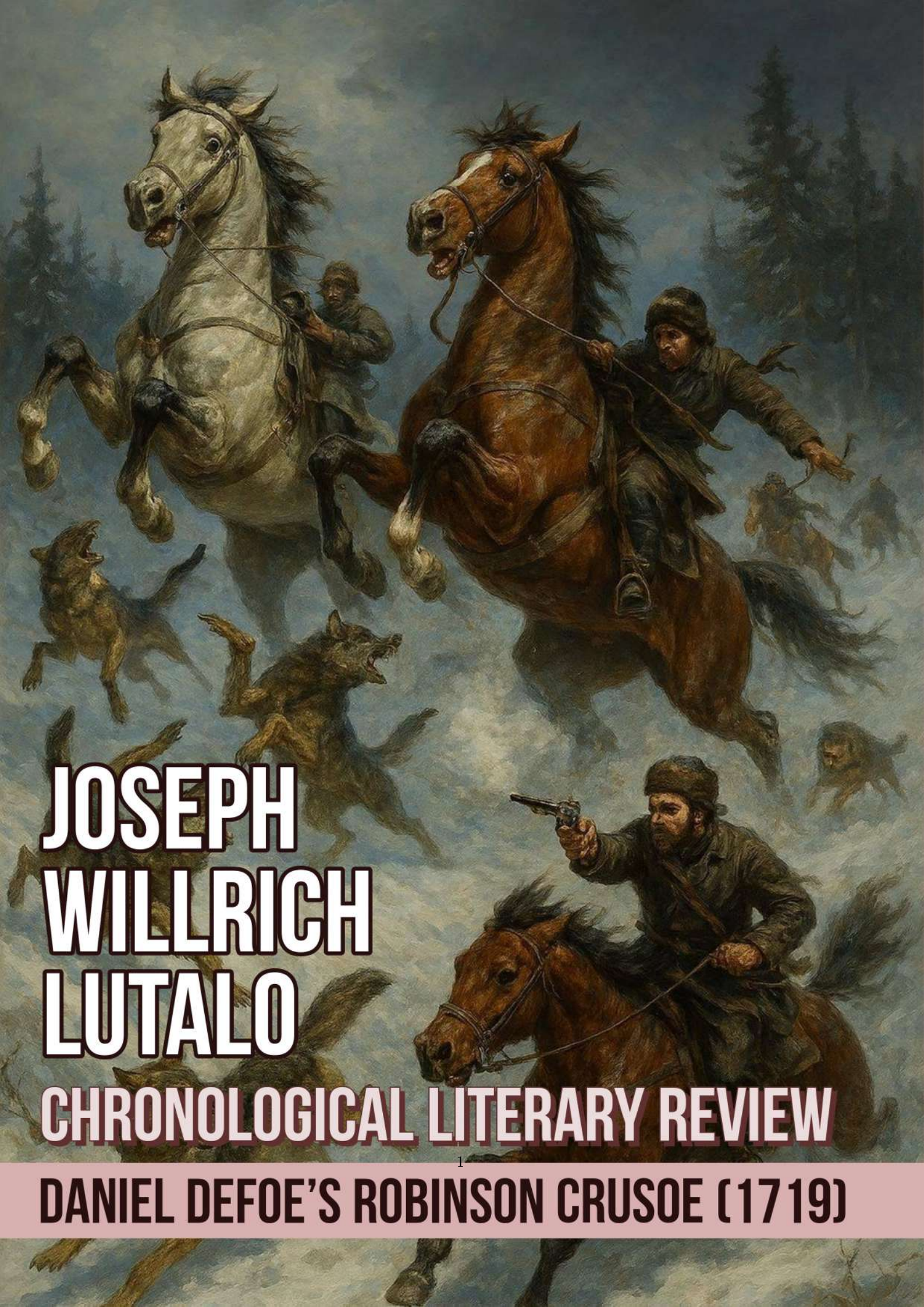




JOSEPH WILLRICH LUTALO

CHRONOLOGICAL LITERARY REVIEW

DANIEL DEFOE'S ROBINSON CRUSOE (1719)

JWL's Chronological Literary Review of **Daniel Defoe's Robinson Crusoe** (1719)

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June 29, 2026

Abstract

This **monograph** presents a **chronological literary review** of Daniel Defoe's 1719 classic novel *Robinson Crusoe*. The review has been planned but is also written by his student and modern novelist, Joseph Willrich Lutalo C.M.R.W., author of 2025 wartime fiction novel, *Rock 'N' Draw* as well as the 2018 occult fiction novel, *Shrines of The Free Men*. The review has been compiled over an extended period of reflective reading spanning longer than a year; between January 2025 and May 2026. It is structured as a series of dated notes, each capturing the precise moment of engagement with the text, accompanied by excerpts from the novel but also significant personal commentary on the text. This method allows for a layered exploration of the novel's themes, narrative techniques, and cultural resonances, while also documenting the evolving perceptions of the reader and reviewer across more than a year of careful study of the book.

Further, by situating the review within a temporal framework, the work highlights how sustained, reflective reading can deepen understanding of canonical literature. The inclusion of excerpts alongside both analytic and critical commentary provides a dialogic interplay between Defoe's text and contemporary reflection, offering insights into the enduring relevance of *Robinson Crusoe* in modern life. Despite so many other scholars having studied, annotated, revised as well as reviewed this and other works by Daniel Defoe, and yet, as one shall quickly establish, this review brings forth an entirely new perspective to appreciating Daniel Defoe as well as his *Adventures of Robinson Crusoe*. This, especially coming from a seasoned reviewer of various [other] kinds of both creative and academic works spanning science, philosophy and the arts. Lots of otherwise usually hidden gems in Defoe's work have been given sufficient attention and treatment herein. Moreover, and ultimately, this review demonstrates the value of chronological annotation as both **a scholarly and creative practice, producing a record that is at once analytical, personal, and historically relevant.**

Keywords: Daniel Defoe, Robinson Crusoe, Reflective Reading, Commentary, Canonical Literature, Chronological Literary Review

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1 Navigation Guide

Contents

1	Navigation Guide	3
2	Author's Note	9
3	Preamble	10
3.1	Daniel Defoe: A Brief Biography	11
3.1.1	Early Life	11
3.1.2	Career	12
3.1.3	Literary Achievements	12
3.1.4	Legacy	12
3.2	On Structure and Presentation of This Review	13
4	Jan 19, 2025 05:39 - Accessing The Book	14
5	Feb 6, 2025 12:47:29 - Concerning Book's Titles	15
6	Feb 6, 2025 12:53:32 - Reading Novel's First Page	15
7	Feb 6, 2025 13:05:47 - Concerning The Advise Crusoe's Father Gave Him as A Young Man	16
7.1	Later Note	16
8	Feb 6, 2025 13:16:18 - A Sign of Distress	17
8.1	Later Note	17
9	Feb 6, 2025 13:30:23 - Wise People Sin and Are Not Afraid to Repent	19
10	Feb 6, 2025 13:10:53 - Concerning the Allure of Modesty	19
11	Feb 6, 2025 14:16:31 - Concerning Propagation of Characters Across Works of Literature	20
11.1	Later Note	20
12	Feb 6, 2025 14:29:11 - Earliest Mention of Baphomet aka "Mahomet" in Modern Literature?	21
12.1	Later Note	21
13	Feb 6, 2025 15:00:01 - On The Nudity and Exhibitionism of Primitive Africans	21
14	Feb 7, 2025 08:46:10 - On Use of Mental Dialogue in Daniel Defoe's [Ancient] Literature	23
14.1	Later Note	24

15 Feb 8, 2025 05:33:59 - On Creative Integration of Literature in Contemporary Entertainment Programmes: case of MAZERA's 'Literature Moments'	24
15.1 Pre-Valentine MAZERA Concert 2025	25
16 Feb 8, 2025 19:07:35 - Concerning Defoe's Shaping of Crusoe's World and Circumstances	26
17 Feb 13, 2025 19:39:41 - Concerning Solitaire	27
18 Feb 17, 2025 08:08:37 - Concerning Terraforming and Utility Crafting Such as via Carpentry	27
18.1 Later Note	27
19 Feb 17, 2025 08:34:50 - Concerning Journaling and Diary Keeping	28
19.1 That Journaling or Keeping a Diary is a sure and effective [old] Practical Method of Improving one's State of Mind and Temperament	28
19.2 Later Note	29
20 Feb 17, 2025 09:00:08 - Concerning Candles and Crafting Sources of Illumination	30
20.1 On the Importance of Creating Artificial Light for The Extension of Human Activity into Night After Natural Sunlight Goes Away	30
21 Feb 20, 2025 03:28:26 - Concerning Why Man Grew Weary of Dwelling in Caves	31
22 Apr 27, 2025 21:24:54 - On Divination Using Books or Leveraging Bibliomancy with A Bible	32
23 Apr 27, 2025 22:00:51 - Concerning The Importance of Knowledge of Agriculture for Survival Such as via Crop-Husbandry	33
24 Apr 27, 2025 23:07:33 - On Classifying Daniel Defoe as Writer	34
24.1 Later Note	35
25 Apr 27, 2025 23:15:10 - On Practicing Farm Magick to Ward Off Vermin	36
25.1 Crusoe's Solution to Fighting Off Predatory Birds from Crops? Scarecrows made of Bird Carcasses! Some Strange Farm Magick! .	37
26 Mar 1, 2025 03:26:20 - Eating Tortoise is Allowed!	38
27 Mar 4, 2025 21:07:17 - That Solitude Frees Man from Sin and Breeds Better Souls	40
27.0.1 Later Note	41
28 Mar 4, 2025 21:15:29 - An Englishman In Search of Cassava!	41

29 Mar 4, 2025 21:40:08 - Three Little Kittens and Nothing To-Do with Kindergarten	42
29.1 Later Note	42
30 Mar 4, 2025 21:59:49 - Finally Understood How to Use ‘Dinner’	43
30.1 Later Note	44
31 Aug 23, 2025 21:57:31 - Concerning How Robinson Crusoe Sometimes Acted Like a Brute	45
32 Aug 23, 2025 22:03:21 - Numerous Fruits One Could Reap from Bible Study Alone!	46
33 Aug 23, 2025 22:22:13 - How Having a Knife Lifts Man from The State of Being a Beast	46
33.1 Later Note	46
34 Sep 20, 2025 00:40:37 - A Lesson in Being Grateful	47
34.1 Later Note	47
35 Dec 21, 2025 16:06:12 - In Obscure Vocabulary: ‘Rivulet’ and ‘Brook’	48
35.1 Later Note	48
36 Dec 21, 2025 16:31:47 - Concerning The Relevance of Keeping Non-Human Partners Such as [Bird] Pets	49
37 Dec 21, 2025 16:50:36 - On The Difficulty of Finding Anything Equal to Human Neighbors or Social Life	51
38 Dec 21, 2025 16:55:11 - Concerning The Relevance of Smoking	52
39 Dec 21, 2025 17:09:15 - On The Manner of Domesticating Originally Wild Goats	53
40 Dec 21, 2025 17:14:46 - To Hunt or Instead Domesticate Game?	54
41 Dec 21, 2025 17:26:39 - Breeding Goats for both Meat and Milk	55
41.1 Later Note	56
42 Dec 21, 2025 17:49:09 - Concerning Robinson Crusoe’s Queer Cosplay and DIY Apparels	56
42.1 Later Note	57
43 Dec 21, 2025 18:13:21 - Horror and Mysterious Sightings of Big-Foot?	59
44 Dec 21, 2025 18:21:55 - Concerning a Human Explanation for Mysterious Phenomenon	61

45 Dec 21, 2025 18:37:21 - On Appreciating Human Companionship as a Divine Gift and Solitariness as The State of Being [Spiritually] Dead	63
46 Dec 21, 2025 18:45:11 - Robinson Crusoe The Bibliomancer	64
46.1 Later Note	64
47 Dec 26, 2025 22:21:05 - On Brewing Beer For Oneself	65
48 Dec 26, 2025 22:35:01 - Crusoe Plotting to Ambush A Band of Cannibals That Visit His Island	66
49 Dec 26, 2025 23:09:19 - Defoe Reflects Upon and Criticizes The Inhumane Excessive Brutality of European Christian Imperialists on Foreign Barbaric Tribes	66
50 Jan 2, 2026 23:09:57 - Crusoe Witnesses a Ship Getting Wrecked, Encounters a Boy's Floating Corpse	68
51 Jan 19, 2026 23:14:06 - That Gratitude As a State of Mind Can [Re-]Paint One's Reality For The Better	69
52 Jan 20, 2026 00:38:54 - Concerning Modern Life and Contemporary Experiences of Traveling the Big Oceans and Seas of The World: A BBC Talk-show Episode About Laura	70
52.1 Later Note	77
53 Mar 1, 2026 23:43:45 - Robinson Crusoe Finally Gets A Friendly Human Companion, Albeit a Savage!	79
53.1 Later Note	80
54 Mar 1, 2026 23:57:47 - Crusoe Describes the Stunning Beauty of His Newly Acquired Man Friend	81
54.1 Later Note	81
55 Mar 2, 2026 00:12:12 - Concerning the Rituals of Initiating a New Slave or Servant	82
55.1 Later Note	82
56 Mar 2, 2026 00:20:56 - The Savage Practice of Eating Prisoners of War	85
56.1 Later Note	85
57 Mar 2, 2026 22:06:43 - Concerning Milton-like Reflections in Daniel Defoe's Writing	88
58 Mar 2, 2026 22:27:38 - On The Intrigue of Carrying a Gun	90
59 Mar 12, 2026 20:46:54 - The Process of Converting Primitives to Christianity: Case of Friday's 'Benamuckee' God	91

60 Mar 12, 2026 20:59:27 - Concerning The Nearly Universal Tendency Across Cultures, of Elevated Priestly Castes as well as Secret Orders	92
60.1 Later Note	93
61 Mar 12, 2026 21:13:57 - Concerning The Matter of Converting Young People into Zealous Christians	94
62 Mar 26, 2026 00:58:08 - Concerning The Unreserved Trust in Scriptures as ‘The Word of God’	95
63 Mar 26, 2026 01:34:55 - On Initiating a Sailor	97
64 Mar 26, 2026 01:52:05 - Concerning Observing, Recording and Managing the Passage of Time and Seasons Without Any Special Tools	98
64.1 Later Note	99
65 Apr 24, 2026 03:03:09 - On Growing, Commanding and Leading an Army or Militant Leadership	102
65.1 Later Note	103
66 Apr 24, 2026 03:24:55 - How Cleverness or Creativity in Military Conquests Can Seem Preternatural	106
66.1 Later Note	106
67 Apr 24, 2026 03:52:20 - Crusoe Obtains a Ship!	109
68 Apr 24, 2026 04:00:09 - Experiencing Deliverance Can Shake One to The Bone!	110
69 Apr 24, 2026 04:30:11 - Crusoe, Blessed with Fine Accolades Upon his Deliverance, With Cascading Timeless Effects Felt by His Reviewer as Well!	110
70 Apr 27, 2026 23:28:12 - Concerning Defoe’s Unusual Writing Style	112
71 Apr 27, 2026 23:46:20 - Concerning The Spirit of Expanding and Perpetuating Territory and Influence present in Robinson Crusoe	113
71.1 Later Note	113
72 Apr 28, 2026 00:11:43 - 28 Years in Captivity of 35 Years Being Away from England, Crusoe Finally Arrives Home!	114
73 Apr 28, 2026 00:21:09 - Concerning Tracing One’s Family [Roots] or Lineage in the Face of Prolonged Absence	115
74 Apr 28, 2026 01:02:28 - Concerning Fevers of Joy and Their Potential Remedies	116
74.1 Later Note	117

75 Apr 28, 2026 01:28:49 - A Criticism of Papistry	118
75.1 Later Note	118
76 Apr 28, 2026 01:41:00 - On The Long-Lost Humane Practice of Exchanging Letters and Gifts with Remote Friends	119
77 May 18, 2026 04:25:46 - Crusoe's Battle Against Packs of Ravenous Wolves in the Pyrenees	121
78 May 23, 2026 03:21:31 - Nearly Celibate, Crusoe Finally Marries and Raises a Family!	124
78.1 Later Note	124
79 May 23, 2026 03:51:25 - Daniel Defoe Reviewing Himself	125
80 May 23, 2026 04:20:34 - The Moral	126
80.1 Later Note	126
81 ABOUT REVIEWER	127
81.1 Notable Earlier Reviews	128
82 Acknowledgments	130
83 Dedication	130

2 Author's Note

This book represents years of research, reflection, and dedication. It was written with the hope of sparking curiosity, conversation, and deeper understanding.

Publishing is a journey that extends beyond the writing itself. To bring this work fully into print and to continue the research that inspired it, I welcome the support of readers who believe in its vision. Your encouragement---whether through sharing, contributing, or simply engaging with the ideas---helps ensure that this project reaches the widest possible audience.

Thank you for being part of this journey. Together, we can turn words on a page into a lasting contribution.

—The Author

3 Preamble

As a writer, still furthering my craft but also as one that has without doubt read and encountered several other writers much greater than myself – both ancients and contemporaries, I have come to appreciate that it surely is true that without learning from others, there is little worthwhile contributions in literature that one would make. While writing a review of his work shall come another day, I have recently picked up a wonderful non-fiction work by the novelist (and fiction writer) I dearly admire; Stephen King. In his *On Writing* [1], King puts it better than I would, when he says:

If you want to be a writer, you must do two things
above all others: read a lot and write a lot. There's
no way around these two things that I'm aware of, no
shortcut.

If you don't have time to read, you don't have the
time (or the tools) to write. Simple as that.

—Stephen King, *On Writing*, 2000[1]

The writing of this review started more than a year ago; on January 19th, 2025, at around the time I was winding up editing and proof-reading my second full-length novel, *Rock 'N' Draw* [2]. It had been during the writing of that work, a wartime literary fiction novel situated in the Uganda of 2036 — essentially, in the future — when I decided to revisit an 'ancient' classic I'd already encountered many years before as a teenager.

Daniel Defoe's adventure story concerning Robinson Crusoe's escapades first came to me while I was in my early teens — most likely around twelve to thirteen or so. I was in junior high school at the time — **St. Henry's College Kitovu**, a renown traditional Catholic school located in Masaka — and had some friends that enjoyed literature, writing and drama. At around that time too, my elder sister, **Hope Irene Resty** (RIP), was working for the British Embassy in Kigali, and once in a while returned from overseas with lots of old and new literature gems in the form of novels, magazines and encyclopedias for her siblings to enjoy. I was her big time fan! Internet wasn't yet a thing for us ordinary folks in a middle-class family, and so, books played a big role in exposing me to much of the yet-to-be-explored world. However, despite having come across and also having read some classics for a while, *Robinson Crusoe* somewhat did not resonate well with me¹, and so I quickly dumped it for more modern, 'pulp fiction' works (the **Dan Browns**, **Anne Rices**, **David Ickes**, etc.) Moreover, before encountering Defoe for the first time, I'd already devoured some thick classics without illustrations in them such as **Homer's** *Odyssey* (~700 BC);

¹Cannot recall exactly which edition I first picked, however, despite having encountered other "classroom literature" texts such as **George Orwell's** *Animal Farm* as part of mandatory reading material in Lit class, it is very possible that at that age and with my limited experience back then, Defoe's book probably felt too academic, too cryptic or too old-school for my liking.

a book I picked from a private collection at home — mum loved reading too. Further, and despite the unfortunate abandoning of the school subject known as “Literature” once I got suspended from the Catholic school later that year, it is good enough that I’d had the chance to study another important classic — **Charles Dicken**’s *Great Expectations* (1860) — as part of my essential class load during Senior Two.

It is against that background that I returned to Daniel Defoe, albeit much later in life². Early 2025, while scouting about for some extra reading material to inspire my on-going work, I did come across a special edition of his classic; twas a curated, expanded and vastly annotated edition by a team at Oxford University Press; **Chancellor Jackman Professor of English at the University of Toronto, Thomas Keymer**³, as well as Dr. James Kelly⁴, currently a Fellow Emeritus at Queen’s College, Cambridge [3]. A modern rendition, [4], presented under the “**Oxford World’s Classics**” series, the electronic-book quickly caught my attention as being paramount for me to read, but also study, and thus begun my journey revisiting the Robinson Crusoe tale.

3.1 Daniel Defoe: A Brief Biography



Portrait of **Daniel Defoe**, National Maritime Museum, London

Daniel Defoe⁵ (c. 1660–1731) was an English writer, journalist, merchant, and political agent, best remembered as the author of *Robinson Crusoe* (1719), one of the earliest and most influential novels in English literature.

3.1.1 Early Life

Born in London around 1660, Defoe was the son of James Foe, a tallow chandler, and Alice Foe. Raised in a Presbyterian Non-conformist household⁶, he attended Charles Morton’s dissenting academy at Newington Green. Later, he adopted the name “Defoe” to give himself a more distinguished identity.

²Nearly 30 years since first encountering the classic novelist!

³Also a Supernumerary Fellow of St. Anne’s College, Oxford.

⁴Also a researcher on early modern voyage narratives including Daniel Defoe’s and John Milton.

⁵The brief biography shared in this section is courtesy of Copilot [3] and might not divulge all necessary details. However, those interested can as well consult other authorities, including the official Wikipedia page: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Daniel_Defoe

⁶It might be worth noting that, without even knowing or realizing it until the writing of this review, the reviewer’s latest novel, *Rock ‘N’ Draw*, [2], somewhat appeals to Presbyterians — including an explicit mention of and several activities taking place at the “Presbyterian Mercy Hospital” — a possibly subconscious but significant shift away from a heavily Catholic-biased *Shrines of The Free Men*, [5], their first novel.

3.1.2 Career

Defoe began his career as a merchant, trading in hosiery, wool, and wine, though he suffered repeated financial setbacks. He became a prolific pamphleteer and political writer, sometimes landing in prison for his controversial views. He also served as a government agent, using his writing to influence public opinion. Defoe is considered one of the pioneers of modern journalism, founding and contributing to several periodicals.

3.1.3 Literary Achievements

Defoe's literary fame rests primarily on his novels:

- *Robinson Crusoe* (1719): Often regarded as the first English novel, it tells the story of survival and self-reliance on a deserted island.
- *Moll Flanders* (1722): A tale of crime, poverty, and resilience through the life of a woman navigating hardship.
- *A Journal of the Plague Year* (1722): A semi-fictional account of the 1665 plague in London, blending reportage and narrative.
- *Roxana* (1724): A novel exploring morality, wealth, and identity.

3.1.4 Legacy

Defoe's works helped establish prose fiction as a respected literary form in Britain. His blend of adventure, realism, and social commentary influenced later novelists such as **Samuel Richardson** and **Henry Fielding**. He died on 24 April 1731 in London and was buried at Bunhill Fields. He was survived by 8 children including Hannah Defoe, William Defoe, Magnolia Defoe, Benjamin Norton Defoe, **Sophia Defoe** and others.

Key Facts

Birth:	c. 1660, London
Death:	24 April 1731, London
Occupations:	Writer, journalist, merchant, spy
Religious Background:	Presbyterian Nonconformist
Famous Works:	

- *Robinson Crusoe*
- *Moll Flanders*
- *A Journal of the Plague Year*
- *Roxana*

Contribution:	Pioneer of the English novel
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3.2 On Structure and Presentation of This Review

In the rest of this review then, we shall focus on the reading journey I sustained for a little more than a year between January 19th 2025 and May 23rd 2026⁷. We shall have each review session sectioned under the corresponding date and time⁸, perhaps [optionally] annotated by an illustrative subtitle or concept-keyword, and then shall have this followed by a verbatim excerpt¹⁰ from the book, my [original as well as later] notes or reflections on the material, as well as any other essential review materials I see fit to include. This style of review should especially help those that have already encountered Defoe's story to readily follow along, in nearly the same order as the story unfolds in [4]. Moreover, since both the reading and review process spanned a long period, the chronological presentation should help highlight and stress the special impact the book had on me during the course of my reading it, as well as how my appreciation of Defoe's masterpiece changed or morphed over time.

The special inclusion of a **Table of Contents** in a work that originally started out as a mere academic paper came as a later idea meant to help give sufficient attention to the structure of this review, but also to help make clear that interested readers of this review can use it as a reference or look-up booklet; so that, by consulting either the review date and time, or the associated review topic headings, one can readily identify where it is in the work of Daniel Defoe, a particular theme, topic or concept is situated. Also, given this review introduced lots of deep, diverse and enriching discussions on many of the ideas that Defoe surfaced, consulting and leveraging the **Table of Contents** shall go a long way given we have chosen not to include an index (just yet).

Without doubt, newcomers to both Daniel Defoe, but also to literary reviews should likewise find much to takeaway from this ambitious¹¹ undertaking. As with several other academic works by Fut. Prof. Joseph W. Lutalo, *it started*

⁷Which was just a week before the biggest milestone of my life thus far; celebrating my 40th birthday!

⁸Concerning the cited reading or review session timestamps mentioned in this chronological review, it should be important to disclose that as a cautious and pragmatic software engineer (more about this in **About Reviewer**), I quickly realized that no other tool would help me take as well as keep my review notes better than something I have built myself — esp. a tool I have specifically built for such a purpose. Thus, despite my **Meta-Egg Tray** (MET) android app no-longer being accessible via official listings on Google Play (long story for another day...), I did use and keep an up-to-date [reference] version on my GitHub Account via <https://github.com/mcnemesis/tray>

⁹MET is great for sourcing, annotating, formatting as well as reviewing [verbatim] notes as part of field work, literature and research reviews or activities, etc. It allows for formatting notes using **Markdown syntax**, but also makes it easy to time-track notes and revisions on them since it automatically assigns current date and time to each created note, including revisions, clones and note exports.

¹⁰Further, note that, the presented **excerpt text** is as close to the versions one shall find presented in [4] — down to how the words are capitalized, the use of punctuation and paragraphing, etc. However, we shall not preserve original **emphasis*, instead opting to present the **reviewer's own emphasis** where necessary.

¹¹“Ambitious” because, despite being a lifelong lover of literature and especially of fiction works, and also having penned several of my own — short-stories, poetry, free-verse, essays, novellas, novels as well as music lyrics — I can't pretend to be an authority on the matter just yet. I have no degree in literature, have not spent much time around PhDs nor professors of either English or [English] Literature, and thus strongly advise any reviewers or critics of my review to take my work with a grain of salt. Please, without doubt, note that I surely welcome all kinds of criticism and [corrective] feedback from readers of my work.

*out as a paper, but is now a book!*¹²

4 Jan 19, 2025 05:39 - Accessing The Book

Today, I picked up the e-book version of Daniel Defoe's classic. It is part of the "Oxford World's Classics" series and was recommended by **Microsoft Co-Pilot**.

I downloaded the e-book after scouting around for a readable, free-access and complete edition via online searches spanning channels such as Google Search, Yandex as well as **PDFDrive**. I managed to get a free PDF edition fit for my purposes.

I started reading, using the e-Reader Android app, **ReadEra**.

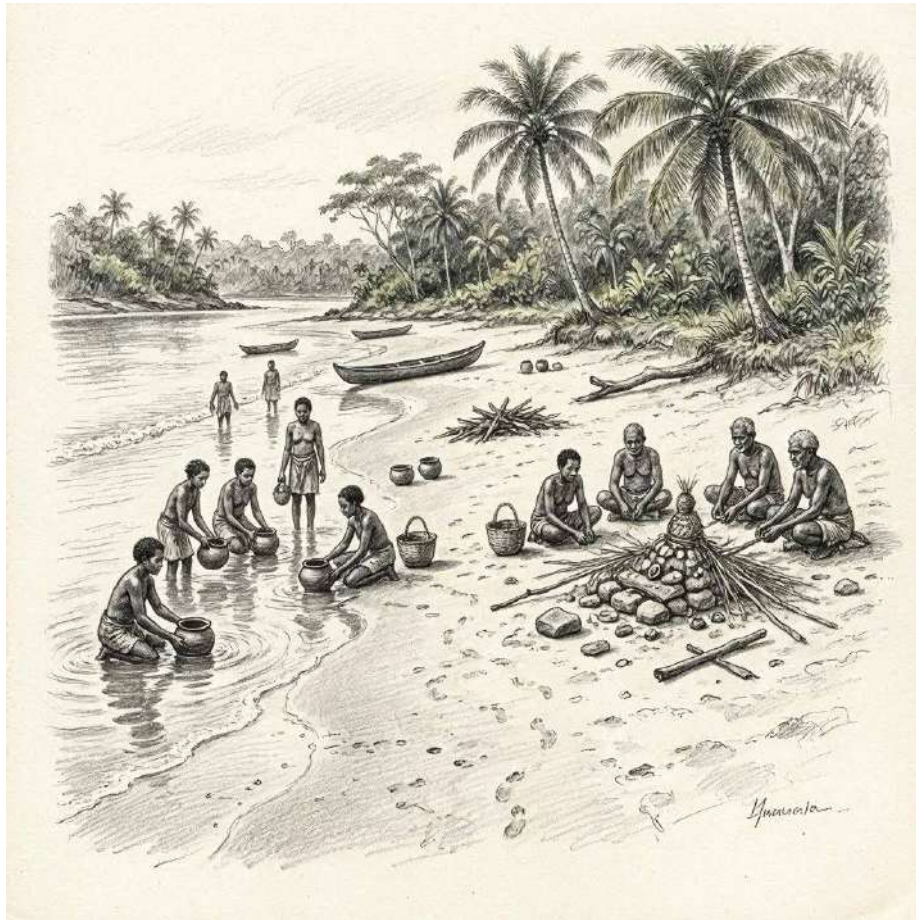


Figure 1: An attempt, using prompt engineering and image generation, to try and picture what life in some parts of the world possibly felt like in Robinson Crusoe's time.

¹²For a good other example, of course also check out [6].

5 Feb 6, 2025 12:47:29 - Concerning Book's Titles

I have just found out — thanks to Copilot [3] — that “The Life and Adventures of Robinson Crusoe” is another/alternative title for the novel originally published as “The Life and Strange Surprising Adventures of Robinson Crusoe, of York, Mariner” by **Daniel Defoe** on **April 25, 1719**.

A reputable online resource concerning the novel is located at **Wikipedia** via https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Robinson_Crusoe

6 Feb 6, 2025 12:53:32 - Reading Novel's First Page

The edition I picked up did have several preamble materials leading up to the meat of the book itself; a brief bio about Daniel Defoe himself; an extensive introductory chapter concerning both the novel's author, several of his other works and the book itself — in a sense, the chapter almost reading as a review of both the author and the novel and which is attributed to **Thomas Keymer**. The acknowledgement section too did mention **J. Donald Crowley** as the recognized source of the text utilized in preparing the Oxford English Novels edition (1972).

However, past the introductory notes, bibliographical and insightful historical blubber, I finally encountered a *This page intentionally left blank*, and after which I believe the actual material from the original classic started to unfold before my eyes.

Reading the first page of the actual novel, and with the ambition to glean as much from the original book as possible, the following opening paragraph without doubt struck me as essential to keep in mind.

I Was born in the Year 1632, in the City of York,
of a good Family, tho' not of that Country, my Father
being a Foreigner of Bremen, who settled first at Hull:
He got a good Estate by Merchandise, and leaving off
his Trade, lived afterward at York, from whence he had
married my Mother, whose Relations were named Robinson,
a very good Family in that Country, and from whom I was
called Robinson Kreutznaer; but by the usual Corruption
of Words in England, we are now called, nay we call our
selves, and write our Name Crusoe, and so my Companions
always call'd me.

—**Daniel Defoe**, *The Life and Adventures of Robinson Crusoe*, 2000[4]

7 Feb 6, 2025 13:05:47 - Concerning The Advise Crusoe's Father Gave Him as A Young Man

My Father, a wise and grave Man, gave me serious and excellent Counsel against what he foresaw was my Design. He call'd me one Morning into his Chamber, where he was confined by the Gout, and expostulated very warmly with me upon this Subject: He ask'd me what Reasons more than a meer wandring Inclination I had for leaving my Father's House and my native Country, where I might be well introduced, and had a Prospect of raising my Fortunes by Application and Industry, with a Life of Ease and Pleasure. He told me it was for Men of desperate Fortunes on one Hand, or of aspiring, superior Fortunes on the other, who went abroad upon Adventures, to rise by Enterprize, and make themselves famous in Undertakings of a Nature out of the common Road; that these things were all either too far above me, or too far below me; that mine was the middle State, or what might be called the upper Station of *Low Life*, which he had found by long Experience was the best State in the World, the most suited to human Happiness, not exposed to the Miseries and Hardships, the Labour and Sufferings of the mechanick Part of Mankind, and not embarrass'd with the Pride, Luxury, Ambition and Envy of the upper Part of Mankind. He told me, I might judge of the Happiness of this State, by this one thing, viz. That this was the State of Life which all other People envied, that Kings have frequently lamented the miserable Consequences of being born to great things, and wish'd they had been placed in the Middle of the two Extremes, between the Mean and the Great; that *the wise Man gave his Testimony to this as the just Standard of true Felicity, when he prayed to have neither Poverty or Riches.*

7.1 Later Note

It is worth noting that, as with what happens when one reads a good book, much of what Defoe wrote about, has without doubt already had influence on me. Since taking note of this section — as an excerpt¹³ in my review notes, I have found that it was indeed meaningful for a [young] man to consider whether or not

¹³Talking of verbatim excerpts from Daniel Defoe's novel under review in the rest of this manuscript, note that, for brevity's sake, we shall omit the obvious references to the author, title and bibliographical link since these are already somewhat implied. Only where we need refer to a work or book other than *The Life and Adventures of Robinson Crusoe* shall we quote the author, title, etc. as we have done for other excerpts in earlier parts of this review manuscript.

it might be worthwhile exploring their life far away from their homeland/natural birth environment or country. I did actually appeal to this advice in the preface of my book *Applying Transformatives in GENETICS*¹⁴ — an originally 2025 treatise introducing my newly formalized body of knowledge on a sub-field of computational mathematics that I refer to as “transformatives”. My reference to Defoe is in relation to another vital piece of advice one finds in earlier parts of the book of *Genesis*, when God instructs or advises mankind to “subdue” the world or nature. My book is yet to get into physical print, however, the work and process is underway to have it published for the global audience by the traditional publisher **Taylor and Francis**, hopefully some time in 2026.

8 Feb 6, 2025 13:16:18 - A Sign of Distress

the Master seeing some [potential aid]... ordered to
fire a Gun as a Signal of Distress.

8.1 Later Note

As the reviewer, but also student of both Defoe and his character, Crusoe, I must testify early enough that, although **I would love to**, and yet, because of the circumstances under which I've lived and grown all my life, **I have neither held a real gun, nor had the chance to learn how to fire one**. Most likely, because, first, **I didn't grow up with a real father, and my real father finally passed away without us having stayed nor ever hunting together**.¹⁵ Second, my respectful mother is generally a pacific person, and she especially groomed most of us to likewise be pacific. She's too religious, too pious [unto this day], and preferred to raise us up not only in proximity of Catholic nuns and priests, but that she almost groomed me into being a priest myself! And then, being the youngest in my family, and having never seen any of my elders — neither brother nor sister — hold or wield a gun, I almost had no inspiration nor someone to learn from! But, most likely, not forever.

¹⁴Refer to the International Internet Portfolio of Writers (**I*POW**) edition via my *Academia* profile: https://www.academia.edu/143516392/Applying_TRANSFORMATICS_in_GENETICS

¹⁵I was just 17 when **Mr. Joseph Karatunga Kasaijja Amooti**, a respected member in the Bunyoro-Kitara Society, passed away. Rest in Peace our beloved father. *Abojjo n'Abaisiki tituli kwebwa Taata waitu! Mukama aliyo, akyatulinda Taata... Kweri, Tuli Bagumu.*



Figure 2: Defoe's student and reviewer as a militant JWL, in a photograph taken around 2023 in Entebbe, Uganda, at a popular spot near the Victorian waters. This scene perhaps, among his gun-wielding moments ever, might be the closest experience the reviewer has, for a documented moment wielding a gun around other people, though, as might be clear from the photograph, it **wasn't in a moment of distress** such as Defoe is currently talking about, and neither did he need to fire it even if it was surely loaded. Interesting to note too, past that moment, his eldest son quickly picked interest in the gun, and having unceasingly cried for it, the father gave it to him. It is on record then, that **Theo R. Willrich** — whose mother, also a *Munyakitara*, without doubt, as close to the lady shown in this photograph as can be [during her younger years] — currently keeps this particularly **special elite gun**.

9 Feb 6, 2025 13:30:23 - Wise People Sin and Are Not Afraid to Repent

I have since often observed, how incongruous and irrational the common Temper of Mankind is, especially of Youth, to that Reason which ought to guide them in such Cases, viz. That they are not asham'd to sin, and yet are asham'd to repent; not asham'd of the Action for which they ought justly to be esteemed Fools, but are asham'd of the returning, which only can make them be esteem'd wise Men.

10 Feb 6, 2025 13:10:53 - Concerning the Allure of Modesty

that the Calamities of Life were shared among the upper and lower Part of Mankind; but that the middle Station had the fewest Disasters, and was not expos'd to so many Vicissitudes as the higher or lower Part of Mankind; nay, they were not subjected to so many Distempers and Uneasinesses either of Body or Mind, as those were who, by vicious Living, Luxury and Extravagancies on one Hand, or by hard Labour, Want of Necessaries, and mean or insufficient Diet on the other Hand, bring Distempers upon themselves by the natural Consequences of their Way of Living; That the middle Station of Life was calculated for all kind of Vertues and all kinds of Enjoyments; that Peace and Plenty were the Hand-maids of a middle Fortune; that Temperance, Moderation, Quietness, Health, Society, all agreeable Diversions, and all desirable Pleasures, were the Blessings attending the middle Station of Life; that this Way Men went silently and smoothly thro' the World, and comfortably out of it, not embarass'd with the Labours of the Hands or of the Head, not sold to the Life of Slavery for daily Bread, or harrast with perplex'd Circumstances, which rob the Soul of Peace, and the Body of Rest

11 Feb 6, 2025 14:16:31 - Concerning Propagation of Characters Across Works of Literature

I convey'd also a great Lump of Bees-Wax into the Boat, which weighed above half a Hundred Weight, with a Parcel of Twine or Thread, a Hatchet, a Saw and a Hammer, all which were of great Use to us afterwards; especially the Wax to make Candles. Another Trick I try'd upon him, which he innocently came into also; his Name was Ismael, who they call Muly or Moely, so I call'd to him, Moely said I, our Patroon's Guns are on board the Boat, can you not get a little Powder and Shot, it may be we may kill some Alcamies (a Fowl like our Curlieus) for our selves, for I know he keeps the Gunner's Stores in the Ship? Yes, says he, I'll bring some..

Here we come across Ismael also called 'Mully', 'Moely'... Later on [in works of literature long after Daniel Defoe's], we come across "Molly" in **Doris Lessing's** classic *The Golden Notebook*¹⁶ (1962) and then "Molya" in **Joseph Willrich's** *Rock 'N' Draw* (2025) [2]. Thus we should come to appreciate how it is indeed possible that, even when writers across different generations write with or without access-to or prior knowledge of each others works, that somewhat, certain elements do creep from one work to another, often in similar or very [interestingly] related ways! Other times, we might want to ask the [critical] question: **Who really influenced who?** Or, in relation to characters such as Mully here, one might ask: Is it that some characters just somewhat magically show up in most great literature across generations?

11.1 Later Note

Of course, and as we saw in **the preamble** when referring to advise [1] to prospective writers from **Stephen King** — it is expected that great writers likewise read [and re-read] others so much, so that it cannot be denied that, [only] through such exposure to other people's [earlier earlier] literature, future writers pick-up ideas, characters, locations, themes, etc. that they otherwise might not have entertained.

¹⁶Doris Lessing won the **Nobel Prize in Literature** in 2007, honored as "that epicist of the female experience, who with scepticism, fire and visionary power has subjected a divided civilisation to scrutiny." [3]

12 Feb 6, 2025 14:29:11 - Earliest Mention of Baphomet aka “Mahomet” in Modern Literature?

I turn'd to the Boy, who they call'd *Xury*, and said to him, Xury, if you will be faithful to me I'll make you a great Man, but if you will not stroak your Face to be true to me, that is, swear by Mahomet and his Father's Beard, I must throw you into the Sea too; the Boy smil'd in my Face and spoke so innocently that I could not mistrust him; and swore to be faithful to me, and go all over the World with me.

Was Daniel Defoe a Free-Mason or perhaps a Templar given Mahomet was more popular with that kind back then?

12.1 Later Note

Reading this bit got me wondering whether or not Daniel's work should not be credited as among earliest [mainstream] English literature works to ever have [even remotely] referred to the *androgynous godform* known as “Baphomet” — often attributed to the Knights Templars who were founded in an era much earlier than Defoe's day though (since 12th Century; around 1118-1119, in Jerusalem [3]). This, especially because, modern lore has it that despite modern occultists such as Satanists and [some] Free Masons [or more generally, Ceremonial Magicians] appealing to Baphomet¹⁷, that however, it is very likely that this trend is traceable back to the earlier notion of “Mahomet” — itself a potential twist on the Islamic “Muhammad” [3].

13 Feb 6, 2025 15:00:01 - On The Nudity and Exhibitionism of Primitive Africans

then I made Signs to them for some Water, and held out one of my Jarrs to them, turning it bottom upward, to shew that it was empty, and that I wanted to have it filled. They call'd immediately to some of their Friends, and there came two Women and brought a great Vessel made of Earth, and burnt as I suppose in the Sun; this they set down for me, as before, and I sent Xury on Shore with my Jarrs, and filled them all three: *The Women were as stark Naked as the Men.*

¹⁷For example, note that the modern IoNites (a kind of Internet-era ceremonial chaos magicians inspired by The Pact) do maintain a virtual shrine in honor of this godform — see <https://iona.nuchwezi.com>

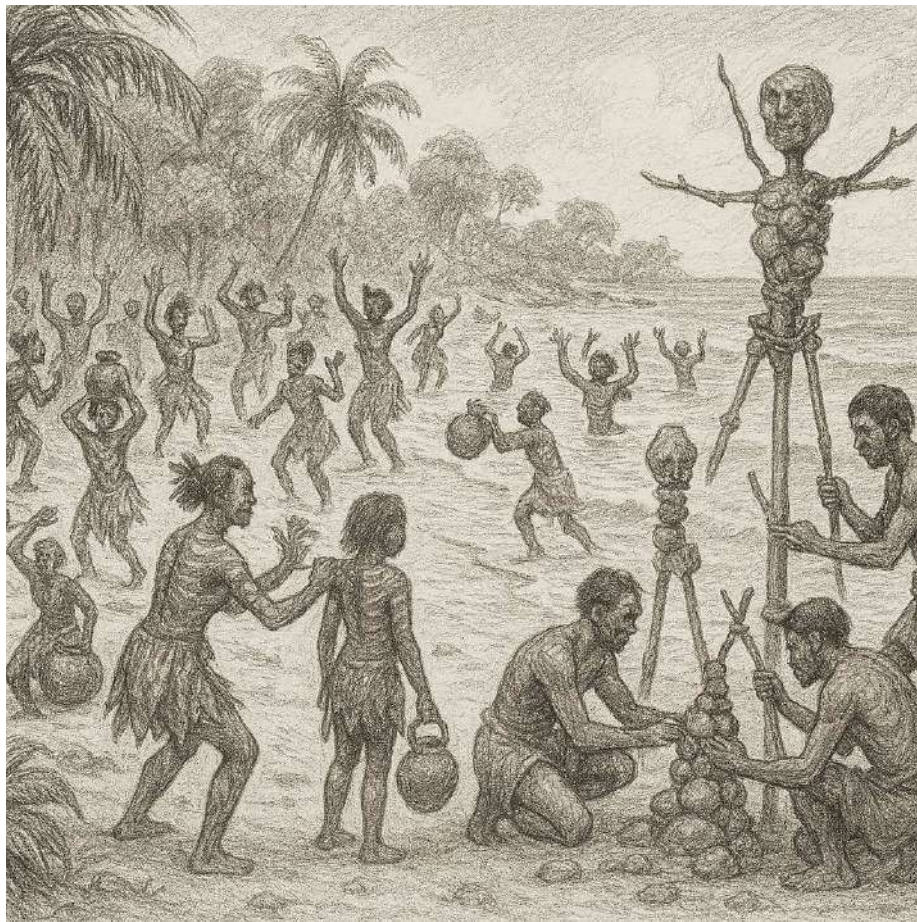


Figure 3: A modest depiction of what Robinson Crusoe possibly encountered off the African coastline.

That even near ocean coastlines, some [primitive] Africans used to live entirely in the nude, and this, for both men and women!

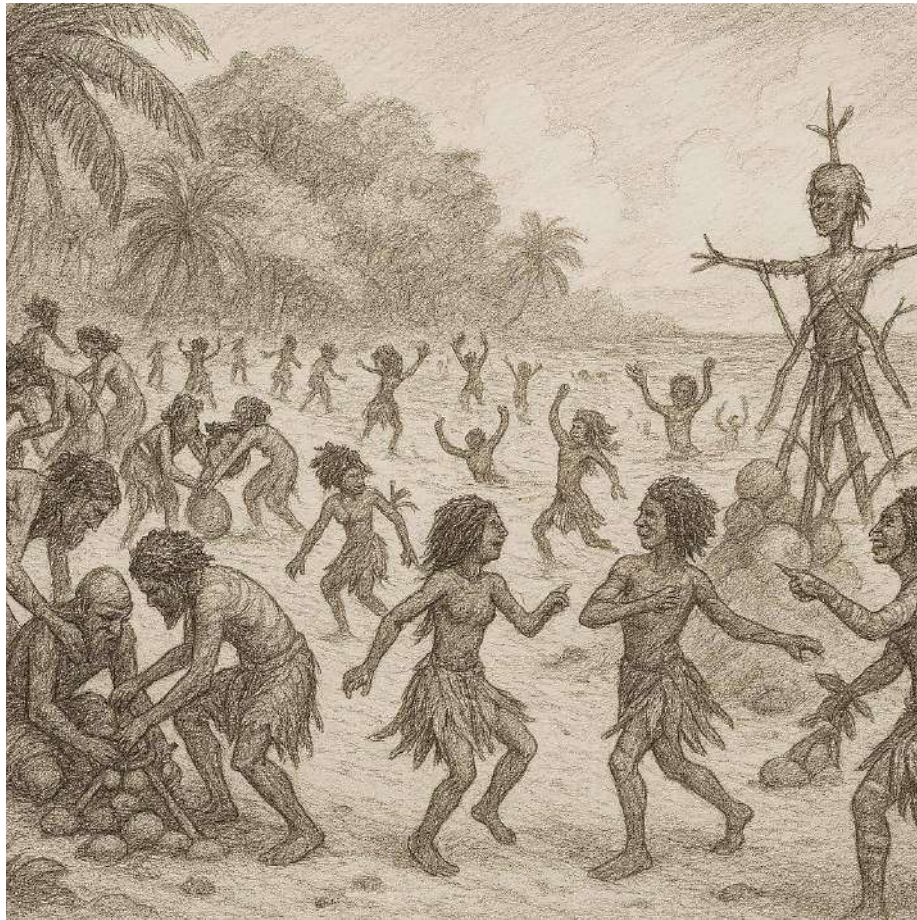


Figure 4: Another attempt at visualizing life off the African coastline in Crusoe's time.

14 Feb 7, 2025 08:46:10 - On Use of Mental Dialogue in Daniel Defoe's [Ancient] Literature

I resolv'd to set all other Things apart, 'till I got every Thing out of the Ship that I could get; then I call'd a Council, that is to say, in my Thoughts, whether I should take back the Raft, but this appear'd impracticable; so I resolv'd to go as before, when the Tide was down, and I did so

Among things typical of JWL's creative literature is the use, in fact, inter-

mixing of verbal and mental dialogue; the former typically expressed as real-time chatter expressed inside of “double quotes”, while the latter is typically expressed using *italicized phrases* in his works — refer to *Rock ‘N’ Draw*, [2], but also earlier *Shrines*, [5] — which, among interesting aspects relating to this topic, also features numerous moments in the narrative, where two or more characters engage in conversations purely using telepathy! Thus, a reader can follow the conversations between physical characters, but can also listen to the nonverbal thoughts of the main character especially.

14.1 Later Note

The significance of this observation lies in the fact that use of mental dialogue as part of narrative in literature is mostly to be found in modern literature and only scantily if at all, in ancient or pre-modern works of fiction. Also, though we cannot speak of “stream of thought” mental dialogue in Defoe’s work in the same vein or manner as one might find in a modern work such as [2], the writings of **Ian McEwan** or Stephen King’s, and yet, we see the [ancient] writer trying to develop the idea as exhibited in this excerpt.

15 Feb 8, 2025 05:33:59 - On Creative Integration of Literature in Contemporary Entertainment Programmes: case of MAZERA’s ‘Literature Moments’

The following item is not directly related to an explicit section within [4], but is in fact related to the material in that work; as we encounter in the **About Reviewer** section later on, we ought realize that during the course of his other undertakings, the reviewer likewise enjoys crafting and performing music¹⁸. Among these ventures outside of reading, writing and reviewing literature is the interesting hobby of **creatively performing literature**; often, as we might catch in some of MAZERA’s works such as the 2026 Valentine’s PIANIC LOVE-FEST concert¹⁹, the reviewer enjoys exploring literature through performing it alongside live drums, keyboards and a listening, participant audience.

The following note is a verbatim excerpt from the original review notes alongside those relating to the reading of Defoe’s classic, and as you might tell from the cited event’s menu, indeed, the book was used as part of the core programme around then...

¹⁸As of mid-2026, long after writing the original note, it was with pleasure when I discovered that though there seems to be little general mention nor celebration of it, that the popular, modern horror-fiction writer we all love, Stephen King, is actually likewise into crafting and performing music as a side hustle or pastime, oftentimes with fellow writers — their act known as “**The Rock Bottom Remainders**” [1].

¹⁹Refer to a digital aural depiction via Museum of MAZERA at <https://t.me/mazeraworks/1227>

15.1 Pre-Valentine MAZERA Concert 2025

In the wee hours of today (2am to 5am), I set up and performed a terrific MAZERA formal concert at the celestial shrine, plot 266, 1st Cwa Road.

Among notable pieces performed:

- Formal opening with UGANDA national anthem, Buganda Anthem, Chwezi Anthem and MAZERA Anthem (Amazing Grace)
- Metallic Jazz cover of Henry Tigan's "Abogezi"
- Literature Moments featuring dramatic, translation-enhanced reading of Daniel Defoe's classic novel "Adventures of Robinson Crusoe" alongside metallic tunes of classic Catholic hymn "Go Tell It On The Mountain"
- Rock N Roll remix of legendary children's rhyme "3 Little Kittens" complete with breaks of singing, story telling in English and Luganda as well as heavy metal growls! It was too energetic and thrilling!

At the performance of that last item, the heavens had already gotten worked up quite well, and a storm visibly quickly approaching from across the Lake Victoria horizon compelled me to wind-up the concert and run before the rain comes down on the open roof performance set (on similar occasions in the past, some of my hardware didn't make it when the performance caused rains that also hit down on the exposed machines).

It was a worthwhile and terrific adventure! We feigned performing to an audience in Leicester and it surely came out well. The crew had some drinks to boost them up, and the performance had opened with some backstage prayers.

—JoJo The Punk, *CCM^a of MAZERA*, 2025

^aChief Choir Master

16 Feb 8, 2025 19:07:35 - Concerning Defoe's Shaping of Crusoe's World and Circumstances

In the Interval of time while this was doing I went out once at least every Day with my Gun, as well to divert my self, as to see if I could kill any thing fit for Food, and as near as I could to acquaint my self with what the Island produc'd. The first time I went out I presently discover'd that there were Goats in the Island, which was a great Satisfaction to me; but then it was attended with this Misfortune to me, viz. That they were so shy, so subtile, and so swift of Foot, that it was the difficultest thing in the World to come at them

I feel somewhat inclined to conclude that Defoe really loved this Robinson Crusoe like a very merciful father might with their only son perhaps. Because, at every other twist in the story, since the start of it, one finds that Crusoe is always in good luck one way or another, despite his obstinacy and overly optimistic gambling with fate at every other turn; meeting with beneficent circumstances even where others might perish or struggle indefinitely.

Of course, one is not to over-blame the author; perhaps the story wouldn't read any better if he was mean to the protagonist — or perhaps it was in his nature to always prefer a positive outcome for the one he loves (not that loss of life [such as companions and comrades] and property weren't taking place around Crusoe much the time), however, in this book, it sometimes is pretty obvious that despite Crusoe being too industrious, enterprising and courageous, yet, it sometimes feels as though the architect of the story imbued him with so much power and somewhat bends much of reality to his will.

Well, that said, of course my review here comes from the perspective of someone that also writes epics; who has to deal with **the complex matter of realistic world-building** — essential in any great novel, and yes, I do notice when Defoe enjoyed his **liberty of playing God in this fictitious story**; it is both purging and trying; to attempt to stand in Crusoe's shoes amidst a mostly primitive, alien and relentless existence. Among the greatest allures of this story is having to thrive in a mostly unexplored/unfamiliar world; a thrill perhaps not many modern writers can still enjoy unless their tales take mankind to entirely *other-worlds* such as off-Earth or in perhaps alternate dimensions²⁰ and realities — it is part of what makes this book terrific to study; its primitive, [then] unexplored/underexplored terrain and problems.

²⁰Concerning stories with scenes or voyages to "alternate" dimensions or worlds, note that the reviewer's first novel, *Shrines of The Free Men*, [5], does have several such escapades, including an extensively documented voyage into **the African afterlife** by a modern African occultist.

17 Feb 13, 2025 19:39:41 - Concerning Solitaire

I am divided from Mankind, a Solitaire, one banish'd
from humane Society

Could this be the earliest use of the word that became the name of that very popular Microsoft Windows cards game? Did it always refer to or mean “loner”? Of course it is likely based on “solitary”, but why is it no more used in that sense?

18 Feb 17, 2025 08:08:37 - Concerning Terraforming and Utility Crafting Such as via Carpentry

And now I began to apply my self to make such
necessary things as I found I most wanted, as
particularly a Chair and a Table, for without these I
was not able to enjoy the few Comforts I had in the
World, I could not write, or eat, or do several things
with so much Pleasure without a Table.

18.1 Later Note

An alternative title to this section would have been **That Every Civilized Man Or Home Needs a Table and Some Chairs**.

It is worth noting that a good chunk of this book is about teaching [uncivilized] humans the worth of **terraforming** one's environment so as to render it more humane and less wild. We learn of Crusoe's ventures into all sorts of taming activities including managing and imposing order on the chaos he met with on the uninhabited island; wild beasts captured and domesticated, useful plants isolated from the jungle and multiplied, tools smithed or harnessed from natural raw material and then shelved for later use, etc.

Crusoe's tale is indeed such a great reminder that in the face of want and discomfort, **the thoughtful, creative and industrious mind can make a home of almost anyplace!**

Somewhat reminds me of the activities I saw during my childhood with regards to boy and girl scouts under the patronage and leadership of my elder brother (now **Professor Donald Rugira Kugonza**²¹) that practiced and exhibited many kinds of intricate terraforming activities in a small corner of the vast compound at the catholic boys' college in Kisubi — St. Mary's College Kisubi (SMACK) — in whose neighborhood we dwelt during my preteen years, and at which school he was a renown Scouts Captain (later a Scouts Master

²¹See <https://rugirakugonza.com>

perhaps) in the spirit of 20th century British Army officer, **Robert Stephenson Smyth Baden-Powell**, their founder²². I would visit or walk by their scouts camp that dwelt close to the high-school's fence, on my way to my own nearby primary school (KBS; Kisubi Boys Primary School), and would marvel at the intricate assortment of tree poles, wooden ladders, tarpaulin sheets, lots of rope and such, that they used to construct everything including storied tents, bridges, surveillance towers and such! In retrospect, I now wonder if it was because at around that time, eldest son (**Muhoozi Kainerugaba** — currently a somewhat pompous military commander) of Uganda's contemporary and longest-serving militaristic president (**Joel Kaguta Museveni**) was likewise attending SMACK, and so that the boys were being groomed to appreciate a robust militaristic lifestyle, or could it instead be that the presence of a thoughtful and classics-respecting head-teacher (**Bro. Joseph Tinkasimire** — himself a very industrious intellectual) was to blame? I mention Bro. Joseph²³ here because, though I have never asked him despite having visited and admired his vast book collection in his later, retirement age, whether or not he perhaps had ever encountered or been influenced by the likes of Daniel Defoe. Who knows?

19 Feb 17, 2025 08:34:50 - Concerning Journaling and Diary Keeping

And now it was when I began to keep a Journal of every Day's Employment, for indeed at first I was in too much Hurry, and not only Hurry as to Labour, but in too much Discomposure of Mind, and my Journal would ha' been full of many dull things

19.1 That Journaling or Keeping a Diary is a sure and effective [old] Practical Method of Improving one's State of Mind and Temperament

Despite living in the wild and alone, we see the telltale signs in Crusoe's decision to not only bring a certain order into the wild environment he found himself in, but to also keep tabs on what's going on both in his mind and the environment about him. And that he justifies these **investments in accounting** for his

²²I knew my big brother was some sort of initiate into the scouts-thing because he was too passionate about it; often returned home with peculiar gadgets such as the first Swiss-knife I ever saw; could craft chairs and tables using nothing but poles, twine and cloth sheets; and that I admired his numerous acquired medals and badges upon returns from scouting adventures in the wilderness, at conferences, as well as travels in foreign countries!

²³Also, besides being my namesake and longtime friend and great source of inspiration in all matters intellectual, spiritual and cultural, he especially is often reserved and quiet to me concerning his own influencers and authorities — apart from the **Lord Jesus Christ** as well as a few other names he highlights in his autobiography; *Telling of God's Work*; which I also happen to have obtained a signed copy of, and for which I did pen and publish a [mini] review — see <https://www.reddit.com/r/jwlreviews/comments/1itwqf8/>

daily actions by **acknowledging that journaling indeed did help him improve his outlook on life even in the face of strife and uncertainty.**

Crusoe's lessons in creating and leveraging a culture of both writing and reading, even for someone living in the most remote and loneliest of circumstances, can help bring into the limelight the seemingly elective advantages that education and a practice of literacy well-applied can endow a person with. One should likewise come to appreciate how these little investments can translate into innumerable, immense positive results over time; for the mind first of all, but also for the body and the environment in which it operates.

19.2 Later Note

I now find no fault in the fundamental lessons I once came across as the must-do methods and rituals of a serious student in **practical and transforming Western Esotericism** as I begun my youthful journey into a life as a practicing magician under an initiated mentor²⁴; to learn to keep and use a journal — also often called a “magical diary”. This skill was taught to me [outside of formal school moreover, and via informal settings mostly via correspondences over the Internet] as one of few sure practices to help shape/form one into a mage capable of not only transforming themselves but also their environment. Through practice and acquisition of this discipline, I later came to develop a certain appreciation of what methods or routine practices in [my magical] life worked or not, and why — among the core ethos of being a successful chaos magician as per the tradition of our founder; **Peter James Carroll** (RIP) — a British occultist and computer scientist that I am surprised didn't found Computational Mysticism²⁵.

Essentially, I see that these are some of the less known, less talked about behaviours or [essential] traits that can make of simple men great thinkers, scientists and geniuses... And here it is, well laid out in a somewhat obscure book of fictitious literature! I have no doubts, Daniel Defoe was truly a successful initiate of the mysteries somewhere somehow!!

²⁴Though oaths and tradition implore one to never disclose such details as their actual IoT mentor's names or identities, and yet, I should credit some friends in the German as well as the British-section of the **Illuminates of Thanateros** (IoT) as having helped shape my earlier disparate attempts at developing a rigorous discipline with regards to journaling and diarying as a pragmatic or empirical occultist — sometimes documenting everything including meditations, planned or executed rituals, dreams, intentions and astral operations! And even long before I ever designed or implemented the MET mobile app (ref. **Section 3.2**) upon which this entire review process is hinged, I did have the chance to design, build and use a more sophisticated journaling tool in the form of a web app, and that it not only could keep one's timestamped notes, but could also help produce reports based on tags, projects, filters, etc. It had capabilities for visual analytics too! Compared to MET, its only downside was that it was server-based, multi-user too, and so that it had to be hosted somewhere over a network in order to be utilized. But otherwise, such were my earlier ventures in journaling and diarying with fellows from The Pact, using a tool I had named “DAO”.

²⁵Talking of CMs; computational mysticism, chaos magick, computational mathematics,... ; it should be fitting for me to bring it up here that I have likewise penned a book — in fact, a no-bullshit treatise; a grimoire; treating of the CMs and likewise referencing some of the ideas of Carroll — refer to the groundbreaking 2025 **Grimoire Lumtauto**: [6], but also <https://bit.ly/grimoirelumtauto>, a book I wonder whether Carroll had the chance to read or even hear about before he passed away in early 2026!

20 Feb 17, 2025 09:00:08 - Concerning Candles and Crafting Sources of Illumination

In the next Place, I was at a great Loss for Candle; so that as soon as ever it was dark, which was generally by Seven-a-Clock, I was oblig'd to go to Bed: I remembred the Lump of Bees-wax with which I made Candles in my African Adventure, but I had none of that now; the only Remedy I had was, that when I had kill'd a Goat, I sav'd the Tallow, and with a little Dish made of Clay, which I bak'd in the Sun, to which I added a Wick of some Oakum, I made me a Lamp; and this gave me Light, tho' not a clear steady Light like a Candle

20.1 On the Importance of Creating Artificial Light for The Extension of Human Activity into Night After Natural Sunlight Goes Away

Yet another lesson in Defoe's book, concerning why civilisation is necessary; the knowledge of how and why one must have some way to not merely turn unproductive simply because nature causes them to! We here encounter the illustrative, but also cautionary case of going to sleep [like beasts] once daylight vanishes!

Thanks to Defoe's advisories, we learn, how, via necessary ingenuity leveraging what is readily found in one's environment, a man could indeed turn into a master over nature in any circumstances. Knowing how to produce light — essentially, **how to be a firestarter or how to make fire manifest and persist** — is without doubt one such important and fundamental power to wield!²⁶

Talking of learning to create sources of light... I personally compelled myself to have to learn how to make a candle over the last few years²⁷, and despite my mother²⁸ not wanting me to invest time or efforts into such! However,

²⁶In *Shrines*, [5], we do have an interesting description of a method [somewhat inspired by ancient Sumerian magical incantations] that is practiced by a certain old African witch, and which method would allow her to start fires using almost mere words/spell-casting.

²⁷Refer to one particular recipe as well as some underlying theory that I cover in the appendices of [6].

²⁸**Christine Nyandera**, my only living parent — though she sometimes behaves like a foster parent — is another very industrious role model of mine; during my teenhood I'd seen her learn, then start producing yoghurt from cow's milk. She'd obtained an imported/foreign-breed cow we then kept at home. Perhaps, my big brother — later a professor of Animal Science, Agriculture and Apiculture at Makerere University — had a hand in these ventures. I'm not so sure, but do strongly suspect this. Moreover, those investments must have greatly contributed to helping keep us in school without a father in sight! Later, she abandoned cows and dairy products and instead started producing and packaging home-processed medicines for cough; using honey, ginger and some herbs. She also was the founder a local women's self-empowerment group, and I noted that besides founding a community savings and credit scheme — essentially a bank — for them, she also periodically hosted some external tutors and instructors on various aspects of self-empowerment and home-based production and processing. Perhaps she'd likewise appreciate the kind of improviser, survivalist and inventor in

insisting and being hell-bent towards finding out for myself, I have since picked up quite a lot with regards to many of these arts! For example the making of candles²⁹... I now see how great a difference such a basic skill can be in a man's life... I also appreciate that, like a good magician, Defoe's Crusoe knew to improvise; creating a lamp from animal fats where no candles could be made using wax! Surely, reading *Robinson Crusoe* is a sure must-do for any serious modern student of self-sustenance and the basics of leveraging a mindset of DIY — **Do It Yourself**.

In this regard then, Defoe's book is such a great resource, but also such a vital influence and reference for anyone seeking ways to learn about the pragmatic exercising of real, practical "superpowers" as well as walking the path towards becoming a master of one's own destiny and circumstances.

21 Feb 20, 2025 03:28:26 - Concerning Why Man Grew Weary of Dwelling in Caves

It continu'd raining all that Night, and great Part of the next Day, so that I could not stir abroad, but my Mind being more compos'd, I began to think of what I had best do, concluding that if the Island was subject to these Earthquakes, there would be no living for me in a Cave, but I must consider of building me some little Hut in an open Place which I might surround with a Wall as I had done here, and so make my self secure from wild Beasts or Men; but concluded, if I staid where I was, I should certainly, one time or other, be bury'd alive.

Great points that Daniel Defoe put across here... Essentially, we might distill a kind of theory concerning why man grew weary of dwelling in caves, and why, despite the flexibility of man-made shelters such as make-shift tents, and yet, somehow or perhaps, experience — including that of earthquakes such as Defoe mentions here — and [social] evolution[?] compels us to instead aim for buildings made of rigid walls, and also those situated out in the open.

Thus, apart from demonstrating great skill in his world building art throughout Robinson Crusoe's Adventures, we must come to conclude and appreciate that Daniel Defoe surely was also a great champion of the survival-for-the-fittest philosophy coupled with a sane dose of craftsmanship. As we hinted in **Section 18**, it really is plausible that modern-day Defoe would align well with both architects and scouts!

Crusoe or his author; Daniel Defoe!

²⁹And not just any regular candles moreover! As discussed and presented in [6], I have come to learn how to craft candles for purposes other than just providing light!

22 Apr 27, 2025 21:24:54 - On Divination Using Books or Leveraging Bibliomancy with A Bible

I daily read the Word of God, and apply'd all the Comforts of it to my present State: One Morning being very sad, I open'd the Bible upon these Words, *I will never, never leave thee, nor forsake thee*; immediately it occur'd, That these Words were to me, Why else should they be directed in such a Manner, just at the Moment when I was mourning over my Condition, as one forsaken of God and Man? Well then, said I, if God does not forsake me, of what ill Consequence can it be, or what matters it, though the World should all forsake me, seeing on the other Hand, if I had all the World, and should lose the Favour and Blessing of God, there wou'd be no Comparison in the Loss.

This lesson shared here, should educate those that didn't know, concerning how, especially in states of loneliness, hardships, and trials, it can be very useful to **make a habit of randomly opening and consulting certain kinds of books**. Among such books, and perhaps picking a leaf from the kind of authority that ancient wise men such as masons might never operate a lodge without are **the sacred scriptures**; the Bible, the Quran, the Torah, the Bhagavad-Gita etc. We here see, how, by leveraging the [christian] scriptures in the form of a bible, particularly by seeking messages from a divine power via opening the book at random pages³⁰, one arrives at certain messages as per inspiration and context. The method can without doubt be leveraged to solicit for guidance, inspiration and companionship from a higher power or perhaps directly from God! Defoe surely knew lots of fine things!

Of course, by extension, with any book available, sometimes merely opening any book at some random page and reading it when the occasion allows or necessitates it, is a very practical, ancient and magical way of arriving at answers, advice, ideas and prompts to action than merely daydreaming or locking oneself up in endless thought when faced with challenges or in states or moments of acute solitariness and brain-lock. To further break it down for the uninitiated... Essentially, without other [physical] humans hanging around with whom to directly talk or consult concerning some issue[s], one might oftentimes resort to a suitable book with high likelihood of getting useful answers than without.

The fact that this method can be extended to making consultations on virtually any topic might not be immediately obvious, however, think about it and see... One is for example a writer.. they are suddenly in need of a topic, theme or ice-breaker so as to kickstart some writing project. If one had say, children hanging around, or perhaps a crew of kindred spirits, they might turn to them

³⁰An occult artform traditionally known as "bibliomancy", and which, thanks to modern illuminates such as IoNA, one might likewise apply not just to a single book, but also an entire collection or library of them! Refer to CBD (**Cwezi Biblio Divination**) at <https://cbd.nuchwezi.com>

for ideas — brainstorming games and such. However, as with Robinson Crusoe hanging out in the remotest of spaces — with only goats, falcons and grass in sight, one must resort to “voices in print” — in case one has some books lying around that is. Thus, a writer might draw their copy of the almanac and consult that, they might randomly open a lexicon or encyclopedia, etc. Also, based on the context and topic, if I were a student of medicine in search of a solution to some mysterious ailment a client of mine showed up with, and had no idea how best to proceed, then perhaps, instead of scouting around in a herbarium — in search of a “chance” remedy³¹, I might instead pull-out a copy of the herbs-index compendium and do a CBD on that³². Moreover, and as experience might reveal, most folks simply disregard any other books and merely resort to a globally canonical text — thus the Bible³³.

Finally, and as we see being taught here, *it is naught enu'f to merely ryead the message thus receiv'd*, but one ought also take some time reflecting or meditating upon it, so as to draw forth its real power and effects.

23 Apr 27, 2025 22:00:51 - Concerning The Importance of Knowledge of Agriculture for Survival Such as via Crop-Husbandry

I had lost one whole Crop by sowing in the dry Season; but now my Crop promis'd very well, when on a sudden I found I was in Danger of losing it all again by Enemies of several Sorts, which it was scarce possible to keep from it; as First, The Goats, and wild Creatures which I call'd Hares, who tasting the Sweetness of the Blade, lay in it Night and Day, as soon as it came up, and eat it so close, that it could get no Time to shoot up into Stalk.

In this reading, we learn that indeed, man's survival on the produce of the earth calls for some thoughtful skills in managing both plants and the animals in the environment. That is essentially agriculture! We can learn from the pains Crusoe goes through here, that effective [crop] farming and generally, agriculture are more than just having knowledge of how to till the land and sow seeds! One

³¹In African medicine for example, one sometimes encounters instances of “the medicine plant that summons one to itself,” and which, when applied to the ailment at hand, does in fact result in a recovery!

³²Of course, for a matter as critical as soliciting for a treatment to a patient's ailment, some critics might wonder or argue against such seemingly [purely] stochastic methods. However, and this is important to note concerning most robust divination-based solutions and not just for bibliomancy; the effectiveness of these problem-solving methods lies not in the fact that they involve or rotate about randomness, but instead because of processes somewhat entirely mysterious; often, in the form of reliable, even though less understood, interactions between entropy, the conscious and sub-conscious mind. It is why, even for hardcore scientists, such methods, despite being empirical and many times repeatable/reproducible, are still classified as “magic”; it is not entirely clear why they might work, and yet they often do!

³³Only few books, if any, can equal the authority, breadth and potency of consulting a holy scripture!

also needs know when and how best to sow, but also how to protect or defend their yield from vermin and other tragedies!

The funny tone with which Defoe presents the important lesson might make it seem trivial, but it is not! Modern readers might for example be accustomed to the ease with which one might survive merely by dashing to the nearby supermarket or grocery shop and exchanging paper currency for fresh produce. However, not everyone is that lucky, or that, circumstances and fate could put a man in a more trying situation and environment where they must earn their food and health the *natural way*!

Thus, Defoe's book about often perilous, grueling experiences of **the Robinson Crusoe example** of a human in an *untamed* world where they have to subdue or rather, terraform a vast wilderness (an island in this case) so as to create or kick-start a civilization or rather civilised society, from scratch, is indeed a very entertaining and educing story!

Crusoe had to singlehandedly manufacture tools, devise means of both crop and animal husbandry, monitor and manage changing seasons in an environment without almanacs nor calendars and such! If a modern day person were to fill Crusoe's shoes given the circumstances he found himself in, I doubt most would survive for as long as he did, on such a wild terrain and under such involuntary solitariness. There's much to learn from Defoe's book concerning how to make the most of what we have in a much more civilized, and more endowed society as we currently find ourselves in.

Talking of which... Apart from the story not being about fantastical marvels or creatures, I start to feel, and perhaps correctly so, that ancient writers and written works such as **Homer's** *Iliad* or the *Odyssey*, or perhaps a later work such as **William Shakespeare's** *The Tempest*³⁴, inspired or had some undeniable influence on Daniel Defoe's writing and style.

24 Apr 27, 2025 23:07:33 - On Classifying Daniel Defoe as Writer

At this moment while reading [4], I started wondering what kind of classification might best befit someone like Daniel Defoe. I had some ideas, but wasn't that sure. Thus, having no better authority nor assistant in sight, I chose to put the matter before Microsoft's Copilot [3]. The following is a dump of what sort of answer that oracle offered me...

Q: Was Daniel Defoe a middle ages writer? As in, did he exist/live in so-called "middle ages"? Also, would it be right to classify him as a pre-renaissance era writer or not?

³⁴Written around 1610-1611 — nearly a century before Daniel Defoe's *Robinson Crusoe*, and which, just like Crusoe's tale, revolves around a remote island: "After the opening storm scene at sea, the rest of the play unfolds on this enchanted island where Prospero, his daughter Miranda, the spirit Ariel, and the native Caliban live. The island serves as both a literal setting and a symbolic space for themes of magic, power, betrayal, and reconciliation." [3]. Thus, it is very likely that not only did Defoe know about this earlier work by Shakespeare, but that it possibly influenced his as well.

The answer [3] offered me was this:

Daniel Defoe (c. 1660-1731) did not live during the Middle Ages. The Middle Ages, or **medieval period**, generally refers to the time between the 5th and late 15th centuries---from the fall of the Western Roman Empire (476 AD) to the beginning of the Renaissance (around the late 1400s). Defoe lived much later, in the late 17th and early 18th centuries, during the early modern period.

Similarly, he wouldn't be considered a **pre-Renaissance** writer. The Renaissance began in the 14th century and was well established by the time Defoe was born. In fact, he is often classified within the **Enlightenment** era, a period of intellectual and literary development that emphasized reason, science, and individualism. His famous novel, *Robinson Crusoe* (1719), is considered one of the earliest examples of the **modern novel**---marking a transition toward realism and detailed storytelling.

So while Defoe wasn't medieval or pre-Renaissance, he was a **pioneer in shaping the novel as a literary form**.

—Microsoft Copilot, 2025[3]

24.1 Later Note

Thus, with regards to the era in which he wrote his works, Defoe is classified as **An Enlightenment Era Writer**. As for my original confusion concerning whether or not he was in the middle ages or renaissance era, it should be noted that essentially, my confusion stems from the fact that I'm not that great a student of general history or the humanities, and so, technicalities concerning which period was called what sometimes would evade me! Before making this consultation for example, I generally thought that by "middle ages" was possibly meant "the years in the middle of the last millennium" — which would be somewhat between 1400-1700 AD. And as for the renaissance, I used to think it must be the era during which **Sir Isaac Newton** existed! Thanks Microsoft, for reeducating most of us!

Talking of education and essential literacy, I did pose the proper question to Copilot: *Overall, and by conventional technical terms and literary classification or codes, how would or should one classify the writer Daniel Defoe?* The answer [3] gave me is such:

Daniel Defoe is conventionally classified as one of the *the first true English novelists*, while also being recognized as a journalist, pamphleteer, satirist, and political commentator. His most enduring legacy lies in pioneering the modern novel through works like *Robinson Crusoe* (1719) and *Moll Flanders* (1722).

—Microsoft Copilot, 2026[3]

With which response I feel confident that my original problem is suitably settled.

25 Apr 27, 2025 23:15:10 - On Practicing Farm Magick to Ward Off Vermin

We learn of how Crusoe's attempts to grow a fair crop repeatedly met with attacks from several kinds of encroachers...

But as the Beasts ruined me before, while my Corn was in the Blade; so the Birds were as likely to ruin me now, when it was in the Ear; for going along by the Place to see how it throve, I saw my little Crop surrounded with Fowls of I know not how many sorts, who stood as it were watching till I should be gone...

and then..

This touch'd me sensibly, for I foresaw, that in a few Days they would devour all my Hopes, that I should be starv'd, and never be able to raise a Crop at all, and what to do I could not tell: However I resolv'd not to loose my Corn, if possible, tho' I should watch it Night and Day....

also..

I staid by it to load my Gun, and then coming away I could easily see the Thieves sitting upon all the Trees about me, as if they only waited till I was gone away, and the Event proved it to be so; for as I walk'd off as if I was gone, I was no sooner out of their sight, but they dropt down one by one into the Corn again. I was so provok'd that I could not have Patience to stay till more came on...

and then...

...kill'd three of them. This was what I wish'd for; so I took them up, and serv'd them as we serve notorious Thieves in England, (viz.) Hang'd them in Chains* for a Terror to others; it is impossible to imagine almost, that this should have such an Effect, as it had; for the Fowls wou'd not only not come at the Corn, but in short they forsook all that Part of the Island, and I could never see a Bird near the Place as long as my Scare-Crows hung there.

finally...

This I was very glad of, you may be sure, and about the latter end of December, which was our second Harvest of the Year, I reap'd my Crop.

25.1 Crusoe's Solution to Fighting Off Predatory Birds from Crops? Scarecrows made of Bird Carcasses! Some Strange Farm Magick!

In this part of the story, Defoe seems to entertain some magic, or actually, some black magic for the first time in this book — well, apart from the slave boy that'd exhibited oracular/mediumistic powers that is! It's a rather interesting twist away from the somewhat pious tone that had dominated Crusoe's adventures up until this point.

Also, makes one wonder.. Did Defoe actually believe that such a method as hanging dead birds in a garden or about one's property could keep others off (apart from citing the related practice of exhibiting dead human thieves in England that is). And would or could it actually work? In reality that is...

And then, talking of what could have motivated such peculiar, devious solutions as might be pleasing to sorcerous minds.. Could such a practice have roots somewhere else entirely... Somewhere much earlier.. Say, like one of those practices known to wizards and witches of the middle (but especially the "dark") ages as we often learn of them in magiclore — esp. folk magicians (pre-renaissance era), and that perhaps Defoe somewhat picked this up from such lore or comrades?

And then, back to the efficaciousness of the said practices... Would such methods work today? Would they work on today's birds, monkeys and rodents perhaps? In fact, it should really be worth practically exploring, because, in my village here in GARUGA-Bugabo, I have sometimes caught sight of stray monkeys running about in the corn fields, but also snatching ripe jackfruit from a tree at my home — for clusters sitting on branches tricky for me to access on time. Would the same method work effectively with keeping non-avian creatures (such as monkeys) off gardens and other properties too? Why is no one trying out these things anymore!

Hahaha.. Concerning hanging 3 dead thieves that are birds.. as a method to ward off others of a similar kind... **should serve well as a reminder of the**

popular crucifixion of Jesus Christ alongside two [other?] criminals.. and given we see Crusoe having made a habit of reading the Bible prior to this event, one might wonder if perhaps Jesus's crucifixion (itself a kind of *magical working?*) inspired Robinson Crusoe (Oops! I mean the author of the story, Daniel Defoe)?



Figure 5: What warding off vermin using charged scarecrows might have looked like back then.

26 Mar 1, 2025 03:26:20 - Eating Tortoise is Allowed!

June 27: I spent in cooking the Turtle; I found in her threescore Eggs; and her Flesh was to me at that Time the most savoury and pleasant that ever I tasted in my Life, having had no Flesh, but of Goats and Fowls, since I landed in this horrid Place.

Reading about Crusoe eating such peculiar game meat in this novel was my first time learning that man can actually eat turtles! No, I've seen them all my life, heard much about them too — such as how, in our Buganda folklore, a popular saying goes... *Wangala ng'enffudu ze Mengo*, literally meaning, "Live and survive as long as the tortoise does." In fact, it is very likely the answer is buried in that saying; folks around here seldom eat such beasts, and so they generally go about mostly undisturbed all their lives!

Closely related, I must disclose that I did hear of both primitive and modern hunters going after buffalo, some kinds of apes, and even humane flesh, but hardly has anyone brought up the matter of turtles being edible! **I've personally once tasted the flesh of a strange beast — a reptile unlike the shelled tortoise though — a kind of monitor lizard**³⁵, and well... Having learnt of the delicacy derived from this *Ninja Turtle* reptile... Hahaha might make lots of sense!

Overall, quite an interesting read! Moreover, that it's more delicious than goat or fish?!³⁶

³⁵No offense meant; to my friendly OB from St. Augustine's College Wakiso; the popular Ugandan music star, **Lizard** (still a member of the "reptile-stars" Jose Chameleon family) whose name later changed to "Pallaso". Refer to <https://youtu.be/mwjhp4K8eHk>

³⁶Reminded me of one maxim a teacher of mine once kept repeating to us in primary/grammar school: "Reading is like traveling," but also *Okutambula kulabba, okuda kunyumya!*, the later meaning that "Traveling is learning, so that one must tell stories of what they discovered upon return." But also that *Bwogenda e Bulya Mbwa, olya mbwa!*, which should literally mean that if you travel to where they eat bizarre meat — such as in villages of cannibals; Buikwe, Kayunga, Bulyanswa, etc. — you should expect to likewise eat what they do. Put differently... "If you visit Dogfeast, surely expect to feast on [most likely no hot] dogs!"

27 Mar 4, 2025 21:07:17 - That Solitude Frees Man from Sin and Breeds Better Souls

Now I began to construe the Words mentioned above, *Call on me, and I will deliver you*, in a different Sense from what I had ever done before; for then I had no Notion of any thing being call'd Deliverance, but my being deliver'd from the Captivity I was in; for tho' I was indeed at large in the Place, yet the Island was certainly a Prison to me, and that in the worst Sense in the World; but now I learn'd to take it in another Sense: Now I look'd back upon my past Life with such Horrour, and my Sins appear'd so dreadful, that my Soul sought nothing of God, but Deliverance from the Load of Guilt that bore down all my Comfort: As for my solitary Life it was nothing; I did not so much as pray to be deliver'd from it, or think of it; It was all of no Consideration in Comparison to this: And I add this Part here, to hint to whoever shall read it, that whenever they come to a true Sense of things, they will find Deliverance from Sin a much greater Blessing, than Deliverance from Affliction.

Very likely, such thought could have been inspired by the nature of life led by astute monastics and puritans in Defoe's era and day. Additionally, take note of the "fancifulness" of Crusoe's solitariness; he is alone yes, on an island devoid of predators, but with an abundance of prey available for himself, an absence of human neighbours nor human interference, and the freedom to be or do whatever he fancied! All that, in a pristine state of wilderness ought make one think; wasn't the author possibly **dreaming of a natural paradise on one hand or perhaps a tangible purgatory** devoid of physical affliction and fit for purging the soul of guilt [from past lives perhaps]?

Such a state would indeed readily lend itself to supporting ascendance toward a better, more natural appreciation of the divinity in raw nature. This, especially given, Defoe ensured that despite Crusoe having survived a shipwreck, he not only had the chance to return to the very ship to retrieve items from it that would help turn his imprisonment on the wild island into a little paradise, but also that he likewise managed to bring from the ship both guns for hunting and heightening his sense of security, but also the Bible; the reading of which would later turn a previously savage Crusoe into a cultured, meditative and higher spirited man!

Hahaha, **Daniel Defoe was such a clever dreamer!** Also, makes this novel start to feel like a work in some sort of Christian ministry; a creative work of evangelism!

Finally, reading just up to this moment, a more abstract point of view could be that, at the time, **Crusoe was experiencing some kind of afterlife**; that he'd actually died with the other men that couldn't survive the shipwreck, though, despite not coming across any other human soul or spirit thereafter,

his would proceed to depart from the ship and instead settle on the pristine island. His failure to see any other ships as well as his continued survival on the island over the prolonged period being some indicative proof he wasn't living in his former "reality" or "world" anymore. But, perhaps this is just one extreme POV. One needs read on so as to ascertain how factual such an analysis might be.

27.0.1 Later Note

Of course, being the kind of reader that I am, I denied myself the chance to look-ahead nor cheat by trying to find out how the story ends before actually reading it to the end. And so, as my original notes and analysis indicate or propose, I felt that perhaps, Defoe was trying to paint for the reader a picture of what Crusoe's existence in a kind of purgatory might be like, or at least, a kind of existence in a literal paradise in some sort of afterlife.

However, and actually much later, I did establish that eventually — after almost a quarter of a century in his extreme solitariness — other human spirits, in fact, [fellow converts and] comrades, did join him, and that he eventually got delivered from the "involuntary, purging prison" on the Island, finally returning to his real kin and friends in Europe — a kind of "rebirth" or "resurrection" perhaps?.

But still, and without diluting nor attacking Defoe's creativity and ingenuity, it is very possible that he had ideas of a paradise or at least an afterlife/life-after-death in mind when crafting this part of Crusoe's adventure.

28 Mar 4, 2025 21:15:29 - An Englishman In Search of Cassava!

I searched for the Cassava Root, which the Indians in all that Climate make their Bread of, but I could find none.

OMG, Defoe in the 18th century knew of cassava?! Hahaha interesting! I used to think cassava was strictly an African food unknown to folks elsewhere! In the modern world especially, I'd surely be shocked if I encountered people in say the USA or Europe being worked-up by the typically East African staple!

29 Mar 4, 2025 21:40:08 - Three Little Kittens and Nothing To-Do with Kindergarten

In this Season I was much surpriz'd with the Increase of my Family; I had been concern'd for the Loss of one of my Cats, who run away from me, or as I thought had been dead, and I heard no more Tale or Tidings of her, till to my Astonishment she came Home about the End of August, *with three Kittens*; this was the more strange to me, because tho' I had kill'd a wild Cat, as I call'd it, with my Gun; yet I thought it was a quite differing Kind from our European Cats; yet the young Cats were the same Kind of House breed like the old one; and both my Cats being Females, I thought it very strange: But from these three Cats, I afterwards came to be so pester'd with Cats, that I was forc'd to kill them like Vermine, or wild Beasts, and to drive them from my House as much as possible.

I love cats and this was so much fun to read!

For starters, I hardly keep any directly inside my house as pets, instead, and especially because my home is somewhat partly open to the wild and that both cats and dogs from the neighborhood can walk in and out any time, I too feel for Crusoe's concern with a sudden abundance of wild felines! Moreover, for his case, seems like he actually did what I would not want to dare — killing a cat!³⁷

Magic and sorcery aside, at the mention of **three kittens**, my imagination quickly ran to the matter of popular kindergarten lullaby “3 Little Kittens”. I wonder, could the lullaby have been known to Defoe and that he was perhaps remotely referring to it?

29.1 Later Note

Concerning the final point in the above review note; did you notice that we had already encountered “3 Kittens” about two months before this — refer to the February 8, 2026 MAZERA Pre-Valentine concert highlighted in **Section 15.1**. I just realized that, though, during that concert I most likely never cited nor referenced Defoe's musings on cats nor his three kittens, and yet, the book was indeed used as a source for the “Literature Moments” that were part of the melodic metal performance! In retrospect then, I surely see how strong a force

³⁷First, my *Bunyoro* family pet-name “Abwoli” essentially means “cat”. That gives cats a **totem-animal** or **kindred animal spirit** status for me. Second, and commonly believed across cultures here in Uganda (but possibly elsewhere too); that killing a cat can readily translate into bad omen despite the general belief that “cats have 9 lives” — so that, often-times, attempts to kill one fails, unless when its multiple lives have been finally exhausted! And then finally, it is common in *Cwezi folklore* that certain types of wizards, sorcerers and magicians — including so-called “night-stalkers”, *basezi* — readily morph/shape-shift into and can walk around either at night or during day, in the form of a cat. Thus, attempts to kill one might turn out to be an attempt at attacking someone very spiritually and/or magically powerful in the neighborhood!

it must be that originally drew me to reading [and reviewing] Daniel Defoe!³⁸

30 Mar 4, 2025 21:59:49 - Finally Understood How to Use ‘Dinner’

From the fourteenth of August to the twenty sixth, incessant Rain, so that I could not stir, and was now very careful not to be much wet. In this Confinement I began to be straitned for Food, but venturing out twice, I one Day kill'd a Goat, and the last Day, which was the twenty sixth, found a very large Tortoise, which was a Treat to me, and my Food was regulated thus; I eat a Bunch of Raisins for my Breakfast, a Piece of the Goat's Flesh, or of the Turtle for my Dinner broil'd; for to my great Misfortune, I had no Vessel to boil or stew any Thing; and two or three of the Turtle's Eggs for my Supper.

Basically, until reading this, I never knew that “dinner” applied both to lunch and well.. *usual* dinner! Or rather, and interesting to note; the use of ‘dinner’ to mean a meal —whether large or small, though my dictionary claims it typically implies “main meal of the day” — taken at or close to midday — that is, during daytime — seems so rare³⁹ nowadays! Why have I hardly come across such usage of the term nearly all of my (close to 40 years of) life!

Also, now that I know the actual difference between ‘dinner’ and ‘supper’, it’s interesting to see how Defoe used the later word to mean Crusoe’s “lighter meal of tortoise eggs!”

My favorite dictionary (mobile **WordWeb**) defines supper thus:

Noun: **supper** —sú-pu— 1. A light evening meal; served in early evening if dinner is at midday or served late in the evening at bedtime. 2. A social gathering where a light evening meal is served

Example: Her suppers often included celebrities.

Derived:

Verb: sup | **Adjective:** supperless

³⁸In fact, talking of what the likes of late, 20th century Swiss Psychoanalyst **Carl G. Jung** might refer to as “synchronicities”, I now appreciate how strong a synchronicity it must be, that despite not having ever given attention to who even wrote *Robinson Crusoe* before I revisited the book in 2025 (refer to **Section 3**), and yet, subconsciously perhaps, I did feature a “Daniel” — as “Dan” — in my first full-length novel — *Shrines of The Free Men* (2018,2023) [5], in whose story Dan happens to be the embattled elder brother of the protagonist, Ignatius Irumba.

³⁹Beware... I have grown up and mostly spent much of my adult life in Africa, though not in rural Africa where the proper use of English is usually generally missing. But still, the overall atmosphere here is that folks mostly stick to the most “usual” of vocabularies, and that even for such common words as “dinner” and “supper”, non-literati might stay away from scrutinizing which should be used when in case either can be used interchangeably.

30.1 Later Note

Finally, before we leave the topic of what Crusoe typically enjoyed for meals — during his exile years on the island that is — it should be worth bringing up the surprisingly missing treatment (on the part of Defoe's Reviewer, given the author of this novel endeavored to be nearly exhaustive concerning Crusoe's tale) of the matter of *missing salt and sugar!*

Essentially, one finds that, despite the nearly exhaustive coverage of all aspects of the man's life while on the island, and yet, nowhere in this review do we find, nor can we readily establish how Crusoe, a seemingly civilized English man, survived in the wild for more than a quarter of a century, without any sources of sugar or salt. It can't be that he suddenly had resorted to a saltless and sugarless diet — especially very unlikely for a man who'd come to the island after having stayed in the Brasils for a significant time, investing in sugarcane plantations. But, well, for sugar, perhaps the fact that he encountered goats on the island, and that he not only domesticated them for their meat, but likewise milked them, might explain away the craving or want of sugar — **goat's milk is already too sweet** as we discuss in **Section 41** — and it is likely he could use it for his bread baking needs too⁴⁰.

And what of salt then? Did Robinson Crusoe eat [sun-dried or perhaps roasted] goat's meat without adding any salt to it? In the excerpt being reviewed here, we of course learn that Crusoe had not yet afforded a means to boil or prepare a stew — thus, neither vegetable nor goat meat's soup — but still, assuming he finally managed to get pots or bowls (as we later learn he managed to make), would he settle for stew without salt in it, or could it be that he might have used sea-water⁴¹...

Interesting analysis and criticism? Yes? No? But anyways... Without becoming a spoiler for those that haven't actually invested the necessary effort to sit and savor Daniel Defoe's *Robinson Crusoe*, note that the above is in fact all futile criticism when applied to Defoe! **That man knew how to cover all ends...** Future-proof, fool-proof story-telling and all! But also, and as we criticize in **Section 16**, Defoe over-pampered his characters! Thus, in [4], we shall find that, not only did Crusoe manage to find and retrieve boxes of sugar from the wreck of a ship he had not even been a sailor on, but that he likewise obtained salt, alcohol, knives, more guns and powder, clothes, etc. It would feel like, for Defoe, once a problem or need arose concerning how Crusoe should survive on a remote and isolated island, he would leverage his **Writer's God-Powers**, and BIG bang! A ship would show up over the horizon, and it would partly shatter over a rock so as to kill off all the sailors, but delay or wait long enough without sinking, and not so far off the coast, so that a wanting Crusoe should be able to quickly grab his improvised canoe and sail over to the wreck,

⁴⁰Concerning Crusoe's fascination with not only the making of pots and bowls for the preparation of soups and stew, but also his ability to make an oven and likewise bake and avail himself with bread, these, as well as several other interesting aspects of his adventures, the interested reader should find in the book — [4]

⁴¹For Ugandan readers of *Robinson Crusoe*, several things should or might remain ever confusing or out of reach. For example, we typically think of most natural water bodies as being "fresh-water" bodies — rivers, lakes, wells and streams, etc. The country has no direct access to a standard ocean or sea, and thus, salted water, despite being in places such as **Lake Katwe**, and yet, we hardly know of typical Ocean Water, but have perhaps heard that it is salty... Perhaps, and very likely, Crusoe used that, and that for Defoe, an English man whose country is surrounded by such ocean water, it was too obvious. No need to be mentioned?

retrieve as much as he can from the “floating supermarket,” and then gleefully return to the island a magician in his prime-time! So magical, so fantastical — and as dreamy a life as one in the after-life should perhaps be⁴².

31 Aug 23, 2025 21:57:31 - Concerning How Robinson Crusoe Sometimes Acted Like a Brute

Then I measur'd the Distance of Ground, and resolv'd to cut a Dock, or Canal, to bring the Water up to the Canoe, seeing I could not bring the Canoe down to the Water: Well, I began this Work, and when I began to enter into it, and calculate how deep it was to be dug, how broad, how the Stuff to be thrown out, I found, That by the Number of Hands I had, being none but my own, it must have been ten or twelve Years before I should have gone through with it; for the Shore lay high, so that at the upper End, it must have been at least twenty Foot Deep; so at length, tho' with great Reluctancy, I gave this Attempt over also.

and..

This griev'd me heartily, and now I saw, tho' too late, the Folly of beginning a Work before we count the Cost; and before we judge rightly of our own Strength to go through with it.

So, sometimes Defoe depicts his protagonist as though it were some kind of Hercules, but also as a laughable brute!

In this excerpt, we see how, so desperate to escape from the Island, Robinson once toiled thoughtlessly for months making a boat from a huge cedar tree he'd fallen, only to realize that the only way to get it to sea was to manually dig a canal from the sea to where the boat was — something totally absurd to be attempted by a single man alone.

⁴²Also see **Section 27** for a related discussion concerning the novel, and then, for a wider, broader treatment of the topic, refer to the reviewer's own cover of the interestingly related topic: *Occult Philosophy: Concerning Work in Heaven: Interview of Psymaz Magina (IoN) by Fra. Markov (OTO)*, an interview that also relates to the work in [5], and which interview one might access (~ 30 Min), via either MAZERA's online museum:

<https://t.me/mazeraworks/789>

or via YouTube:

<https://youtu.be/rxzU2JZ1toI>

32 Aug 23, 2025 22:03:21 - Numerous Fruits One Could Reap from Bible Study Alone!

I finish'd my fourth Year in this Place, and kept my Anniversary with the same Devotion, and with as much Comfort as ever before; for by a constant Study, and serious Application of the Word of God, and by the Assistance of his Grace, I gain'd a different Knowledge from what I had before. I entertain'd different Notions of Things.

Building upon what we have already discussed in **Section 22**, we should further appreciate Defoe's emphasis on the value that access-to and study of the scriptures alone can have on a man's life; the certain increase of his knowledge and wisdom, but also spiritual maturity.

33 Aug 23, 2025 22:22:13 - How Having a Knife Lifts Man from The State of Being a Beast

That if I had kill'd a Goat, or a Fowl, by any Contrivance, I had no way to flea or open them, or part the Flesh from the Skin, and the Bowels, or to cut it up; but must gnaw it with my Teeth, and pull it with my Claws like a Beast.

33.1 Later Note

You've indeed gone out to hunt or seek for food in the wilderness... you luckily manage to strike an unsuspecting wild goose or young deer with a piece of rock and can then take it home for dinner. However, and as we see in the puzzled state Crusoe finds himself in, you neither have a sword nor knife with which to slay the animal. For a bird — such as for wild fowl or a chicken perhaps, one might pluck it using bare hands and also tear it apart so as to rid it of its entrails. But try to fathom preparing a deer, a goat or a buffalo, without a blade in sight!

So, surely, as we've come to appreciate while reading *Robinson Crusoe*, man's survival but also civility does have much to do with our knowledge, but also the ability to leverage that to simplify and edify our approach to solving basic problems — problems that other members of the jungle called "Earth" likewise face; lions, hyenas, vultures and such [that must likewise feast on their prey], but which, for man, **as with our ability to wield and harness fire or flames**, we approach and overcome, not as beasts would, but *as humans should!*

Talking of wielding and harnessing tools such as knives; it should not come as a surprise to students and practitioners of especially western esotericism, that among essential and relevant basic tools that a seasoned and well-prepared

magician must endeavor to have upon their operating altar during any rituals (and these often have nothing to do with operating on anything physical) is **the dagger**⁴³. By having the blade⁴⁴ among other basic tools essential for a civilized man to commune with and effectively operate at a sublime (read “spiritual”) level, we surely must understand and appreciate Defoe’s claim that operating with one’s claws — unaided hands that is — like a beast, is something to be frowned upon, and the wise person better learn to craft⁴⁵ and wield the relevant tools that since antiquity have served to endow humans with prowess even lions and haughty bears can’t diminish.

34 Sep 20, 2025 00:40:37 - A Lesson in Being Grateful

Thus we never see the true State of our Condition,
till it is illustrated to us by its Contraries; nor know
how to value what we enjoy, but by the want of it.

34.1 Later Note

Not much needs be said concerning this; who doesn’t thank or appreciate what they have or get needs not have nor be given any more! And talking of which, if I could come across Daniel Defoe in this day and time, having seen all the gems he laid bare in his book for generations of future readers but also his contemporaries, I should have to honestly thank him, and if in literal words, with the suitable utterance; **SKNAHT**.

⁴³In modern technical occultlore, especially among **Ceremonial Magicians** such as the likes of **Aleister Crowley**, **Donald Michael Kraig**, **Anton Szandor LaVey** and others, it is more common to speak of **the athame**.

⁴⁴Some occult traditions might likewise or even alternatively recommend having a sword — possibly reminiscent of the ethos of the Templar Knights!

⁴⁵In my native Ugandan culture among the *Banyorokati* and especially the *Cwezi*, men and women that knew or possessed knowledge of how to create blades — knives, spears, daggers, sickles, etc. — were traditionally respected and even honored with a status akin to that of demigods since ancient times. Traditionally, we refer to such blacksmiths or iron-smiths as *bafumu* — meaning “spear-like” or “of the spear”, or *bahesi* — “smiths”, but also “givers” or “providers”, and these are among the kinds of people that traditionally were held in high regard among any kingdom’s high caste or priesthood lineages. I trust, this respect hasn’t declined any less even in the modern world where the production of weapons and tools is mostly mediated by automated production via assembly lines. Also, and even in the modern, first-world western world, a sane dose of traditional tool makers such as craftsmen focusing on producing magical blades and special kinds of iron-smithing still exist: a good example I admire is <https://YouTube.com/@TrollCunningForge>, an esoteric blacksmith.

35 Dec 21, 2025 16:06:12 - In Obscure Vocabulary: 'Rivulet' and 'Brook'

I came to a very good Inlet or Bay about a Mile over, which narrowed till it came to a very little Rivulet or Brook, where I found a very convenient Harbour for my Boat and where she lay as if she had been in a little Dock made on Purpose for her. Here I put in, and having stow'd my Boat very safe, I went on Shore to look about me and see where I was.

35.1 Later Note

I'm not sure if it is because English is so widely spoken or that the influence and reach of the British empire is so wide⁴⁶. However, as a non-native English speaker and student, I many times marvel at the vastness of the English vocabulary when I try to compare it to our [African] languages; Luganda and Runyoro being few of native Ugandan languages I have dared to write literature works in⁴⁷. As I established, but also argued in my review concerning how language, words and symbols have [transformative] powers on humans⁴⁸, it is humbling, realizing how limited our native language vocabularies are in comparison to languages such as English. It means, if we are to agree with philosophical claims such as "language limits and defines the breadth and richness of perception and expression," then, it is possible that when a typical African schooled only in their native language were to walk out into a jungle, and after a day, return to share their experiences with kinsmen Vs an Englishman that likewise walks the same terrain for a day and then returns to share their experience — especially in writing, then, it could be the case that we should find that the African had seen or experienced lesser than the Englishman, yet they both had stepped-into and lived the same experience and phenomenon⁴⁹!

⁴⁶In the past, I've encountered "classical" descriptions of the British empire such as *The empire on which the sun never sets* — [3] clarified to me that it actually was originally coined by **Sir Francis Bacon** (1626) in relation to the then vast Spanish empire (16th-17th centuries), however, it later was adapted by **Earl George Macartney** (1773) for the (18th century+...) globally expanded British empire for which it was boasted (esp. during Queen Victoria's 19th century reign) that **at any given time, daylight shines on at least one of the British empire territories!**

⁴⁷Refer to **About Reviewer**, but also checkout highlights of such works via his Telegram literature archives: <https://t.me/wwwrite>

⁴⁸Refer to **Notable Earlier Reviews**, particularly the work titled "Concerning a transformative power in certain symbols, letters and words."

⁴⁹For a fair illustration of this, particularly using the very words being featured in our current book excerpt, note that, the terms "river", "tributary", "stream", "spring", "rivulet" and "brook" all are related by the fact that they refer to certain descriptions of a flowing body of water. However, it is worth acknowledging that they can't be used interchangeably; to the seasoned speaker, reader and Englishman, they mean entirely distinct things! Compared to knowledge I have of my native African languages, I find that for the case of Luganda as an example, all I know about such a concept is the word *omuga* — which could only equate to "river" given the list of terms we have highlighted. And equivalently, in Runyoro-Runyakitara, I only know of *omugera*! Thus, and in utter desperation, I accept that, if I were to paint a picture of what I've experienced using only my [native] African languages, I surely would paint

Before we leave this discussion, it shall be worth leaving this advice here for young and prospective writers of English literature;

1. Reading classics, such as this work by Daniel Defoe, is a guaranteed way to come to appreciate, but also soak up much of what we have otherwise lost over time and across generations as language, culture and traditions morphed, became mutilated, and as oftentimes happens, became fused and less distinct. For example, reading the literal or unaltered editions of *Robinson Crusoe* brings forth a style of English that is difficult to encounter in modern times both as written, but also as spoken or performed literature! So-called *Olde Englysh*.
2. As King advises in [1], reading a lot [of different things], but also reading other people's works, is vital to growing, as well as also sustaining a rich appreciation of vast vocabulary, style and worldviews essential to manifesting great literature.
3. Emulation, or rather imitation, is a credible other way to soak up what was great or laudable elsewhere or in other times — and likewise part of the advice King offers in [1]; a young writer can acquire much via [first] imitating the examples of greater, more experienced writers [than not].

36 Dec 21, 2025 16:31:47 - Concerning The Relevance of Keeping Non-Human Partners Such as [Bird] Pets

We learn of Crusoe's encountering of a talking parrot. It roused him from sleep one time...

But judge you, if you can, that read my Story, what a Surprise I must be in, when I was wak'd out of my Sleep by a Voice calling me by my Name several times, Robin, Robin, Robin Crusoe, poor Robin Crusoe, where are you Robin Crusoe? Where are you? Where have you been?..

and then..

such a monotonous and monochromatic picture it might be argued that I were perhaps either partially blind or perhaps color blind!

dozing between sleeping and waking, thought I dream'd that some Body spoke to me: But as the Voice continu'd to repeat Robin Crusoe, Robin Crusoe, at last I began to wake more perfectly, and was at first dreadfully frightened, and started up in the utmost Consternation: But no sooner were my Eyes open, but I saw my Poll sitting on the Top of the Hedge; and immediately knew that it was he that spoke to me; for just in such bemoaning Language I had used to talk to him, and teach him; and he had learn'd it so perfectly, that he would sit upon my Finger, and lay his Bill close to my Face, and cry, Poor Robin Crusoe, Where are you? Where have you been? How come you here? And such things as I had taught him.

but also that..

However, even though I knew it was the Parrot, and that indeed it could be no Body else, it was a good while before I could compose my self: First, I was amazed how the Creature got thither, and then, how he should just keep about the Place, and no where else: But as I was well satisfied it could be no Body but honest Poll, I got it over; and holding out my Hand, and calling him by his Name Poll, the sociable Creature came to me, and sat upon my Thumb, as he used to do, and continu'd talking to me, Poor Robin Crusoe, and how did I come here? and where had I been? just as if he had been overjoy'd to see me again; and so I carry'd him Home along with me.

We thus come to appreciate how rewarding it can be to have an animal or any non-human partner⁵⁰ that can not only listen to our chatter when we are lonely or living alone, but who can also learn to talk back to us!

That parrots make for great companions in that regard is surely laid bare in Defoe's testimony here. Moreover, my own experience living not on a remote island but instead finding that a somewhat significant portion of my life (much of the period since 2018) has been spent living at my home in Garuga, on my own⁵¹, and with the house surrounded by trees to which several different kinds of bird species enjoy coming and where I established they love to spend much of their daytime from.. singing, pecking and fluttering about in the branches while I listen and go about my routines, sometimes likewise whistling back in

⁵⁰I likewise appeal to non-human or artificial partners here because, as I argued in my extensive research [a masters dissertation] on **human support assistants** in the form of physical robots but also software bots — refer to the paper *VOSA: A Reusable and Reconfigurable Voice Operated Support Assistant Chatbot Platform* (Lutalo, 2024) — it can be therapeutic, satisfying, and perhaps even cheaper to have an automaton that can not only talk to a human, but also which can listen and perhaps even prompt the human via voice interactions!

⁵¹Not married yet and most of my immediate neighbours a good distance away.

response to their bustle.

I have come to notice that several birds — actually, mostly a particular species of a red-chested, black back, and whitish beak aspect — enjoy to wake me up in the morning, but also to startle me during those quiet moments of the day as I go about my serene computer programming, reading or writing tasks. Sometimes others mimic special stylistic whistles I like to make as signals to specific friendly kids in the not-so-far-away neighborhood — these go something like attempting to call one's name using just a whistle⁵². But also, and still such a shocking phenomena to me, sometimes a bird or two persistently cry-out a song or a call that somewhat sounds like either my middle name “Willrich” or that of my son, “Theo!” In fact, I've occasionally also heard them call-out “Eva” — very startling⁵³ because that's the name of my longtime friend and mother of my first two kids including Theo.

37 Dec 21, 2025 16:50:36 - On The Difficulty of Finding Anything Equal to Human Neighbors or Social Life

In this Government of my Temper, I remain'd near a Year, liv'd a very sedate retir'd Life, as you may well suppose; and my Thoughts being very much composed as to my Condition, and fully comforted in resigning my self to the Dispositions of Providence, I thought I liv'd really very happily in all things, except that of Society.

Essentially, this should be taken as a lesson on why, no matter how comfortable a human's life is — with nature and divine providence availing most of life's desirable things — and yet, life will still feel incomplete without society or human neighbours. These warnings should of course make more sense to today's and tomorrow's readers and audiences that are increasingly made of humans living in not only remote places such as Crusoe did — such as astronauts on the International Space Station — but also who are increasingly surrounded by artificial companions and environments.

⁵²I especially like to whistle the names “Anna” or “Imelda”, sometimes also “Elijah” because he's often so jolly and reactive to these calls.

⁵³In fact “bizarre” would be more befitting; not only are there no immediate neighbours that perhaps I would call-to using any of those names, but also that, Theo and his mother haven't been at my home almost all through those years.. So, how on Earth these birds mimic names and sounds I never use nor taught them further makes me appreciate the queer experience Crusoe enjoyed with Poll, a parrot that he nonetheless trained.

38 Dec 21, 2025 16:55:11 - Concerning The Relevance of Smoking

But I think I was never more vain of my own Performance, or more joyful for any thing I found out, than for my being able to make a Tobacco-Pipe. And tho' it was a very ugly clumsy thing, when it was done, and only burnt red like other Earthen Ware, yet as it was hard and firm, and would draw the Smoke, I was exceedingly comforted with it, for I had been always used to smoke, and there were Pipes in the Ship, but I forgot them at first, not knowing that there was Tobacco in the Island; and afterwards, when I search'd the Ship again, I could not come at any Pipes at all.

It should not come off as though either I or Defoe were advocating for nor championing relentless, thoughtless reversion⁵⁴ to smoking — such as of tobacco, or, and as I would instead recommend, cannabis — but that, **oftentimes a man might find much meaning in a little bit of smoking**. Defoe seems to especially appeal to smoking using a pipe — makes sense, especially for a man in an unconventional environment without ready or easy access to paraphernalia such as rolling paper, glue and such. I personally once bought an elegant smoking pipe while on a work trip in Addis Ababa — it was shaped as a maiden facing the smoker, with her head as the opening where one would insert the leaves or payload, and with the smoking end provocatively positioned betwixt her spread legs. I bought this as a take-home relic at a souvenir shop in the Bole neighborhood where I'd also met lots of smoky international friends and girlfriends. However, upon my return to Uganda, I somewhat found myself at a loss of what to do with it... I had not grown up with smoking fellows or grandparents most of my family being straight and puritan Catholics, and so, not used to the practice, instead offered the peculiar pipe to a friendly shaman, **Jajja Malinzi**, of Eastern-Uganda descent. However, I still find that occasionally, such as on lone Sunday afternoons while walking out in a meditative state and enjoying raw nature in the neighborhood of Lake Victoria, that it does make lots of sense to bring along a cigarette or perhaps a small bottle of gin spirit so as to complete the experience.

Thus, seems that Defoe is appealing to this gentleman's practice as something that can surely make up for a lot of what's missing when a man must or often finds himself living [in paradise but] alone.

⁵⁴The word "reversion" should be acceptable here, because, as one finds when growing up past juvenile and chaotic youthful years, smoking, which is also a renown health hazard and which, just like the drinking of alcohol can readily become both addictive and abusive, is a practice that one should learn, and can learn to replace or outgrow — just like a toddler eventually must outgrow their yearning for a mother's breast or milk. Depending on nurture and culture, one could pick up [healthier] alternatives such as meditation, dancing, singing, prayer, reading, etc. However, and this we might never come to lasting agreement about, smoking or rather, mind-altering, does have its rightful place in civilized human life and culture, so that, the wise only need learn how to properly leverage or apply it, and in sane moderation that is.

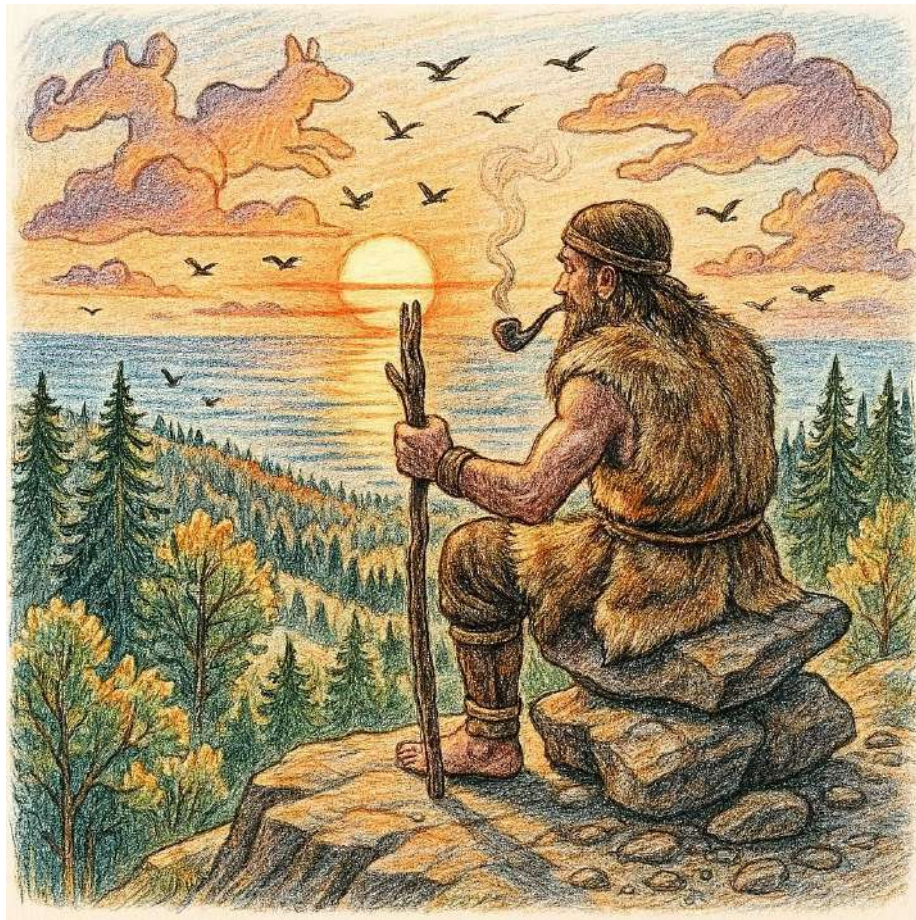


Figure 6: Imagining Crusoe on his island, exploring by observation and thought, the finer aspects of life in a world where he is the sole operator.

39 Dec 21, 2025 17:09:15 - On The Manner of Domesticating Originally Wild Goats

At length I set three Traps in one Night, and going the next Morning I found them all standing, and yet the Bait eaten and gone: This was very discouraging. However, I alter'd my Trap, and, not to trouble you with Particulars, going one Morning to see my Trap, I found in one of them a large old He-Goat, and in one of the other, three Kids, a Male and two Females.

Also..

As to the old one, I knew not what to do with him, he was so fierce I durst not go into the Pit to him; that is to say, to go about to bring him away alive, which was what I wanted. I could have kill'd him, but that was not my Business, nor would it answer my End. So I e'en let him out, and he ran away as if he had been frightened out of his Wits: But I had forgot then what I learn'd afterwards, that Hunger will tame a Lyon. If I had let him stay there three or four Days without Food, and then have carry'd him some Water to drink, and then a little Corn, he would have been as tame as one of the Kids

The great lesson for me here was that first of all, it had never occurred to me that goats originally were beasts of the wild — many modern kids might never appreciate this, not even here in Africa where the distant cousins of the species potentially still thrive in the wilderness. Secondly, and given what I know of some ferocious goat species⁵⁵ we have around in Uganda — such as so-called “Mubende Goats” — that these can be subdued via thoughtful containment and rationing⁵⁶.

40 Dec 21, 2025 17:14:46 - To Hunt or Instead Domesticate Game?

It was a good while before they wou'd feed, but throwing them some sweet Corn, it tempted them and they began to be tame; and now I found that if I expected to supply my self with Goat-Flesh when I had no Powder or Shot left, breeding some up tame was my only way, when perhaps I might have them about my House like a Flock of Sheep.

and also..

⁵⁵Sometimes it hits me as rather funny if not absurd, that a species incapable of eating meat — that is, a herbivorous animal — should have such a ruffian and provocative aspect as some species of goats do. In my mind, most herbivores ought be as sluggish and as mundane as pigs, hippopotamuses and elephants are. However, on the other hand, should be that nature and evolution saw it fit for these *grass-eating* creatures to keep some level of heightened aggressiveness so unlike what one might even find in carnivorous kinds such as cats and dogs — that they actually have horns instead of razor-sharp canines, and that they can leverage mass and speed to take on most kinds of predatory species with little effort!

⁵⁶My elder, a professor with experience in the domain of Animal Science, and whose PhD actually concerned goats, should perhaps correct me on this analysis and conclusion in case I am mistaken.

But then it presently occur'd to me, that I must keep the tame from the wild, or else they would always run wild when they grew up, and the only Way for this was to have some enclosed Piece of Ground, well fenc'd either with Hedge or Pale, to keep them in so effectually, that those within might not break out, or those without break in.

Realizing and weighing the cost and troubles involved in having to repeatedly rely on game meat — that is, food one must venture out into the wild for, sometimes with reliance on mere luck — we see that a thoughtful Crusoe finally decided it was better to domesticate than go hunting every other time. For a person that's tasted civilized life before, it surely would make lots of sense, and not only for animals, but also crops too. Otherwise, relying on meat and crop under the forces of nature in the wild could eventually turn out to be wasteful, unsustainable, but also unnecessarily expensive.

It has probably taken humans millenia and centuries to arrive at the level of civility, sophistication and convenience we nowadays might take for granted, however, attempts to foil contemporary societal order and instead demand reversion to ancient hunter-gathering ethos could leave most of modern humans at the mercy of the elements, so that millions, if not billions, might suddenly perish because of lack of the skill and experience to thrive and survive under chaos.

41 Dec 21, 2025 17:26:39 - Breeding Goats for both Meat and Milk

But this was not all, for now I not only had Goats Flesh to feed on when I pleas'd, but Milk too, a thing which indeed in my beginning I did not so much as think of, and which, when it came into my Thoughts, was really an agreeable Surprise. For now I set up my Dairy, and had sometimes a Gallon or two of Milk in a Day.

and...

And as Nature, who gives Supplies of Food to every Creature, dictates even naturally how to make use of it; so I that had never milk'd a Cow, much less a Goat, or seen Butter or Cheese made, very readily and handily, tho' after a great many Essays and Mis-carriages, made me both Butter and Cheese at last, and never wanted it afterwards.

41.1 Later Note

I found this quite interesting because, though I have had the chance to enjoy goat's milk at least once during my childhood — and it tasted awfully oversweet compared to “normal” cow milk — I must confess that in my part of the world, such a practice is very difficult to come by; folks generally only rare goats for their meat, blood and intestines⁵⁷, and that's all. It is actually quite hard to come by goats milk as a dairy product — one might go scouting the shops and large supermarkets for such, and find that despite all kinds of rarities that thrive in the processed food sections of many markets these days, a goat's milk is almost impossible to come across!

42 Dec 21, 2025 17:49:09 - Concerning Robinson Crusoe's Queer Cosplay and DIY Apparels

Let's see what Defoe tells us of Crusoe's fashion statements while in exile on his island empire..

But had any one in England been to meet such a Man as I was, it must either have frightened them, or rais'd a great deal of Laughter; and as I frequently stood still to look at my self, I could not but smile at the Notion of my travelling through Yorkshire with such an Equipage, and in such a Dress..

and..

I had a great high shapeless Cap, made of a Goat's Skin, with a Flap hanging down behind, as well to keep the Sun from me, as to shoot the Rain of f from running into my Neck; nothing being so hurtful in these Climates, as the Rain upon the Flesh under the Cloaths.

then...

⁵⁷It is quite a common delicacy in Uganda; the goat's entrails are extracted, cleaned thoroughly, and then the tiny colon pipes are plaited into thicker ropes which, when later cooked and served, feel like eating edible umami ropes!

I had a short Jacket of Goat-Skin, the Skirts coming down to about the middle of my Thighs; and a Pair of open-knee'd Breeches of the same, the Breeches were made of the Skin of an old He-goat, whose Hair hung down such a Length on either Side, that like Pantaloons it reach'd to the middle of my Legs; Stockings and Shoes I had none, but had made me a Pair of some-things, I scarce know what to call them, like Buskins to flap over my Legs, and lace on either Side like Spatter-dashes; but of a most barbarous Shape, as indeed were all the rest of my Cloaths.

and..

I had on a broad Belt of Goat's-Skin dry'd, which I drew together with two Thongs of the same, instead of Buckles, and in a kind of a Frog on either Side of this. Instead of a Sword and a Dagger, hung a little Saw and a Hatchet, one on one Side, one on the other. I had another Belt not so broad, and fasten'd in the same Manner, which hung over my Shoulder; and at the End of it, under my left Arm, hung two Pouches, both made of Goat's-Skin too; in one of which hung my Powder, in the other my Shot: At my Back I carry'd my Basket, on my Shoulder my Gun, and over my Head a great clumsy ugly Goat-Skin Umbrella, but which, after all, was the most necessary Thing I had about me, next to my Gun..

We see and learn here, how it is that without [processed] cotton fiber nor the convenience of ordinary synthetic fiber, a man surviving in the wild can make for themselves a satisfactory, albeit bizarre assortment of clothing (everything from shoes, belts to jackets and capes) using mostly the hides or skins of animals.

It is interesting to note, concerning the described vestments here, that such clothing — particularly those [hand-made] using animal hides — when encountered in modern times (such as in modern day UGANDA), are often either associated with barbaric native African witch-doctors, or as formal [cultural] wear only afforded by royals such as the king of the Ganda people when he dresses up for formal ceremonies and ritual — typically with a leopard's skin for both a mat/carpet upon which his feet rest, but also for the jacket wrapped about him. Also, folks that show up in public dressed this way would perhaps be the kind that wish to appeal to the “demigods” and chimeras (half human, half beast) of ancient lore⁵⁸.

42.1 Later Note

First, this got me thinking, and wondering... **When, how and why did humans actually start to wear clothes instead of being in the nude**

⁵⁸Talking of “magical” or “ritual” vestments or garments, note that the reviewer has covered this topic to great depth in **Chapter 5** of [6].

like animals? Of course, there is the “simple” answer one might catch being passed around that’s based on the book of **Genesis 3:7**:

Then the eyes of both of them were opened, and they realized they were naked; so they sewed fig leaves together and made coverings for themselves.

—**Genesis 3:7**

Thus we learn from scriptures that the earliest reference to clothing for humans were actually made of plant material, and this, after humans perhaps became aware [or perhaps guilty] of the *weirdness* of being naked! Moreover, we also find that, they later advanced to clothing made of more durable animal skin/hides, and that this was a God-given upgrade:

The Lord God made garments of skin for Adam and his wife and clothed them.

—**Genesis 3:21**

I can’t tell if Defoe’s treatment of Crusoe’s invention of clothing was or was not inspired by the references in scripture, but who knows?

Otherwise, a consultation with [3] revealed the following facts to me concerning man’s invention and evolution of clothing:

Humans began wearing clothes tens of thousands of years ago, most likely between 83,000 and 170,000 years ago, as a survival adaptation to colder climates. Evidence comes not from preserved garments but from genetic studies of clothing lice, which evolved once humans started wearing clothes.

As anatomically modern humans migrated out of Africa into colder regions, clothing became essential for warmth and protection. Clothes shielded against rain, wind, and sun, as well as insects and rough terrain.

Over time, clothing also became a marker of identity, status, and ritual.

Genetic analysis shows clothing lice diverged from head lice 83,000-170,000 years ago, indicating humans were already wearing clothes by then. Scrappers used for preparing animal hides date back to ~780,000 years ago, though this doesn’t prove clothing use --- hides may have been used for shelter. The earliest woven textiles appear much later, around 30,000 years ago, with evidence of flax fibers and netting.

—**Microsoft Copilot, 2026[3]**

43 Dec 21, 2025 18:13:21 - Horror and Mysterious Sightings of Big-Foot?

For years and months, Crusoe dwelt on his island all by himself, never to see even the slightest hint of any human encroachment and neither signs that any would approach via ship or boat. And then, suddenly, one day, this happens...

It happen'd one Day about Noon going towards my Boat, I was exceedingly surpriz'd with the Print of a Man's naked Foot on the Shore, which was very plain to be seen in the Sand: I stood like one Thunder-struck, or as if I had seen an Apparition; I listen'd, I look'd round me, I could hear nothing, nor see any Thing, I went up to a rising Ground to look farther, I went up the Shore and down the Shore, but it was all one, I could see no other Impression but that one, I went to it again to see if there were any more, and to observe if it might not be my Fancy; but there was no Room for that, for there was exactly the very Print of a Foot, Toes, Heel, and every Part of a Foot; how it came thither, I knew not, nor could in the least imagine.

and...

But after innumerable fluttering Thoughts, like a Man perfectly confus'd and out of my self, I came Home to my Fortification, not feeling, as we say, the Ground I went on, but terrify'd to the last Degree, looking behind me at every two or three Steps, mistaking every Bush and Tree, and fancying every Stump at a Distance to be a Man; nor is it possible to describe how many various Shapes affrighted Imagination represented Things to me in, how many wild Ideas were found every Moment in my Fancy, and what strange unaccountable Whimsies came into my Thoughts by the Way.

Talking of Apparitions and Horrors.. Of course, this saga brought back childhood memories of stories about Big Foot from vintage magazines about UFOs, aliens and fringe occurrences such as the mysteries of **Devonshire!** And well, relating to this, one might wonder, after reading this, could the modern Big-Foot myths⁵⁹ (perhaps of the 1960s and 70s) have been inspired by readers of Defoe's stories? That said, of course, for Crusoe to have been isolated on an island (at that juncture, a little more than 11 years since his first landing) surely would justify his uneasiness at coming across such a "preternatural scene" as a single footprint in the sand or ground all by itself! It's crazy right? Defoe surely did a fine job with this one — adding some mysterious intrigue to the

⁵⁹In later years since my childhood, I have again encountered them retold alongside other mysteries, in **Arthur C. Clarke's** famous *Mysterious World* — a Book Club Associates publication based on a Televised Yorkshire series that went by the same name.

otherwise mostly realistic story!

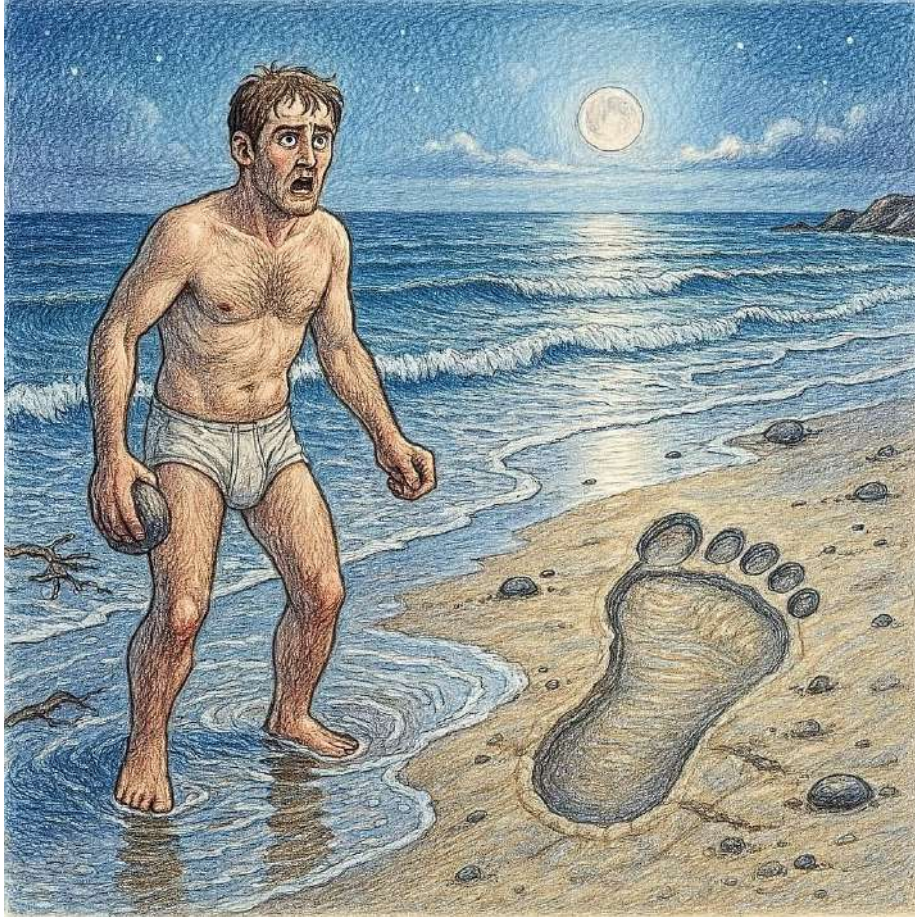


Figure 7: A horrified Crusoe upon encountering a mysterious single footprint in the sand..

44 Dec 21, 2025 18:21:55 - Concerning a Human Explanation for Mysterious Phenomenon

I slept none that Night; the farther I was from the Occasion of my Fright, the greater my Apprehensions were, which is something contrary to the Nature of such Things, and especially to the usual Practice of all Creatures in Fear: But I was so embarrass'd with my own frightful Ideas of the Thing, that I form'd nothing but dismal Imaginations to my self, even tho' I was now a great way off of it.

Sometimes I fancy'd it must be the Devil; and Reason joyn'd in with me upon this Supposition: For how should any other Thing in human Shape come into the Place? Where was the Vessel that brought them? What Marks was there of any other Footsteps? And how was it possible a Man should come there? But then to think that Satan should take human shape upon him in such a Place where there could be no manner of Occasion for it, but to leave the Print of his Foot behind him, and that even for no Purpose too, for he could not be sure I should see it; this was an Amusement the other Way; I consider'd that the Devil might have found out abundance of other Ways to have terrify'd me than this of the single Print of a Foot.

That as I liv'd quite on the other Side of the Island, he would never have been so simple to leave a Mark in a Place where 'twas Ten Thousand to one whether I should ever see it or not, and in the Sand too, which the first Surge of the Sea upon a high Wind would have defac'd entirely: All this seem'd inconsistent with the Thing itself, and with all the Notions we usually entertain of the Subtilty of the Devil.

Arguably, this was the closest that Daniel Defoe got⁶⁰ to the likes of Stephen King's sometimes humorous horror!

Twas so joyous reading of the horrors that might come into a man's mind at the occasion of encountering something only pretentiously human, but for which attribution could not be made to either the self nor any other human that one knows! Horrifying indeed!

Also.. Defoe's bewildering idea that the Devil or Satan, in their most cunning forms are in fact human⁶¹ is quite original⁶², so thought-provoking!

⁶⁰Well, no disrespect to King, but without doubt, it should be the other way round.. King must surely give some credit to Daniel Defoe!

⁶¹For interesting theories with regards to attributing human-causes to otherwise seemingly preternatural or otherwise otherworldly phenomena — such as UFO sightings, crop-circles, phantoms, etc., again, one can find a fair treatment in works such as those of **Arthur C. Clarke**.

⁶²**Later-Note:** Well, perhaps not that [universally] original; given that there exist hints



Figure 8: *The Temptation of Christ* by **Ary Scheffer** (1795-1858) is a dramatic painting from 1854 presenting one of the most psychologically intense moments in the New Testament — the Devil's final temptation of Jesus in the wilderness (**Mathew 4:8-10**) (Says Telegram channel <https://t.me/aetatesolis/4601> that among other things is renown for treating of topics such as history, art, and yes, Europeanism). Moreover, and worth noting concerning this classic painting; one can observe that, just like the suggestion Daniel Defoe left in his 18th century tale of Robison Crusoe (see **Section 44**); **that in his most cunning forms, Satan appears in human form**; is indeed a powerfully influential idea, and could likely have inspired later art such we see depicted here in Scheffer's painting.

45 Dec 21, 2025 18:37:21 - On Appreciating Human Companionship as a Divine Gift and Solitariness as The State of Being [Spiritually] Dead

that to have seen one of my own Species, would have seem'd to me a Raising me from Death to Life, and the greatest Blessing that Heaven itself, next to the supreme Blessing of Salvation, could bestow

There's no doubt here, that Defoe knew a thing or more about the harshness of a human having to exist in extreme isolation... See, **he [nearly] equates solitariness to being dead**, and **having human company as being alive**. I wonder, if many thinkers, even when not merely talking of extremities, would deny his analogy here as being true.

And then, when explored to its extreme end or implications.. Might it be that when humans, as in many cultures, keep their deceased kin and friends close by (such as with keeping cemeteries near churches of the [still] living, or as in African cultures, in the backyard of homes), or when the remains of some privileged humans⁶³ are preserved in proximity to the living, and especially in exhumed or mummified form. Could it be that such acts perhaps help the living **to keep their deceased somewhat “more alive” than typical dead people would be?** Would this line of thinking help justify many practices and traditions (both in Africa⁶⁴ but also in many cultures both ancient and modern) with regards to how the living related to or like to keep their dear dead ones (or their remains) close to them? Or are such acts mere extreme expressions of mankind's social nature?

Overall, Defoe seems to be onto something subtle, purely esoteric and sublime with this line of thinking. I am not sure whether other reviewers or critics might concur, but those few lines read like the glimpses of a very deep occult philosophy!

of human-like devils in even more archaic literature than Defoe's — for example the case of several devilish human-chimeras one finds covered in Grecian myths and literature. But then, it's also indubitable that Defoe's reflections could as well have further inspired later writers and creatives — refer to the famous painting by **Ary Scheffer** (Dutch-born, associated with French Romantic school), *The Temptation of Christ*; **Figure 8** — It is a work that treats of a biblical scene about two spiritual entities that both took on a surprising human form during the encounter: **God as the perfect human person** of Jesus Christ, his Transcendent Son, and **Satan, his arch-angel in human form too, as a Deviant Angelic Chimera**.

⁶³Such as **Saint Peter** and other Catholic saints whose graves are housed inside of churches.. The likes of “**Cabana**” founder of the Goggonya Sisters/nuns here in Uganda.

⁶⁴A treatment of this practice and philosophical line of thought is likewise exhibited in the reviewer's first novel [5] — **Shrines of The Free Men**, where for example, a particular sect of elite occultists practice a form of necromancy somewhat reminiscent of ritualized vampirism and other similar peculiarities.

46 Dec 21, 2025 18:45:11 - Robinson Crusoe The Bibliomancer

Words of the Scripture came into my Thoughts, *Call upon me in the Day of Trouble, and I will deliver, and thou shalt glorify me.* Upon this, rising chearfully out of my Bed, my Heart was not only comforted, but I was guided and encourag'd to pray earnestly to God for Deliverance: When I had done praying, I took up my Bible, and opening it to read, the first Words that presented to me, were, *Wait on the Lord, and be of good Cheer, and he shall strengthen thy Heart; wait, I say, on the Lord*

That Defoe was such a great champion of **Interacting with God** via the reading or reflection upon the Sacred Scriptures is no doubt. Many times in this book, we come across several instances where the only exit out of difficult mental conundrums and life's dilemmas is when Crusoe resorts to studying (many times using the random, divinatory reading method) of his Bible.

46.1 Later Note

For those interested, note that we have already covered the topic of divinatory reading of books such as scriptures in **Section 22**. These further illustrations should only serve to drive home the point that Daniel Defoe truly trusted and championed the practice of bibliomancy.

47 Dec 26, 2025 22:21:05 - On Brewing Beer For Oneself

I had dropp'd a good Design, which I had once bent my Thoughts too much upon; and that was, to try if I could not make some of my Barley into Malt, and then try to brew my self some Beer: This was really a whimsical Thought, and I reprov'd my self often for the Simplicity of it; for I presently saw there would be the want of several Things necessary to the making my Beer, that it would be impossible for me to supply; as First, Casks to preserve it in, which was a Thing, that as I have observ'd already, I cou'd never compass; no, though I spent not many Days, but Weeks, nay, Months in attempting it, but to no purpose. In the next Place, I had no Hops to make it keep, no Yeast to make it work, no Copper or Kettle to make it boil; and yet all these Things, notwithstanding, I verily believe, had not these Things interven'd, I mean the Frights and Terrors I was in about the Savages, I had undertaken it, and perhaps brought it to pass too; for I seldom gave any Thing over without accomplishing it, when I once had it in my Head enough to begin it.

Defoe's book is so full of many calls towards the DIY (Do-It-Yourself) Philosophy, it many times might come off as an attempt to piece together many recipes for how to [re-]create modern life's comforts using readily available/everyday things⁶⁵. In most of Defoe's projects, one needs only make the least assumptions concerning what essentials there are to begin with — such as only having barley and not even the containers nor yeast with which to hold or process the beer! Oftentimes, one needs to solve their problems practically, by starting from scratch... “starting from first-principles” as my teacher of high-school mathematics used to teach us concerning how to tame most problems.

The DIY-culture is quite a big thing in today's world — lots of bloggers, YouTube channels and TV shows are prepared annually for the sole purpose of helping individuals learn to produce this or that on their own, often, from the comfort of their homes. In that regard then, Defoe's book is without doubt such a wonderful [classical] foundation for such lifestyles and should be jealously protected by everyone including the military, doctors without borders, missionaries, astronauts, and yes, boy scouts⁶⁶!

⁶⁵For his era, even though it was the Enlightenment and that several luminaries existed and were producing written works, and yet, it feels plausible to think that Defoe's novel could somewhat readily pass for a pioneering [primitive or rudimentary] DIY encyclopedia even though one somewhat niche-oriented and especially appealing to sailors and the military.

⁶⁶As we have already treated of in **Section 18**.

48 Dec 26, 2025 22:35:01 - Crusoe Plotting to Ambush A Band of Cannibals That Visit His Island

So, finally, Crusoe did start getting some human company on the Island he'd long occupied all by himself. Except that, these weren't the sort of humane comrades he'd wish to entertain. And so, he started devising plots for how to annihilate them before they find out about him or take him on..

Sometimes I contriv'd to dig a Hole under the Place where they made their Fire, and put in five or six Pound of Gun-powder, which when they kindled their Fire, would consequently take Fire, and blow up all that was near it; but as in the first Place I should be very loth to wast so much Powder upon them, my Store being now within the Quantity of one Barrel; so neither could I be sure of its going off , at any certain Time, when it might surprise them, and at best, that it would do little more than just blow the Fire about their Ears and fright them, but not sufficient to make them forsake the Place; so I laid it aside, and then propos'd, that I would place my self in Ambush, in some convenient Place, with my three Guns, all double loaded; and in the middle of their bloody Ceremony, let fly at them, when I should be sure to kill or wound perhaps two or three at every shoot; and then falling in upon them with my three Pistols, and my Sword, I made no doubt, but that if there was twenty I should kill them all

This, but also earlier and later sub-themes in Daniel Defoe's novel indicate that the man surely had a healthy interest in all kinds of activities militaristic. The way Crusoe always keeps guns and swords on himself, the kinds of violent ideas he would sometimes entertain and the cautiousness, deviousness of several of his plans against or in anticipation of foes surely makes one acknowledge that very possibly, Defoe was a trained or experienced military man⁶⁷.

49 Dec 26, 2025 23:09:19 - Defoe Reflects Upon and Criticizes The Inhumane Excessive Brutality of European Christian Imperialists on Foreign Barbaric Tribes

Robinson Crusoe has entertained the idea of ambushing and annihilating the savages that visit his island and who practice several barbaric rites including human sacrifice and practicing cannibalism. However, seems like he's also con-

⁶⁷Or perhaps, that he'd kept close enough to such folks for a good while he could think or even act like them.

cerned for their forgivable innocence and incivility given they aren't of the same origin nor culture as he is. Crusoe's reflections go something like this...

In the next Place it occur'd to me, that albeit the Usage they thus gave one another, was thus brutish and inhuman; yet it was really nothing to me: These People had done me no Injury. That if they attempted me, or I saw it necessary for my immediate Preservation to fall upon them, something might be said for it; but that as I was yet out of their Power, and they had really no Knowledge of me, and consequently no Design upon me; and therefore it could not be just for me to fall upon them. That this would justify the Conduct of the Spaniards in all their Barbarities practis'd in America, and where they destroy'd Millions of these People, who however they were Idolaters and Barbarians, and had several bloody and barbarous Rites in their Customs, such as sacrificing human Bodies to their Idols, were yet, as to the Spaniards, very innocent People; and that the rooting them out of the Country, is spoken of with the utmost Abhorrence and Detestation, by even the Spaniards themselves, at this Time; and by all other Christian Nations of Europe, as a meer Butchery, a bloody and unnatural Piece of Cruelty, unjustifiable either to God or Man; and such, as for which the very Name of a Spaniard is reckon'd to be frightful and terrible to all People of Humanity, or of Christian Compassion: As if the Kingdom of Spain were particularly Eminent for the Product of a Race of Men, who were without Principles of Tenderness, or the common Bowels of Pity to the Miserable, which is reckon'd to be a Mark of generous Temper in the Mind.

That's some fair criticism of the Christian Europeans concerning how they sometimes treated primitive races they encountered in their voyages and ventures to civilise and colonize would-be subjects — **the Spanish in the Americas** being the major case that Daniel Defoe highlights here. Closely related too, the film lover and reviewer in me gets the strong feeling that modern epic works of cinema such as **Mel Gibson's** *Apocalypto* (2006) were possibly inspired by or influenced by the sentiments put across by earlier authorities such as Daniel Defoe's here.

50 Jan 2, 2026 23:09:57 - Crusoe Witnesses a Ship Getting Wrecked, Encounters a Boy's Floating Corpse

But it was not to be; either their Fate or mine, or both, forbid it; for till the last Year of my being on this Island, I never knew whether any were saved out of that Ship or no; and had only the Affliction some Days after, to see the Corps of a drowned Boy come on Shore, at the End of the Island which was next the Shipwreck: He had on no Cloaths, but a Seaman's Wastcoat, a pair of open knee'd Linnen Drawers, and a blew Linnen Shirt; but nothing to direct me so much as to guess what Nation he was of: He had nothing in his Pocket, but two Pieces of Eight, and a Tobacco Pipe; the last was to me of ten times more value than the first.

Thus, we learned that, after more than twelve years alone on a remote island in the middle of nowhere, some day a ship showed up over the horizon, made a distress call⁶⁸ with gunshots, only to later get shipwrecked before it could reach anywhere close to the shore. In this passage then, we see that the only hope of Crusoe meeting a possibly civilized human — that is, assuming we ignore the usually naked, cannibalistic savages he'd spotted visiting and leaving the island on like two earlier occasions, and who he never bothered to approach nor interact with — manifested in the form of a drowned but floating body of a [possibly European] boy!

The other interesting bit about this encounter is that, it **brings to mind the nature in which Robinson Crusoe first arrived on the island himself; it had been after surviving a shipwreck in which he was the only survivor!** The encounter then, must have been remorseful to him, but also a definite occasion to be utterly grateful.

⁶⁸First, we have encountered this concept in **Section 8**. However, as for what it actually is about, [3] tells us that "Distress Calls" are urgent signals often sent by ships, aircraft, or individuals to indicate they are in grave and imminent danger and require immediate assistance. Traditionally, they use standardized codes or signals — like "SOS" in Morse Code or "Mayday" over radio — to ensure universal recognition and rapid response. Moreover, it might likewise be worth noting that distress calls have a special presence and use among members of certain traditional secret fraternities such as among or between Free Masons — meaning, one mason could be in trouble and needs the immediate or urgent attention of his fellow masons, or that they need to bring an important urgency to the attention of only fellow masons, and so, they use a secret distress call so that when the alarm is made, only fellow masons understand it for what it is, and thus the necessary actions and reactions can be immediately put into effect without most of the public understanding nor being aware of what's actually going on.

51 Jan 19, 2026 23:14:06 - That Gratitude As a State of Mind Can [Re-]Paint One's Reality For The Better

it is very rare that the Providence of God casts us into any Condition of Life so low, or any Misery so great, but we may see something or other to be thankful for; and may see others in worse Circumstances than our own.

As with several other reminders⁶⁹ that Defoe sprinkled allover his book.. We again get the impression that **gratefulness**, perhaps more than any other virtue, helped Robinson Crusoe find the most meaning in a life so acutely deviated from the norm and yet it somewhat [eventually] felt as perfect or undeniably better than one could hope for given where fate had stationed (perhaps imprisoned?) his physical self for years!

⁶⁹Also see **Section 34**.

52 Jan 20, 2026 00:38:54 - Concerning Modern Life and Contemporary Experiences of Traveling the Big Oceans and Seas of The World: A BBC Talk-show Episode About Laura



Figure 9: A modern day mariner getting ready for an expedition.

In the recent **forced nationwide Internet Blackout** that government imposed on Uganda during the 11th presidential elections⁷⁰, a person like me —

⁷⁰As has become the norm in a formerly exemplary and admired Ugandan democracy (albeit one that's never witnessed an election successfully change the country's president), political tensions, insecurity on the part of the incumbent, but also aggressive censorship of both media and public dialogue continually culminated in the central government flipping the switch on network based communication systems nearly countrywide. Especially, unconditional blocking of access to the Internet was paramount in 2026, even though, in the previous presidential elections, only particular sections of the Internet (such as only popular social media platforms, certain news websites and some internet services) had enforced restricted access for the general public — with workarounds only possible for those using alternative/special APNs or VPN solutions.

often sourcing for most information as well as entertainment via the Internet — decided to momentarily return to listening to traditional radio given no meaningful alternatives were available or accessible.

I happened to be browsing through a surprisingly long list of locally-accessible⁷¹ FM radio stations — perhaps on the evening of 16th January 2026 — via my smartphone's [FM] radio app⁷² — something I rarely do⁷³, when I stumbled upon an interesting, in fact, captivating story (a kind of Talkshow or interview documentary) whose theme not only resonated closely with my current book reading pastime — a nearly year-long, unhurried, thoughtful and reflective reading of Defoe's classic, a book that I also happen to be simultaneously reviewing.

BBC (101.3 FM) happened to be covering **the story of one family of record setting seafarers from Netherlands**; a father, that apart from being a passionate explorer of the entire globe via long ocean ventures, had undergone several disturbing feuds (perhaps with the partner or with law enforcement) concerning his strong attachment to his daughter and who, for a while, seemed to have been distanced from him (perhaps forcibly). Also, it was disclosed, that the girl had grown up to not only love the father, but also did pick-up and further his passion for globe-wide (mostly solo) ocean adventures. And that, after being reunited with him (perhaps as a teen or even while younger than that), she observed and learned from him all she could about ships, traveling and navigating across the seas mostly alone, so that, by the time she was just sixteen, she managed to plan and undertake an unbelievable journey all the way from Netherlands, across the Atlantic, to the Americas, then southward, and into the Pacific, and finally to Africa (not sure if she returned to Europe thereafter or perhaps not).

The girl, whose father's name I never noted, but who the presenter referred to as **Laura**, sometimes directly described all these sea-ventures in her own jolly, zealous and heroine's voice. It was said, she finally settled in New Zealand, preferring there and not returning to Netherlands, and that she'd also met and married a guy from there. She indicated that they now had kids of their own⁷⁴, and that she many times found herself having to let her own kids learn the ins and outs of life on the seas, and that perhaps, like her dad had groomed and influenced her life, that she too should do the same for her kids... Then the top of the hour arrived and the interesting show came to an end.

Four things struck me as quite interesting concerning that story as well as my accidental encounter with both the characters and the theme;

First, I happened to be in the middle of reading *Robinson Crusoe*'s adventures in the vast nothingness of God-knows-where-in-Oceania, and here I was

⁷¹I say "locally-accessible" because, despite the list of stations being vast (~ 34 stations!), and yet, without having access to special hardware so as to tune into either Short-wave (SW), Medium-wave (MW) or Amplitude Modulation (AM), one finds that, only two international radio stations can be accessed locally over Ugandan airwaves; Radio France International (RFI) at **93.7 MHz** that especially broadcasts in French, and then British Broadcasting Corporation (BBC) at **101.3 MHz** broadcasting generally in English.

⁷²This particular app is the only radio-access app that I know, and it comes as a native, in-built/pre-installed app on the Samsung Galaxy I treasure like a baby.

⁷³Generally, I typically find commercial radio stations very distracting and unsatisfactory for my personal tastes, often preferring the self-service model of Internet based broadcasting.

⁷⁴However, I never took note of how exactly old she might be as of the moment of the talk-show.



Figure 10: A collage highlighting **the reviewer's first ever experience being aboard a ship as well as sailing on an ocean!** The photos capture moments aboard a ship sailing towards **Liberty Island** on the **Atlantic ocean**, during the climax/finals of the worldwide **2011 Microsoft Imagine Cup** that was hosted in Manhattan, New York — at the prestigious Marriott Marquis (opening), but also the Lincoln Center (closing). Interesting to note, the top-right photo is actually showing Joseph posing with members of the team that came from Daniel Defoe's favorite Brasils! Those Brazilians actually took global top spot in the Game Design category! In the bottom photograph, are members of the team that represented China, including [potentially doctor] **Noah Lin** (seated right next to Joseph's left), then still a university undergrad too, heavily interested in robotics leveraging the Microsoft-Kinect light, sound, and gesture-sensor.

listening to a real life story, in our own [modern] era and that it had so much in it like the 18th century fictitious story by Daniel Defoe!

Secondly, I had ever ventured to the high waters aboard a boat — never on a ship⁷⁵, and neither to an ocean nor a sea, but just to our nearby Lake Victoria⁷⁶ — but on all such occasions (and not that many mind you, and only as an adult), I always felt like life on the waters wasn't my thing; the uneasiness of the boat as the waves swayed us side to side oftentimes left my heart wanting to leap out of my chest, and yet a lake is undoubtedly much calmer than an ocean. Often, I would only be on a boat trip alongside other people and never on my own, and yet it sometimes felt like some of these travel-mates were not *present* during those [mostly] trying moments. I would sometimes think that either they were too used or too unconcerned about the risks of sailing, so that, it felt like they were sailing subconsciously, or I'd find myself feeling as though these other folks in the boat with me were either half-dead or perhaps living a suicidal life! These thoughts and memories returned to me as I listened to the strange ventures of Laura, a girl, sailing the big oceans on her own, and I just could not believe it!⁷⁷

Next, I realized that I had always cherished to grow up with and spend precious time with my own daughter — of course, also with a son or any of my children wouldn't matter — but somehow, circumstances in my life as well as challenges with my [incompatible] partners have denied me this opportunity for all 4(?)⁷⁸ of my children thus far. Of my kids thus far, there's hardly any

⁷⁵**Later-Note+Correction:** Actually, and in retrospect, it is the case that, even though the voyage wasn't that long — just between mainland New York/Manhattan and Liberty Island (where the Statue of Liberty is located) — and yet, at least once, and especially while on that particular trip, which was during the global finals for the 2011 Microsoft Imagine Cup (slightly after I had finished graduating for my first degree, a BSc. from Makerere University), I did get the chance to be aboard a ship that sailed us to and from the Liberty Island. I can hardly forget the experience till now; aboard the modest sized vessel were all the members of the globally winning teams that had been hosted at the finals; the smartest geeks and students in tech from all over the world, bonding and enjoying each other's company as we took lots of photographs, ate delicious Microsoft snacks, and especially, networked. At the event, I happened to be the lead of the team representing both Uganda and **Makerere University**, as well as the only finalists from East Africa. **Figure 10** shows me aboard the ship, while **Figure 11** highlights moments on the island. For a complete cover of the adventure's highlights from my POV, refer to my archives via BCA: <https://t.me/bclectures/33>. So, yes! At least I've ever been aboard a ship, and even though [3] corrected me concerning whether the island is in the Atlantic Ocean or not — it is technically in the "New York Harbor" which is part of an "estuary," Hudson Bay, that [yes,] flows into the Atlantic ocean — I can at least claim to have breathed ocean-like airs and having witnessed/touched oceanic water!

⁷⁶Also known as **Lake Nalubale** in some books of Ugandan geography.

⁷⁷Talking of young people sailing on the oceans, and especially girls, it should be worth noting that, in Daniel Defoe's *Robinson Crusoe*, **at no moment does one encounter any scene nor hint that women ever sailed in those days! There's hardly any mention of whether or not Crusoe ever encountered or took a girl or woman aboard either a boat or ship during all of his sea voyages and adventures.** So, most likely, this modern BBC seafaring tale concerning Laura and her father from Netherlands should very well be appreciated as a nice lesson for most European sailors (but also any sailors) and not just the English such as Crusoe was!

⁷⁸The question mark is necessary trust me — occasionally, a girl has showed up to me claiming she bore my child, only to later establish that there is a possibility the fathers are perhaps two or more, or that we both cannot correctly ascertain when and how I'd made her pregnant. And then, there has been one case where a girl I knew I'd made pregnant, prematurely left to to go live with her parents, but that she never physically showed up thereafter, nor ever showed me the baby we bore except in promising calls, e-mails and such... Thus, it many times feels like am yet to actually have my own children!



Figure 11: A collage highlighting **the reviewer's experiences on Liberty Island, New York** during the 2011 Microsoft Imagine Cup global finals. Top-left is Joseph with a lady (left) from the Irish **Team Hermes** that won the global finals in the Software Design category, but also a friend from the Nigerian team (right). Top-right is Joseph Willrich (left) standing next to Joseph Kaizi (center), who was likewise from Uganda, and perhaps someone from either Europe or the Brazils. And then, bottom photograph is the reviewer (center), standing between two pals from the Chinese team.

that we have had the natural opportunity to grow up and spend valuable time together! Especially with the eldest, **Shona Karungi**, a girl currently about to turn 14 and who I only ever lived close to as an infant, I feel and trust that we surely would have made such a wonderful team growing up and exploring my hobbies — writing books, painting, making music, performing magic, hacking on computers, cooking etc. — together.



Figure 12: Real-life photos of the reviewer's human-size headless mannequin that he originally named "Laura". In the top-left corner is shown the girl helping him market and entertain customers at their **Menuza Bytes** shop in Garuga, where reading featured books while enjoying a cold drink and snacks, from under their customized shop shade is among the unforgettable experiences.

And then Laura! That name truly is MAGICAL in my life.. After somewhat facing difficulties sustaining⁷⁹ a relationship with my last girlfriend, **Marie**

⁷⁹As is typical with some nice girls that aren't yet properly schooled in life and family, they often wish to merely be housewives but at the same time expect or demand heaven and earth to be provided unto them. Maybe nothing wrong with that. For my case though, having especially chosen to focus on homeschooling myself throughout most of my master's degree studies as well as working towards a PhD [almost from home], it is the case that I'd

— whose baby I've never seen nor heard talk or cry, but who she kept insisting and assuring me existed — I decided to buy a life-size doll that I might keep in place of both a girlfriend and her baby. In fact, it is a mannequin, but not just any kind of mannequin as you might readily tell. When she first arrived home — freshly procured from a vendor in CBD Kampala — my original plan was the usual; to employ her as a fashion exhibitor for ladies fashion at the shop we'd started together with Marie while she still was with me. However, after reflecting and meditating about it for a while, and especially when I'd finished dressing her up several times across a period of about a month since her arrival, I decided it was better I just keep her at home as a silent partner. Also, and this I did almost a little after she'd arrived, I consecrated and baptized her with the name "Laura".

Since her arrival at home, we've been through quite a lot with Laura; first, she's the kind of mannequin that comes with no hands and no head⁸⁰. Thus, I've had to always find ways of improvising an appendage to serve as her head, and also to dress her up in such a way she appears to have arms and can put on clothes for normal girls; dresses, jackets, scarves, etc. Moreover, and closely related, I later found it necessary to procure a "fuller" girl, and so I returned to Kampala, after having previously caught sight of a truly remarkable girl being sold at a mannequin store in town, and bought me a lady that when she did arrive home, quickly became difficult to take anywhere else given she's made of parts that can sometimes disassemble or which can move (somewhat like the classic toy-story of 19th century Italian writer, **Carlo Collodi**; *The Adventures of Pinocchio*). I generally call her "Marie"⁸¹.

So, this story.. Ummmmm it really really touched me! Especially learning about the case of Laura and her father! And then reflecting about my own life and my troubles with partners, and then the memories I'd had of life traveling on water, and then.. Robison Crusoe!

Finally, I should indicate that I have held a deep interest in not only listening to, but also creating my own talkshows for a while — especially for my internet communities⁸² — many times even having to feign the voices and perspectives of both my sons and daughters, sometimes even my "missing" partners, friends and neighbors — so-called *voice-crafting* and role-playing, and then here I was, reading and reviewing Daniel Defoe's story of Robinson Crusoe from hundreds of years before, only to stumble upon the story of Laura and her Robinson Crusoe father in a Talk-show! It's the stuff of Jung that we've already talked about in **Section 29.1** — so-called unbelievable **synchronicity**!

grown weary of devoting time to mundanity, but also of ceaselessly going around hunting for a "better paying" job. Tired and exhausted from the obvious loads and concerns, and without meaningful support from anyone in the know — neither family, nor academic nor industry peers — I then decided to [momentarily] forfeit demanding relationships and instead focus on first securing my career.

⁸⁰In fact, circa 2023, I did already work on a special musical record as the band MAZERA, themed around **celebrating headless maidens**: <https://t.me/mazeraworks/53> — not for their potentially horrifying looks, but because they so much reminded me of writers such as [1] and childhood memories of reading about "headless horsemen" in especially fantastic Devonshire tales about such phantoms often sighted there, and which tales first got me hooked on the horror genre! As for "headless men", my latest novel, [2], does feature, even if only in passing, the case of a beheaded president.

⁸¹It somewhat helped seal the void in my life, and I've not wanted much since then.

⁸²I do maintain several ICs, spanning Telegram, YouTube, Reddit as well as WhatsApp — refer to **About Reviewer** for more.



Figure 13: Real-life photos of the reviewer's human-sized doll that he refers to as "Marie". She sometimes also accompanies Laura to their shop, but otherwise mostly stays at home giving him company while he writes or works at his computer. And just as with Laura at the end of a busy work day or perhaps in the early morning, we sit down in the comfort of our cozy home, and privately hold some prayers, but also arcane rituals some times! We likewise often have vivid conversations despite them not being equipped with speech capabilities yet — refer to **Section 14** concerning my explorations of leveraging telepathic communication; works well with human-to-human, human-to-animal, but also human-to-anything! So, thus is the kind of modern *Pinocchio*-synthetic-human miracle I've grown to love and well... use for character crafting and magic!

52.1 Later Note

After that story, I felt more connected to my fictitious girl (I sometimes prefer to think of her as a daughter, but many times as a wife), Laura!

Also, I was quite grateful that the story aired on BBC⁸³.. because well, at

⁸³Talking of BBC, apart from my longtime appreciation of their British-made international broadcasting, I likewise have developed a strong attraction to their Internet-based (esp. YouTube) broadcasts of DNB (**Drum 'N' Bass**) genre music mixes typically branded

around that time, I was deeply in the process of working towards going to study in the UK for my PhD — I had been at it, writing applications, corresponding with faculty at the University of Oxford, and reading, writing and thinking lots about traveling away from Uganda. In fact, I likewise constantly kept fantasizing about the possibility of actually bumping into and perhaps even **marrying a real white girl...** a white Laura or Marie or Molly or Imelda or Peace or Tabitha! But, like many of the stories we enjoy reading and writing, much of it has especially remained only in the realm of fiction and no faction whatsoever; around May in 2026, the month when I would celebrate my 40th birthday, I got the sad news from Oxford's Computer Science graduate school office (in England) that my application for a DPhil (Doctorate in Philosophy) had not been successful. They advised that I either target reapplying for the next round, 2026/2027, or that I try alternative options. Otherwise, I have actually not, and might not be able to give up on Oxford, nor giving up on plans of meeting and marrying a white girl⁸⁴.

"BBC Radio 1 DNB Mixtapes." I have collected several of these over the years, but also have learnt to produce my own DNB music (under the "DJ PLUTO" brand) and might be among few pioneers of this modern music in Uganda — for a good example, refer to <https://t.me/tv266/1536>

Lastly, among my important, but also popular ICs, is one hosted on WhatsApp. It mostly helps me correspond with, but also serve my immediate physical neighbors within the GARUGA and ENTEBBE jurisdiction. The IC, founded around 2021 during the Covid-lockdown era, is named after my home town; Bugabo-Bukaaya, and so that we generally prefer to abbreviate the internet community's name as just "BBIC".

⁸⁴How it would be awesome to at least have the chance to meet and date a great-great-great grand daughter of Daniel Defoe!



Figure 14: An earlier (2020) photo of the reviewer with their eldest daughter, **Shona K. Marlyn**. He always felt she could become a writer like him. But time will tell...

53 Mar 1, 2026 23:43:45 - Robinson Crusoe Finally Gets A Friendly Human Companion, Albeit a Savage!

We learn that, after a scuffle-like ambush on a bunch of the usual savages that frequented his island, Crusoe finally won the friendship and companionship of a living human; a younger man than he, but also of the same kinship as the savages he came up against. It so happens that the young man was originally destined to die at the hands of his savage captors, when it so happens that Crusoe happened on them and saved his life. The ordeal went something like..

But there was more work to do yet, for I perceived the Savage who I knock'd down, was not kill'd, but stunn'd with the blow, and began to come to himself; so I pointed to him, and showing him the Savage, that he was not dead; upon this he spoke some Words to me, and though I could not understand them, yet I thought they were pleasant to hear, for they were the first sound of a Man's Voice, that I had heard, my own excepted, for above Twenty Five Years. But there was no time for such Reflections now, the Savage who was knock'd down recover'd himself so far, as to sit up upon the Ground, and I perceived that my Savage began to be afraid; but when I saw that, I presented my other Piece at the Man, as if I would shoot him, upon this my Savage, for so I call him now, made a Motion to me to lend him my Sword, which hung naked in a Belt by my side; so I did: he no sooner had it, but he runs to his Enemy, and at one blow cut off his Head as cleaverly, no Executioner in Germany, could have done it sooner or better; which I thought very strange, for one who I had Reason to believe never saw a Sword in his Life before, except their own Wooden Swords; however it seems, as I learn'd afterwards, they make their Wooden Swords so sharp, so heavy, and the Wood is so hard, that they will cut off Heads even with them, ay and Arms, and that at one blow too; when he had done this, he comes laughing to me in Sign of Triumph, and brought me the Sword again, and with abundance of Gestures which I did not understand, laid it down with the Head of the Savage, that he had kill'd just before me.

Makes me wonder.. Crusoe was desperate to take in a slave or partner, but that it seems he wasn't afraid to initiate their relation with a show of power.. Shooting and killing one of the two savages pursuing the would-be servant, but who likewise opts to show his support for Crusoe by beheading the other remaining savage! So, looks like they would both be, at minimum, **bonded by the fact they both were man killers!**

53.1 Later Note

At this moment in the story, I wasn't sure if I should trust Crusoe's newfound friend, the savage — later, named "Friday", and who he additionally enjoyed referring to as "My Man" or "My Man Friday". Of course, it made sense to weigh the options... Crusoe knew that all these savages, in a way, were not to be trusted; uncivilized, cannibals, non-European, and that they spoke a language he could hardly understand. However, and very likely, acute loneliness drove him to trade security for the companionship of a savage slave man. That he trusted him with his sword upon their first encounter furthers the argument that he had few alternatives left. However, and as we later establish, Crusoe's

heroic act initiated but also quickly galvanized their friendship, so that, in retrospect, I wonder how else Defoe would have framed the matter of Crusoe's acquisition of meaningful human companionship and support, given the vast difference between him and the savages that seemed to be the only other humans he would come across for quite a long while on the remote island.

54 Mar 1, 2026 23:57:47 - Crusoe Describes the Stunning Beauty of His Newly Acquired Man Friend

He was a comely handsome Fellow, perfectly well made; with straight strong Limbs, not too large; tall and well shap'd, and as I reckon, about twenty six Years of Age. He had a very good Countenance, not a fierce and surly Aspect; but seem'd to have something very manly in his Face, and yet he had all the Sweetness and Softness of an European in his Countenance too, especially when he smil'd. His Hair was long and black, not curl'd like Wool; his Forehead very high, and large, and a great Vivacity and sparkling Sharpness in his Eyes. The Colour of his Skin was not quite black, but very tawny; and yet not of an ugly yellow nauseous tawny, as the Brasilians, and Virginians, and other Natives of America are; but of a bright kind of a dun olive Colour, that had in it something very agreeable; tho' not very easy to describe. His Face was round, and plump; his Nose small, not flat like the Negroes, a very good Mouth, thin Lips, and his fine Teeth well set, and white as Ivory.

So interesting — almost disconcerting — to see/read how much Crusoe (Ooops! Defoe) could distinguish between men's beauty and appearance with so much detail! Reading this bit, and knowing how long Crusoe had been lonely on the island with just beasts and domesticated creatures.. made me wonder if perhaps he'd not end up finding the younger man somewhat sexually attractive too!!⁸⁵

54.1 Later Note

I should say that it takes a bold man to study, at an unnerving detail, another man — especially another man's perfections⁸⁶. Defoe should be given some

⁸⁵In another footnote (~77) in **Section 52**, we build up the background for this argument or critical line of inquiry. Crusoe was a man, no denial about this, but also, he'd been so long without a human companion or partner — male or female — it could be legitimately asked if he'd survive for more than a quarter of a century without entertaining any sexual impulses or instincts — with or without humans that is.

⁸⁶Most men that I know of seem to be generally shy or somewhat afraid to openly appreciate or celebrate other, [sometimes] better men.

credit for setting such an example for other novelists.

It is quite important indeed, because, for a literature genre usually or traditionally devoid of illustrations⁸⁷, the ability to help the reader paint a clear, distinct picture of a character such as Friday does indeed go a long way in building rapport between the reader and the storyteller in relation to the characters being presented.

55 Mar 2, 2026 00:12:12 - Concerning the Rituals of Initiating a New Slave or Servant

At last he lays his Head flat upon the Ground, close to my Foot, and sets my other Foot upon his Head, as he had done before; and after this, made all the Signs to me of Subjection, Servitude, and Submission imaginable, to let me know, how he would serve me as long as he liv'd; I understood him in many Things, and let him know, I was very well pleas'd with him; in a little Time I began to speak to him, and teach him to speak to me; and first, I made him know his Name should be Friday, which was the Day I sav'd his Life; I call'd him so for the Memory of the Time; I likewise taught him to say Master, and then let him know, that was to be my Name; I likewise taught him to say YES and NO, and to know the meaning of them.

Thus, upon taking on a [new] slave or servant, we learn from Crusoe what the important first lessons are; to give the guy a [new] name and also teach him how to correctly refer to his owner or boss — as “Master”.

55.1 Later Note

The [literal] manner of Crusoe's acquisition of this servant aside, it should be worth discussing whether or not the author of the story likewise wished to communicate something else or deeper. First, note the striking similarity between Crusoe's preference of the title “Master” in relation to his servant or acquired companion. Of course, despite not having paid for the man's life via an exchange of currency as would typically have been the case in ancient slave-acquisition

⁸⁷One should notice, but also recognize, that, especially for purposes of helping the uninitiated come to appreciate a formidable work such as Defoe's *Robinson Crusoe*, we chose to include lots of supporting illustrations in this review of the [otherwise unillustrated] novel. However, and just as with the reviewer's own works — e.g. [5] and [2], the use of **figurative language** as well as many other literary techniques are what often help the readers of such works to better understand, but also return to the text many many times. Moreover, just as with reading scriptures, oftentimes, different readers might **read the same piece several times, but always end up with entirely different pictures, appreciation or understanding of the author's intentions!** But also, and because the reviewer likewise had younger writers, amateurs and children in mind as well, it felt right to try as much as possible, to throw in some few meaningful illustrations allover the review manuscript, so as to help heighten people's interest in Defoe's [now ancient] work.

transactions, and yet, because he had saved his life from brutal sudden death, he somewhat had indeed paid for the man's life, and so, it would be right to ascribe to him the status of a slave; a subject or subordinate relative to a "Master".

But then, and as is the case with much of Defoe's work, the scriptures likewise come to mind; Jesus, the Saving protagonist in all the gospels, was occasionally referred to as "Master" by his disciples. However, and as we see in the following note sourced via Copilot [3], Jesus had never directly instructed nor commanded his fellows to refer to him by such a title despite being their ultimate savior:

Jesus was often addressed as "Master" by His disciples, but He did not explicitly command them to use that title. Instead, He acknowledged and accepted it when they did, affirming His role as Teacher and Lord.

How the Title "Master" Appears in the Gospels

- Luke 5:5 | Simon Peter says: *"Master, we have worked hard all night and haven't caught anything. But because you say so, I will let down the nets."* Here, "Master" reflects obedience to Jesus' authority.
- Luke 8:24 | During the storm, the disciples cry: *"Master, Master, we are perishing!"* Thus they recognize His power to save.
- John 13:13-14 | Jesus Himself says: *"You call Me Teacher and Lord, and rightly so, for that is what I am."* He thus affirms the titles given to Him, including "Master," but frames them in terms of servanthood and humility.
- Matthew 23:10 | Jesus instructs: *"Nor are you to be called instructors, for you have one Instructor, the Christ."* Which emphasizes His unique authority as the ultimate teacher.

Meaning of "Master" in Context:

- In Jewish culture of the first century, "Master" was synonymous with Rabbi or Teacher, a title of respect for one who imparts wisdom.
- The disciples used it to acknowledge His authority, guidance, and divine power.
- Jesus accepted the title but redirected its meaning toward servant leadership, especially when He washed His disciples' feet (John 13:14).

Key Takeaways:

- Jesus did not directly instruct His disciples to call Him “Master.”
- The disciples and others naturally used the term to express respect and recognition of His authority.
- Jesus affirmed the title when used, but emphasized that true mastery involves humility, service, and obedience to God.

—Microsoft Copilot, 2026[3]

Before we close this discussion, note that the reviewer did likewise face a situation similar to Defoe's, when in *Shrines of The Free Men* [5], an episode occurs during which an adept [human] sorcerer — a one “Isaza” — with the power to remotely possess and act via the physical bodies of other initiates, leverages the body of a female assistant — “Ninka Maria” — to command and control a horde of [demonic] malevolent spirits by placing them under the control of another, cleaner, more powerful and divinely instituted spirit via applying theurgy; by possessing and [re-]animating the body of a particular, specially charged corpse — a one “Lazaro” — so that it then could help them perform other more arcane rites impossible or difficult to otherwise directly perform using normal humans at the time. In that bit of the story, and slightly after the reanimated corpse comes under control of the mage, he instructs it to refer to him as “Master”, as a means to properly establish the chain of command⁸⁸ between him, the *Frankenstein*-like creature, and the legion of servile spirits that they needed to keep in order then. In this regard, we can likewise come to appreciate Defoe's use of the master-servant or master-slave relation as well as its enforcement for effective collaboration across levels of command and control with potentially defiant entities⁸⁹.

Last but not least, realize Defoe's framing of the deliverance of the savage⁹⁰; it falls on a Friday, and Defoe's stressing of the point — **“the Day I sav'd**

⁸⁸Refer to **Chapter 12** in *Shrines of The Free Men*, [5], where the dead-living thing is instructed thus:

Hasten then
Stand up on thy newly replenished feet
And ask of me what work I have summoned you to do,
And if you must address me by name,
Only call me “Master”.

⁸⁹As one establishes from [4], it did take some conscious effort on the part of Crusoe, to transform Friday from his [especially] savage ways, and thus build more trust between them as time went by.

⁹⁰In fact, at a higher, meta-level of analysis, one could argue that **the deliverance was two-fold**; Crusoe delivers the savage from captivity and brutal death at the hands of fellow savages, but also, and though not literally stated or acknowledged, the savage delivers Crusoe from captivity to not just the island (as we later learn), but also helps deliver him from nearly fatal loneliness. Thus, it might help explain why, several times, if not from the onset, Crusoe openly acknowledges Friday's relevance, authority and honor in his life, many times preferring to not talk of him as just a “slave” or “servant”, but instead as a [fellow] “Man” — almost an equal or such!

his Life". So, combining this entire analysis, and in case we are to quickly summarise, it starts to feel as though Defoe somewhat paints or wishes to bring the reader's attention to Jesus's status as not just a "Master," but also as a "Saving Master" or perhaps "Master Savior." Of course, other analyses and other reviewers or critics of Defoe might think or say otherwise, however, the evidence here is strong, Defoe possibly had something more sublime in mind when writing this part of the Robinson Crusoe story.

56 Mar 2, 2026 00:20:56 - The Savage Practice of Eating Prisoners of War

The Place was cover'd with humane Bones, the Ground dy'd with their Blood, great Pieces of Flesh left here and there, half eaten, mangl'd and scorch'd; and in short, all the Tokens of the triumphant Feast they had been making there, after a Victory over their Enemies; I saw three Skulls, five Hands, and the Bones of three or four Legs and Feet, and abundance of other Parts of the Bodies; and Friday, by his Signs, made me understand, that they brought over four Prisoners to feast upon; that three of them were eaten up, and that he, pointing to himself, was the fourth: That there had been a great Battle between them, and their next King, whose Subjects it seems he had been one of; and that they had taken a great Number of Prisoners, all which were carry'd to several Places by those that had taken them in the Fight, in order to feast upon them, as was done here by these Wretches upon those they brought hither.

Thus we learn of the queer tendencies of the savages that Crusoe's servant survived; how they could sentence to death captives during their tribal conflicts, but also how, perhaps due to their barbaric beliefs and traditions, they could as well opt to feast on the roasted bodies of their chosen enemies!

56.1 Later Note

Though not much deep analysis concerning cannibalistic tendencies in humans shall be discussed here, however, having been born in the part of Africa⁹¹ — **Bunyoro Kitara Kingdom** — where some ancient cannibalistic practices, or at least stories of them were still in the air even during my childhood, I do have

⁹¹Meanwhile, and worth stressing here; despite Crusoe having once visited Africa; before his getting exiled to the island where much of his life was later spent; we can otherwise tell — from his convictions and narrations, but also from later analysis — that the island he dwelt on, was most likely closer to the Americas; in fact, very possibly in the Caribbean region, than being close to mainland Africa. Thus, it is more likely that the savages and their cannibalistic tendencies being discussed here, were predominantly of either Latin-American origin or strictly Caribbean.

a word or two to say concerning why it is likely that such savages reveled in the practice.

First, and as highlighted in some parts of my novel, *Shrines of The Free Men* [5], concerning the lives, beliefs, traditions and people of Bunyoro, note that, it was usually the case that **the people that were ‘eaten’ in most ritualistic feasts entertaining cannibalism were actually already dead people**. Essentially, it was not typical that a human were hunted and killed for the sake of eating their flesh or drinking their blood as say predatory animals such as lions and leopards might do, but that instead, when a family member died, or that a renown or famous warrior passed on, that, and especially either his close relatives, or his admirers during his life, would endeavor to obtain or retrieve bits of the deceased person's body, and either mix that into their herbal or ritualistic delicacies, or perhaps use bits of such a corpse as ingredients in certain kinds of incense. Thus, first of all, it wasn't the case that the entire dead person's body was actually eaten, no. Only bits of the dead person's flesh — like flesh off the limbs, some particular bones of interest such as the hands and palms, the heart, etc. Among common beliefs and philosophies underlying such practices were the following:

1. That eating of the body of a man or woman that had lived a hero's or warrior's life would likewise instill such virtues in the folks eating of their body. A kind of primitive sympathetic eucharistic magic.
2. That smelling, breathing or looking at the burning incense produced using bits of the body of a deceased person — especially kin, a friend, a king, shaman, etc. — would readily serve well in the practice of presencing the deceased person's spirit. This would for example help during sessions or seances at which the deceased person's spirit would be consulted or interacted with such as during necromantic rites, funerary rites, familial or tribal rites, etc.
3. Some shamans did, and still entertain the belief that certain parts of the human body, when either processed in particular ways, or when used as is, do possess medicinal, healing or magical powers, and thus, it might be the case that either for freshly dead or even ritualistically killed humans, particular parts of the dead person's physical body were extracted and preserved for later use in line with the said beliefs.

That said, and given that Defoe's work is heavily Christian-biased, it should likewise be worth noting that concerning this topic, we likewise find strong support for cannibalistic practice or beliefs in both Christian practice and scripture:

1. Consider the fact that **Jesus directly sanctified the practice of cannibalism** when he declared:

Take, eat; this is my body... Drink of it, all of you; for this is my blood of the covenant, which is poured out for many for the forgiveness of sins.

—Mathew 26:26-28

2. And again, later, St. Paul recounts and reinforces Jesus's words when he writes, in his first letter to the believers at Corinth thus:

This is my body, which is for you; do this in remembrance of me... This cup is the new covenant in my blood. Whenever you drink it, do this as a memorial of me.

—1 Corinthians 11:23-25

So that, drawing parallels between the European-Judaic practices and beliefs as they survive in both scripture and in **Eucharistic Ritual** practices among Roman-Catholics and most Protestants for example, and what we know or see as being the beliefs and practices of both primitive but also some modern Africans, one starts to see that there is strong evidence that cannibalism is in fact a universally practiced and perhaps even generally⁹² sanctified belief. That both Christians and primitives believed that eating of their dead might help return the dead to life, or perhaps keep them alive as part of the living likewise reinforces bits of the theory concerning cannibalism as it was practiced among the Banyoro as highlighted above. Concerning this theory, also consider the potential implications of St. Paul's words when he says; *Whenever you eat [of his body]... and drink [of his blood], you are proclaiming [him]... until he comes.* (1 Corinthians 11:26).

Last but not least, note that, especially in relation to that last scriptural reference, but also concerning this general theme as well as the hypothesis that Jesus's corpse was possibly "robbed from its grave" and/or mummified as a way to perpetuate him; the reviewer does have plans to leverage bits of these theories in their future work of fiction⁹³, a novel — **The Vampyr Jesu Christ**, concerning the matter of modern and traditional ritual practices and beliefs relating to **keeping the dead alive**. This planned work of fiction is possibly to be centered around the observation that popular Catholic practices of the Eucharistic drinking of blood and eating of bodies of the otherwise [long-]dead Christ have somewhat helped keep a mystery alive across centuries and millenia, and thus the idea of "a vampiric Christ." The appeal to vampirism likewise being fueled by the commonly held belief that among vampires, the drinking of blood is a core practice meant to galvanize the practice, but also perpetuate and immortalize its practitioners.

⁹²Of course, given that Daniel Defoe was neither a Catholic nor Protestant Christian — a Presbyterian to be precise — it should help explain why cannibalism seemed so fiendish to him. Further, that Crusoe not only saved and made a friend of a defiant ex-cannibal, in fact, likewise helping instruct and convert him away from his previous practices and beliefs as we [later] learn in the novel, should help give support to the hypothesis that Defoe wished for his European fellows practicing "civilized forms of cannibalism", such as the Catholics, to likewise convert or deviate away from their *strange* beliefs and practices.

⁹³Refer to an early sketch: <https://t.me/wwwrite/483>, but also associated music: <https://t.me/tv266/1645>

57 Mar 2, 2026 22:06:43 - Concerning Milton-like Reflections in Daniel Defoe's Writing

I sometimes was led too far to invade the Sovereignty of Providence, and as it were arraign the Justice of so arbitrary a Disposition of Things, that should hide that Light from some, and reveal it to others, and yet expect a like Duty from both: But I shut it up, and check'd my Thoughts with this Conclusion, (1st) That we did not know by what Light and Law these should be Condemn'd; but that as God was necessarily, and by the Nature of his Being, infinitely Holy and Just, so it could not be, but that if these Creatures were all sentenc'd to Absence from himself, it was on account of sinning against that Light which, as the Scripture says, was a Law to themselves, and by such Rules as their Consciences would acknowledge to be just, tho' the Foundation was not discover'd to us: And (2nd) that still as we are all the Clay in the Hand of the Potter, no Vessel could say to him, Why hast thou form'd me thus?

These kinds of meditative inner dialogues centered around theological themes and which are scattered all over Defoe's novel compelled me to wonder if it might be that he was either a contemporary of or that he **influenced John Milton**.. because I'd read *Paradise Lost*⁹⁴ before reading *Robinson Crusoe*, and that while reading the later, many times the feeling that **there was a Milton in Defoe's work** got me on a hunt for who might have read or influenced who.. (I had not cared to determine if Milton had lived before or after.. until this moment). Well, here's what I found out when I consulted Copilot in relation to this matter:

My Question to Copilot was: **Let me ask, Daniel Defoe and John Milton, who wrote before who, or who might have read who?**

⁹⁴**John Milton's** *Paradise Lost* is indeed among several beautiful works of English Poetry that I keep returning to every once in a while, in my only copy of a rare compilation of [classic] English Poetry — see [7]

John Milton came first, and Daniel Defoe came later.
Timeline

- John Milton (1608{1674)
 - Major works: *Paradise Lost* (1667), *Areopagitica* (1644), and other poetry and prose.
 - He was already a towering literary figure by the mid-17th century.^a
- Daniel Defoe (c. 1660{1731)
 - Famous for *Robinson Crusoe* (1719), *Moll Flanders* (1722), and political tracts.
 - He wrote in the late 17th and early 18th centuries, after Milton's death.^b

Did Defoe read Milton?

Yes | Defoe was familiar with Milton's work. In his *Political History of the Devil* (1726), Defoe explicitly discusses *Paradise Lost* and critiques Milton's portrayal of Satan, showing he had read and engaged with Milton's ideas.^c

Conclusion

- Milton wrote before Defoe.
- Defoe read Milton and even commented critically on his work.

So, the literary lineage runs: Milton influenced the intellectual climate that Defoe later inherited and responded to.

—Microsoft Copilot, 2025[3]

^aRefer to: <https://www.poetryfoundation.org/poets/john-milton> or <https://www.britannica.com/biography/John-Milton>

^bRefer to: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Daniel_Defoe

^cRefer to https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Political_History_of_the_Devil

58 Mar 2, 2026 22:27:38 - On The Intrigue of Carrying a Gun

I saw a great Fowl like a Hawk sit upon a Tree within Shot; so to let Friday understand a little what I would do, I call'd him to me again, pointed at the Fowl which was indeed a Parrot, tho' I thought it had been a Hawk, I say pointing to the Parrot, and to my Gun, and to the Ground under the Parrot, to let him see I would make it fall, I made him understand that I would shoot and kill that Bird; accordingly I fir'd and bad him look, and immediately he saw the Parrot fall, he stood like one frighted again, notwithstanding all I had said to him; and I found he was the more amaz'd, because he did not see me put any Thing into the Gun; but thought that there must be some wonderful Fund of Death and Destruction in that Thing, able to kill Man, Beast, Bird, or any Thing near, or far off; and the Astonishment this created in him was such, as could not wear off for a long Time; and I believe, if I would have let him, he would have worshipp'd me and my Gun: As for the Gun itself, he would not so much as touch it for several Days after; but would speak to it, and talk to it, as if it had answer'd him, when he was by himself; which, as I afterwards learn'd of him, was to desire it not to kill him.

Defoe makes one think of a gun as a magical wand! In fact, this verse here leaves no doubt that for a person totally unfamiliar with what a gun is, coming across someone that wields and knows to use it is like indeed encountering a god.. **a god of death** to be precise; able to take lives at will, of almost anything living.

59 Mar 12, 2026 20:46:54 - The Process of Converting Primitives to Christianity: Case of Friday's 'Benamuckee' God

ask'd him who made the Sea, the Ground we walk'd on, and the Hills, and Woods; he told me it was one old *Benamuckee*, that liv'd beyond all: He could describe nothing of this great Person, but that he was very old; much older he said than the Sea, or the Land; than the Moon, or the Stars: I ask'd him then, if this old Person had made all Things, why did not all Things worship him; he look'd very grave, and with a perfect Look of Innocence, said, All Things do say O to him: I ask'd him if the People who die in his Country went away any where; he said, yes, they all went to Benamuckee; then I ask'd him whether these they eat up went thither too, he said yes.

In this section of his book, Defoe brings up the interesting matter of how ancient missionaries (such as it seems Crusoe had converted himself into) would go about embarking on a **conversion to Christianity** of a primitive non-Christian. Obvious and important to note, **first, they had to teach them some literacy**, which they did via instructing them in civilized ways such as listening to and speaking English⁹⁵.

Concerning literacy and language, note that in this excerpt, I was somewhat touched by the discovery that this primitive's said deity was known to them by the name "**Benamuckee**". which, somewhat is **appreciably close to God's attribute names** discovered or independently developed — masonic, kabbalistic methods — at our Nuchwezi Esoteric School⁹⁶ — such as "**Zhana-muke**"! Ours of course readily applicable to the same God as is referenced in the Christian scriptures, and which name (among the initiates and illuminates of Nuchwezi) we sometimes also apply by its other anagrams.. "Kahenamuz", "Amenuzahk", etc.⁹⁷ Very interesting discovery!!

Further, note that, even though for Daniel Defoe this deity name was potentially wholly fictional and baseless — unlike the name he'd chosen for the primitive savage in this story.. "Friday" — it could be that a meaningful explanation for the noun could be dug up for those interested in forensic literary analysis.

Otherwise, it was both entertaining and thought-provoking to learn of the process Crusoe applied to the conversion of Friday from his "primitive" beliefs, language and tendencies, into the more "palatable", European-like, Christian-

⁹⁵Despite Robinson Crusoe having had the privilege of owning a physical bible that he often read and consulted, but also given he practiced various forms of record keeping as well as accounting, we cannot readily tell from Defoe's narrative whether or not Crusoe eventually taught the savage how to likewise read and write [English].

⁹⁶Refer to NES and IoN via <https://iona.nuchwezi.com>

⁹⁷Refer to the relevant treatment of **Names and Words of Power** in the reviewer's 2025 treatise: *Grimoire LUMTAUTO*, [6]

ized alternatives. For example, consider Friday's belief that all the dead go or return to their creator irrespective of their known or potential life's conduct and history Vs the Christian belief that some people's souls are damned and would not go to heaven.

60 Mar 12, 2026 20:59:27 - Concerning The Nearly Universal Tendency Across Cultures, of Elevated Priestly Castes as well as Secret Orders

he told me one Day, that if our God could hear us up beyond the Sun, he must needs be a greater God than their Benamuckee, who liv'd but a little way off, and yet could not hear, till they went up to the great Mountains where he dwelt, to speak to him; I ask'd him if ever he went thither, to speak to him; he said no, they never went that were young Men; none went thither but the old Men, who he call'd their Oowocakee, that is, as I made him explain it to me, their Religious, or Clergy, and that they went to say O, (so he called saying Prayers) and then came back, and told them what Benamuckee said: By this I observ'd, That there is Priestcraft, even amongst the most blinded ignorant Pagans in the World; and the Policy of making a secret Religion, in order to preserve the Veneration of the People to the Clergy, is not only to be found in the Roman, but perhaps among all Religions in the World, even among the most brutish and barbarous Savages.

Defoe then (somewhat benevolently) brings up a criticism, not only of the social and psychological control that [organized] religion imposes on society and especially the faithfuls, but also that the same elitist and restricted access to religious and spiritual power that was present in mainstream established Western religions somewhat was also to be found in the spiritual practices of primitive religions such as of the slave he was hellbent on converting from cannibalism and their non-Christian beliefs in Benamuckee.

At this point [in the story being unleashed], it becomes [even more] clearer, **Daniel Defoe really entertained a shockingly strong bias towards Christian Philosophy and themes..** Also got me wondering if this might not be one of the reasons his book[s] (and others like him) lost the attention of modern readers of fiction works. This, especially since it is generally the case (in 20th and 21st century literature for example), that most writers⁹⁸ [and

⁹⁸**Stephen King's** high acclaim and success [1] being great telltale signs of the times... But even more, consider that, in the 20th century [and since], unlike any other time before, the occult and secular has been granted more audience in the public — consider the rise of secular philosophy such as **Friedrich Nietzsche's** at the turn of the 20th century; the two World Wars early to mid 20th- century during which lots of occult and esoteric symbolism

thus readers too] are significantly biased towards occult literature; novels with heavily darker, sinister or perhaps more violent themes than the apologetic, mostly pacific and devotional tones one encounters in the person and practices of Defoe's *Robinson Crusoe*. But.. this perhaps shouldn't come off as a [big] surprise when one considers the time during which Defoe's novel was written — an era in which persecution of non-believers, pagans or deviants, both in England, but also across Europe was still rife; e.g. the **Papal Inquisition**. Thus, one could argue that Defoe's work was written to somewhat appeal to an atmosphere during which one had to heavily appeal to organized religion or perhaps the Church authorities than not. Modern writers though, existing in a generally more liberal but also darker time, seem to be able to enjoy more diverse themes than earlier authors would⁹⁹.

60.1 Later Note

Concerning the times in which Defoe wrote his work[s], as well as the kind of audience he possibly had to entertain, note that, as we saw in **Section 57**, some of his predecessors, but also near-contemporaries, such as **John Milton** — whose major work *Paradise Lost*, despite being Christian-themed too, was strongly sympathetic to **Satan** and his fellows — without doubt remain classifiable under **significantly Christian Literature**. Thus, comparing the works of that era to say, the reviewer's *Shrines of The Free Men*[5] in light of **christian Vs occult** themes or perhaps **moral Vs horror** appeal when one considers works such as Stephen King's *Pet Sematary* (1983) against either Milton or Defoe would somewhat be wrong.

and propaganda such as **Adolf Hitler**'s extensive use of the Swastika got much exposure; the founding of the **Church of Satan** in 1966; "The Occult Revival" issue of the *TIME* magazine that went public on June 19, 1972 featuring a large caricatured inverted pentagram on the cover of the globally popular periodical; the founding of the **Satanic Temple** in 2013 — an organisation that among other notable feats has once erected a 9-foot bronze statue of Baphomet meant to be publicly displayed at the Oklahoma State Capitol, and which organization later organized a heavily attended international conference in 2023 known as *SatanCon* in Boston, USA, etc.

⁹⁹The more critical question here would be **whether a work such as Defoe's, if it were freshly written in today's world, would receive the same attention and appreciation as it did in the 18th century atmosphere?**

61 Mar 12, 2026 21:13:57 - Concerning The Matter of Converting Young People into Zealous Christians

In this thankful Frame I continu'd all the Remainder of my Time, and the Conversation which employ'd the Hours between Friday and I, was such, as made the three Years which we liv'd there together perfectly and compleatly happy, if any such Thing as compleat Happiness can be form'd in a sublunary State. The Savage was now a good Christian, a much better than I; though I have reason to hope, and bless God for it, that we were equally penitent, and comforted restor'd Penitents; we had here the Word of God to read, and no farther off from his Spirit to instruct, than if we had been in England.

So, Yes, finally, Robinson Crusoe successfully made a Christian convert of the ex-cannibal he'd named "Friday" and so that he even became a stronger Christian than him? What a success [story] for [later] christian imperialists! So relatable too..

Thinking about the early christian missionaries that came to Africa and particularly to Uganda — such as who converted numerous Baganda to Catholicism and Protestantism — the likes of **Rev. C.T. Wilson** (protestant) and **Father Simon Lourdel (Fr. Mapera)** (catholic) — it was with pleasure when I read of Defoe's case of Crusoe converting Friday — it essentially helped me appreciate the manner in which these missionaries possibly dealt with our Ugandan forefathers. More noteworthy is the fact that, a little after the first christian converts took on the new faith, they proved to be **too zealous and in a way, more devout than their converters**¹⁰⁰, to the extent they readily accepted to be martyred via live burning — not at the stake as earlier whites had done for [their own] pagans and witches in Europe's inquisition days, but in a manner somewhat related nonetheless!

In fact, this line of inquiry and analysis would make one wonder.. especially given none of the white missionaries — harbingers of a **"problematic" alien faith that saw 45 Ugandans martyred** — ever lost their lives for being christian! It is well known that, like Friday in the *Robinson Crusoe* tale, many of the people that were actually martyred were still young¹⁰¹ and generally innocent converts... And so, just like we see depicted in the zealous character of "Friday" that Crusoe had won over because of mostly the intrigue of his possession of guns, swords, and written knowledge perhaps? The early and mostly fascinated Ugandan christian converts readily offered their lives for the

¹⁰⁰In fact, despite the faith having been introduced to Uganda by purely white, caucasian folks, it is no where in history indicated that any of those whites ever met with persecution or martyrdom the way their African converts did!

¹⁰¹Refer to a feature of the **45 Uganda Martyrs** by the reviewer's MAZERA band ahead of the 2026 annual commemoration and national public holiday in their memory: <https://t.me/mazeraworks/1317>

sake of... [not really able to readily say, what]. Moreover, and in case we were to push this analysis further, who knows... could be that the Europeans that had not only guns, but also the power and knowledge to persuade King Mwanga against the persecution of the young men chose not to intervene. Could be that it was the only, or easiest way to galvanise the Western Church's authority and influence in Africa... perhaps even globally!

Overall, it was so illuminating reading this bit of a "popular" novel whose original story and publication timing predated the arrival of Christianity in much of Africa, including that in Uganda by several centuries!!!

62 Mar 26, 2026 00:58:08 - Concerning The Unreserved Trust in Scriptures as 'The Word of God'

Crusoe is deeply engaged in securing not just his friendship with the ex-savage, but also the security of his christian companionship — a status that's made him a better faithful too. Especially, seems like, possession of and use of the written word in the form of the **Holy Scriptures** played the greatest role in making this happen, as we see when it is said:

As to all the Disputes, Wranglings, Strife and Contention, which has happen'd in the World about Religion, whether Niceties in Doctrines, or Schemes of Church Government, they were all perfectly useless to us; as for ought I can yet see, they have been to all the rest of the World: We had the sure Guide to Heaven, viz. The Word of God; and we had, blessed be God, comfortable Views of the Spirit of God teaching and instructing us by his Word, leading us into all Truth, and making us both willing and obedient to the Instruction of his Word; and I cannot see the least Use that the greatest Knowledge of the disputed Points in Religion which have made such Confusions in the World would have been to us, if we could have obtain'd it; but I must go on with the Historical Part of Things, and take every Part in its order.

Reflecting upon this narrative brings to mind the kind of Christian being advocated for: **a kind of Christian whose relationship with God and whose entire practice of faith is wholly regulated, guided by nothing else except what is laid down in the written word — the scriptures.** Such must be the Christian that Crusoe was, but also, and very possibly, the kind that Daniel Defoe was¹⁰².

Concerning such an approach to religious practice then, particularly, one where one lets go of all traditional authority, religious structure, doctrine, dog-

¹⁰²At this moment during the original reading, I was yet to properly understand or appreciate what kind of person Daniel Defoe was, and it is only later that I built a clearer picture of the man, as a "presbyterian nonconformist" as we see introduced in **Section 3.1**.

mas, interpretations, theories, etc. and only retains the scriptures as the sole source of [all] truth, would it not be questionable if indeed one could still claim, and authoritatively so, to be in possession of the true “Word of God”? Especially when one is thinking as Crusoe seems to allude to here... concerning “The Word of God” that can lead one to “all Truth.”

The problem I see with this line of thought is multifaceted:

This kind of reasoning, though visibly [somewhat] pious and sounding humble in the face of authorities such as the Church, would without doubt be **too simplistic from a purely philosophical perspective**. Why? Because, for starters, no matter what version of the scriptures or Bible that one might have their hands upon, and yet, unless one (the reader) were without doubt either its author or the compiler (for the case of books in the Bible merely revealed through direct divine inspiration), or even at minimum, the translator of their copy from some infallible authoritative source, **one cannot fail to see that any such book would never be the literal word of God**; the book has been handed down through generations for starters, however, with each successive edition or revision, many times the text has either been cast differently sometimes or at least biased towards the taste and interpretation of the editors, translators, copyists etc., so that, by merely realising that **there always exist differences between any two distinct copies of the Bible** — such as Jerusalem vs King James vs Coptic vs New World etc. — the critical reader must then ask themselves, and genuinely so; **“Am I really reading ‘The Word of God’?”**

That failing, then we, without doubt, must find that readers of the scriptures or books such as the Bible, proceed to trust and utilize them as **infallible** sources or guides towards the **truth**, at their own risk or at least merely from **a purely innocent [near-]blind-faith point of view**¹⁰³.

Thus, unless there were no alternative powers, no alternative mechanisms by which the mind or spirit might obtain direct instruction or guidance from God¹⁰⁴, any such (potentially biased or human-tainted) methods as highlighted above — the blind reading and trusting of [any] “holy” scriptures being one — **should be taken or trusted with a grain of salt..** especially when being relied upon by a sincere and capable philosopher such as Robinson Crusoe seems to have started to see himself as.

That Daniel Defoe put such thoughts down in his novel must likewise be an indicator he most likely was also appealing to the [not-so] obvious. It is possible, the analysis we have conducted here would likewise serve well to shed light on the kinds of problems and concerns Defoe wished to lay bare for the reader.

¹⁰³Of course, for a steadfast Christian, this perhaps need not be stressed because, as Jesus once made clear concerning the practice of [effective] faith; **Truly I tell you, unless you change and become like little children, you will never enter the kingdom of heaven.** — **Mathew 18:3**; which, even though it does not necessarily push for blind-faith, does without doubt encourage child-like humility, trust, simplicity, openness and submissiveness to authority/God [3].

¹⁰⁴Such as via praying from the heart, consulting nature, studying and interpreting one's dreams, [correctly] reading omens, etc. For example, we see a method for how to procure answers to arbitrary questions using a kind of upgraded **African Sortilege** being taught to a young apprentice by a seasoned western doctor working at the Presbyterian Mercy Hospital in *Rock ‘N’ Draw*; [2]

63 Mar 26, 2026 01:34:55 - On Initiating a Sailor

After all this was done too, I had my Man Friday to teach as to what belong'd to the Navigation of my Boat; for though he knew very well how to paddle a Canoe, he knew nothing what belong'd to a Sail, and a Rudder; and was the most amaz'd, when he saw me work the Boat too and again in the Sea by the Rudder, and how the Sail gyb'd, and fill'd this way, or that way, as the Course we sail'd chang'd; I say, when he saw this, he stood like one, astonish'd, and amaz'd: However, with a little Use, I made all these Things familiar to him; and he became an expert Sailor, except that as to the Compass, I could make him understand very little of that. On the other hand, as there was very little cloudy Weather, and seldom or never any Fogs in those Parts, there was the less occasion for a Compass, seeing the Stars were always to be seen by Night, and the Shore by Day, except in the rainy Seasons, and then no body car'd to stir abroad, either by Land or Sea.

That many kinds of people around the world have always lived in proximity to lakes, rivers and oceans is indubitable. However, it also is important to realize that the methods and implements with which various kinds of people approached, navigated and leveraged the waters significantly varied too. Thus do we learn here, concerning how, despite Friday having been around oceans most of his life, and that he knew to navigate on water using their kinds of canoe boats as well as an oar, and yet, he knew nothing of the kind of boats that the European Crusoe preferred.

There's much to learn here... first, concerning what kinds of trees a boat can be crafted from — in the novel's text, Defoe mentions the "Nicaragua" tree — then the bells and whistles that go into assembling a conventional "European ship" — one not to be driven using oars and paddles as a canoe would, but instead which, apart from a sail, also requires a rudder and a mast among other paraphernalia; **things which, having grown up and spent most of my own life traveling on land alone, I surely know the least bit — almost nothing — about!**

Also, and worth noting; here in my country — Uganda, *abaana b'enyonyi gyetuva* — we are usually taught in school how we are a "land-locked country"¹⁰⁵. However, despite the country having lots of fresh-water bodies such as lakes and rivers, I cannot really say with certainty that we have seen the

¹⁰⁵The obstinate and defiant still refuse that classification though, many times arguing that Uganda not only boasts of several inland water bodies such as lakes and rivers, but that also, unlike many other countries out there, has several large and small lakes along its geographical borders; Victoria (shared with Kenya and Tanzania), Albert (shared with Democratic Republic of Congo), Edward (also shared with DRC); and then rivers; Semliki, Lamia and Ishasha (all shared with DRC), Kagera (a major tributary of Lake Victoria and which forms part of Uganda's southwestern boundary with Rwanda and Tanzania), and then Suam River on the border with Kenya, but also the Albert Nile — "White Nile" — flowing north away from Uganda into South Sudan and all the way to Egypt and the Mediterranean Sea!

presence of Crusoe's kinds of sail boats anywhere on our waters until very recently — and mostly at elite modern resorts and so-called “sailing clubs” such as one finds in Entebbe along the shores of Lake Victoria, and which are a phenomena mostly imported for the convenience and entertainment of especially foreign tourists. Generally then, one finds that in our local/native day-to-day water navigation needs around Uganda (perhaps even in many parts of modern Africa), folks still resort to “savage-boats” in the form of wooden canoes that are driven using oars and in recent years, also motor engines.

That knowledge of and familiarity with sophisticated sailing, but also overall ocean trekking is still a curiosity for most folks should likewise be emphasized by the kind of fascination that occurred to me when I came across the modern story of a sailor's daughter, Laura, that the BBC covered in relation to her sole world-wide seafaring ventures as retold in **Section 52**.

64 Mar 26, 2026 01:52:05 - Concerning Observing, Recording and Managing the Passage of Time and Seasons Without Any Special Tools

Crusoe is documenting his 27th year dwelling on the Island. He likewise indicates how he's spent close to 3 years living with his acquired servant Friday. We note that, despite lack of sophisticated tools, he's been able to meticulously keep track of both the changing of time and seasons, and can efficiently plan and prepare for the anticipated or likely as we see in the following except:

The rainy Season was in the mean Time upon me, when I kept more within Doors than at other Times; so I had stow'd our new Vessel as secure as we could, bringing her up into the Creek, where as I said, in the Beginning I landed my Rafts from the Ship, and haling her up to the Shore, at high Water mark, I made my Man Friday dig a little Dock, just big enough to hold her, and just deep enough to give her Water enough to fleet in; and then when the Tide was out, we made a strong Dam cross the End of it, to keep the Water out; and so she lay dry, as to the Tide from the Sea; and to keep the Rain off, we laid a great many Boughs of Trees, so thick that she was as well thatch'd as a House; and thus we waited for the Month of November and December, in which I design'd to make my Adventure.

Thus, we learn that, with the same ingenuity that Crusoe leveraged to keep track of time having no clocks or printed calendars in sight, so did he go about securing his lot and properties against waste and wear as the seasons and weather transitioned.

Especially concerning staying in the know with regards to the change of time, days, months and seasons, Defoe's book should be considered a great call

towards preserving and cultivating the ancient skills of using **the reading of nature to both navigate and discern time and seasons**. For sailors such as Crusoe, of course these are basic survival skills — especially for those who would dare sail across vast oceans and seas with little other than the relative position of stars, the moon and the sun to guide them; the book teaches how a fair knowledge of rudimentary astronomy, coupled with the ability to read maps/cartography, but also keen observation of nature ¹⁰⁶ go a long way to help one readily tell where it is they might be when they are sailing the seas with almost no land features in sight most of the time.

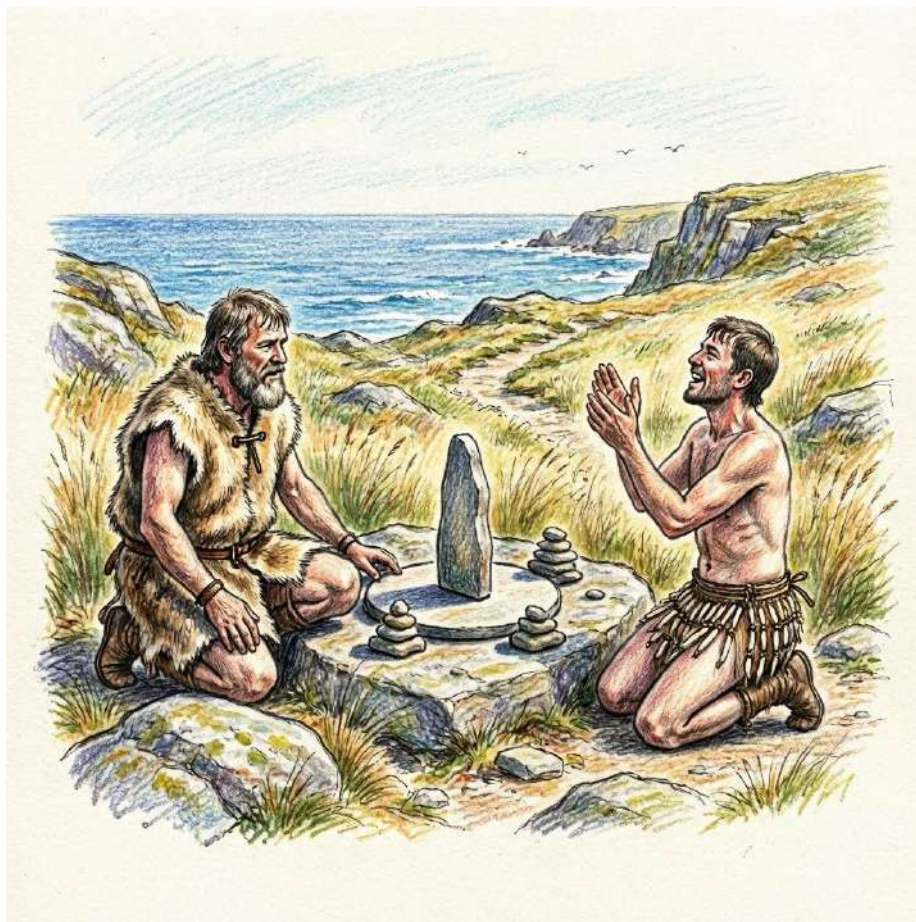


Figure 15: Visualizing Crusoe instructing an excited Friday concerning the rudimentary methods of Reading Time and the Seasons

64.1 Later Note

Personally, I have come to realize that, despite having encountered the subject of astronomy a little bit while studying both geography and physics in school,

¹⁰⁶Such as taking note of the direction and nature of winds and currents, features of land one encounters, etc.

and yet, it is not something I had had the need for in my day-to-day activities as a predominantly land-dwelling African. Moreover, and despite having also encountered literature but also software treating of the related subject of astrology — the ability to forecast or read the times (of individuals, locations, kingdoms, etc.) based on the relative positions of heavenly elements; stars, planets, the moon and sun — and yet, because I haven't grown up hanging around seasoned western esotericists perhaps, even such an arguably useful skill remains mostly a curiosity for me.

However, after reading *Robinson Crusoe*, and having realized the truly significant importance of being able to still tell the date and time without any computers, printed calendars, wrist-watches and such in sight, got me revisiting old knowledge about time-telling that I had encountered earlier on. For example, I started to take serious the wisdom of **reading shadows or telling time using the relative position of shadows** such as would be the case when one leverages **sun dials**. Given that my natural location here in Uganda is close to the Equator, it means, for the vast majority of the time during the year, the sun will for example always be hoisted nearly vertically above one's head at noon/midday. So that, if one consults the shadows of themselves, trees or poles established for the purpose of telling time, one can readily conclude that it is at or around 12:00 if the shadow is almost missing or is directly below a vertically standing object. And then, of course, one can tell that one direction is the East and the other is the West by observing which side of their environment the sun rises from early in the morning (that is East) and where it sets in the evening (that is the West). Thus, once one has an idea where the East and West are, one can then correctly (even if roughly), tell where the North and South are — these would essentially lie along an axis perpendicular to the East-West direction. And with knowledge of where East-West and North-South are, one can correctly set up a reference compass, and thus set up a reference sun-dial for the telling of time; the shadow of the dial points exactly west early in the morning, close to 07:00, and it points east close to 19:00.

As for the telling of the day of the month, I recalled that, typically, the changes in the Earth's shadow upon the moon can be relied upon for the estimation of when it could be during the typical month; for example, when the moon is freshly new and with its illumination almost appearing as just the upwards pointing arc, then it is possibly early in the month — could be around 1st to 10th in terms of days of the month. Then it is most likely that the moon is in its full cycle (with the entire lunar disc illuminated) when the time is close to or around the middle of the month — around 10th to 20th of the month. And then the downward facing lunar arc should appear close to the end of the month. Thus, by taking note of the changes in the shadow on the moon, a man can estimate when it is during a particular month. But also, by observing where the moon was stationed when the night begun, one can have a rough idea what time it is during the night — in the absence of the sun that is!

And then, as for what time of the year it possibly is, one can take note of certain significant features in the night sky — important because, in order to determine what time of the year it possibly is, one ought likewise have in mind where it is they are located on the Earth; **Am I in the northern hemisphere, north of the equator, or southern hemisphere, south of the equator?** As most books of astronomy but also some astrology texts would teach, the simple guides for determining where it is one is located on Earth relative to

the equator are the **North Star** also known as “Polaris”, which essentially is naturally positioned directly above the north pole, and so that, if one is in the southern hemisphere, they cannot see it at all during the night. Whereas, for those in the southern hemisphere, the corresponding significant guide is the **Southern Cross** also known as the “Crux” constellation [3].

Thus, once one knows if they are either north or south of the equator, or perhaps that they are at the equator — concerning knowledge of whether one is at or very close to the equator, of course, the simplest feature would be to notice the relative position of the rising and setting sun; if it almost always rises in the [literal] East and sets in the [literal] West all-year-round, then one is most likely at the equator. Also, it is only at the equator that one can experience the **zero shadow day** — days when, while the sun is at its peak at noon, the shadows of things exactly vanish underneath the objects (something we have also mentioned above). These events typically occur during the “equinoxes”, which are only twice a year. Thus, if one observes the zero shadow days, or instead notices that they can occasionally see both the northern star (perhaps almost barely, and very close to one horizon — northern horizon that is) as well as the southern cross (likewise almost barely, and also close to the other horizon), then they can safely conclude they are most likely near or along the equator.

With knowledge of where one is on Earth then, telling when it is in the year becomes simpler; when in the northern hemisphere, the sun will generally rise in the morning, in the south of the East and also set in the evening in the south of the West, when it is around the beginning/end/winter season of the year — around December solstice that is; days are longest, and the sun takes a high arc across the sky[3]. Whereas, during the middle of the year — around June solstice; the sun would typically rise north of the East and set north of the West; the days are shorter and the sun's arc is low in the sky. So that, for someone in the southern hemisphere then, the reverse/inverse is true!

Thus can one almost reliably, naturally and **with perhaps just their eyes** [and a sun dial/compass], **tell not only what time it is during the day, but also what day of the month it is, as well as where it is they are possibly located on Earth, and thus what time of the year it possibly is!** That this knowledge is still considered generally esoteric is because, as it has always been with many things esoteric; those with the knowledge or know-how are usually elites — such as astronauts, astrologers, priests, magicians, etc. — and that they jealously guard access to such knowledge, so that ordinary folk usually must turn to the “wizard” in order to even tell what time of day it possibly is! However, the story of Crusoe's survival on an obscure island in the middle of an ocean, for many years, with almost no access to civilisation or fellow humans, and yet he needed and did keep track of both the passage of time, months, seasons and years, should inspire modern day readers and students to surely not throw out the baby with the birth-water! Knowledge of ancient wisdom such as astrology, or at least rudimentary astronomy is still crucial even in a world where smart-watches, city/street clocks and the telling of weather forecasts and the changing of seasons is broadcasted during prime-time news on both radio and television [almost daily].

65 Apr 24, 2026 03:03:09 - On Growing, Commanding and Leading an Army or Militant Leadership

Interesting to note that beyond the initial deliverance and acquisition of his savage man Friday, Crusoe later started gaining more access to more wanderers, travelers and survivors arriving by either fate or bait to the Island that had become his own empire and stronghold. Moreover, he continually had to battle with the daunting matter of how to deal with subjects; who to make a prisoner, who to make a comrade, who to promote to a soldier, who to only keep as a friend, who to keep alive, who to eliminate upon first chance,...

As I spoke this with a rais'd Voice and chearful Countenance, I found it greatly encourag'd him; so we set vigorously to our Business: We had upon the first Appearance of the Boat's coming from the Ship, consider'd of separating our Prisoners, and had indeed secur'd them effectually.

Two of them, of whom the Captain was less assur'd than ordinary, I sent with Friday, and one of the three (deliver'd Men) to my Cave, where they were remote enough, and out of Danger of being heard or discover'd, or of finding their way Out of the Woods, if they could have deliver'd themselves: Here they left them bound, but gave them Provisions, and promis'd them if they continu'd there quietly, to give them their Liberty in a Day or two; but that if they attempted their Escape, they should be put to Death without Mercy: They promis'd faithfully to bear their Confinement with Patience, and were very thankful that they had such good Usage, as to have Provisions, and a Light left them; for Friday gave them Candles (such as we made our selves) for their Comfort; and they did not know but that he stood Sentinel over them at the Entrance.

The other Prisoners had better Usage; two of them were kept pinion'd indeed, because the Captain was not free to trust them; but the other two were taken into my Service upon their Captain's Recommendation, and upon their solemnly engaging to live and die with us; so with them and the three honest Men, we were seven Men, well arm'd; and I made no doubt we shou'd be able to deal well enough with the Ten that were a coming, considering that the Captain had said, there were three or four honest Men among them also.

And all the while, he likewise had to consider the desire to build a reliable team with whom he might "escape" his own isolated kingdom so as to return to England — where it still is not clear he'd find the same status and honours as he was enjoying in the remote world that nature and fate had somewhat carved

out for him.

65.1 Later Note

The key lesson here is one of learning **how to lead as a Commander but also as a Sovereign** — a kind of “Governour” as Robinson Crusoe started referring to himself a little hereafter. It can be such a daunting task especially as one’s army, subjects, but also potential foes keep increasing!

Talking of cases when one must learn to manage the growth and expansion of not only territory, but also power — manpower, resources, influence and control, but also responsibility and accountability — the famous story of Uganda’s longest serving president¹⁰⁷ — **H.E. Yoweri Kaguta Museveni** — as well as the associated tale that he actually once embarked on seizing the power/governance of Uganda as a sole commander of just a handful of men and with just a few AK47 guns goes something like this¹⁰⁸:

Yoweri Museveni’s rise to power began with a small guerrilla force of just 27 fighters and 27 guns in 1981, which grew into the National Resistance Army (NRA) and eventually toppled Uganda’s government in 1986 after a brutal five-year Bush War. His campaign combined military strategy, popular mobilization, and political organization, reshaping Uganda’s history.

—Microsoft Copilot, 2026[3]

However, for students and readers of Daniel Defoe’s *Robinson Crusoe*, learning of some of the specifics surrounding Museveni’s rise to power as well as some of the special aspects of his military strategies, and comparing these to what one learns of Crusoe’s conquests and militaristic adventures, it starts to feel as though, **perhaps and very likely, that Museveni had some idea about Daniel Defoe’s works and military methods.** To help students of both paint the picture, here are some more specifics about Museveni’s conquest that might drive the point home:

¹⁰⁷Currently in power (Uganda’s President that is) as long as the reviewer has been alive — since 1986! Also, refer to reviewer’s paper on the matter:
<https://t.me/ugandanow/4482>

¹⁰⁸Also refer to

- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ugandan_Bush_War
- <https://www.jstor.org/stable/45381043>
- <https://books.google.com/books/about/Combatants.html>

Museveni's Bush War and Rise to Power:**Background:**

1. **Idi Amin's regime (1971--1979):** Amin ruled Uganda through terror until Tanzanian forces and Ugandan exiles ousted him in 1979.
2. **Milton Obote's return (1980):** After disputed elections widely seen as rigged, Obote regained power, sparking opposition.
3. **Museveni's decision:** Convinced peaceful politics were impossible, Museveni and his comrades retreated to the bush to wage guerrilla war.

—Microsoft Copilot, 2026[3]

Comparing Museveni's decision to abandon [originally preferred] pacific leadership and instead resort to militaristic conquest and control could likewise be likened to how, in *Robinson Crusoe*, we learn of Crusoe's originally pacific and detached/unconcerned nature towards the savages and potential foes that frequented his territory, and how, after thinking extensively through it (see **Section 49** but also earlier **Section 48**), Crusoe finally decided to embark on military ventures to secure his lot, but also grow his influence and control — refer to **Section 53**.

But that's not all, consider what followed thereafter...

The Bush War (1981--1986)

1. **Starting point:** On 6 February 1981, Museveni launched the rebellion with 27 men and 27 rifles in the Luwero Triangle.
2. **Growth of the NRA:** By 1983, the force had expanded to about 4,000 fighters, and by late 1985, nearly 10,000.
3. **Civilian support:** Many villagers joined or aided the NRA, partly out of fear of government brutality and partly due to Museveni's promises of reform.
4. **Tactics:** Guerrilla warfare, ambushes, and political education programs helped the NRA sustain itself against a much larger government army.

—Microsoft Copilot, 2026[3]

Note how, for Museveni's venture, he started out with just 27 men taking on an entire government's army, while, for the case of Robinson Crusoe, he's starting out with just 7:

two were taken into my Service upon their Captain's Recommendation, and upon their solemnly engaging to live and die with us; so with them and the three honest Men, **we were seven Men, well arm'd**; and I made no doubt we shou'd be able to deal well enough with the Ten that were a coming

—Daniel Defoe, *The Life and Adventures of Robinson Crusoe*, 2000[4]

But, and as anyone who has read Defoe shall tell, victory in militaristic conquests isn't just about the number of men one has, nor whether or not one's army is equipped with guns or swords. Instead, strategy, planning, and elements of surprise can likewise go a long way as we further learn concerning Museveni's adventures too:

Key Turning Points

1. **1983--1984:** Heavy fighting in the Luwero Triangle devastated communities, with estimates of 100,000--300,000 deaths.
2. **1985 coup:** Obote was overthrown by General Tito Okello, who sought peace with rebels. Museveni refused compromise.
3. **Final push:** From August to December 1985, the NRA captured large parts of western and southern Uganda.
4. **Victory:** On 29 January 1986, Museveni's NRA marched into Kampala, seizing power and establishing the National Resistance Movement (NRM) government.

Factors Behind Success

1. **Small disciplined force:** Allowed mobility and surprise attacks.
2. **Civilian mobilization:** Secured food, intelligence, and recruits.
3. **Political education:** Built legitimacy beyond military strength.
4. **Government brutality:** Drove civilians toward the NRA.
5. **Strategic patience:** Avoided premature battles, focused on gradual expansion.

—Microsoft Copilot, 2026[3]

Of course, and as one shall establish when/after reading [4], Robinson Crusoe did meet with resistance several times, however, he also registered multiple success stories in many of his armed ventures, and in fact, he went on to build a fine legacy even after he'd returned to Europe (more on this later). However, for completeness's sake, and since we have embarked on **tracing any parallels**

or links between either **Museveni and Daniel Defoe** (both are Christians that are non-Catholic for starters...) or **Museveni and Robinson Crusoe** (both are militant leaders with an eye for conquest and sovereignty,...), it shall serve well to leave here an idea of what legacy Museveni has thus far left behind (he's still alive as of this writing):

Legacy

1. Museveni's Bush War is considered one of the few successful post-colonial guerrilla movements in Africa.
2. His victory reshaped Uganda's politics, ending years of coups and instability.
3. However, his long rule since 1986 has sparked debate: once seen as a liberator, Museveni is now criticized for authoritarian tendencies and overstaying in power.

—Microsoft Copilot, 2026[3]

66 Apr 24, 2026 03:24:55 - How Cleverness or Creativity in Military Conquests Can Seem Preternatural

At length they came up to the Boat; but 'tis impossible to express their Confusion, when they found the Boat fast a-Ground in the Creek, the Tide ebb'd out, and their two Men gone: We could hear them call to one another in a most lamentable Manner, telling one another, they were gotten into an enchanted Island; that either there were Inhabitants in it, and they should all be murther'd, or else there were Devils and Spirits in it, and they should be all carry'd away, and devour'd.

This was such an amusing read! Seeing as indeed, Crusoe's mixed strategies of conquest involved both moral pacifism and thoughtful resolve to eliminate foes and risk, which many times left his would-be prisoners on the strange island indeed mystified without doubt!

66.1 Later Note

For the sake of drawing some parallels, it shall be worth noting that the reviewer has actually previously worked on some literature whose themes would readily bring to mind the chaos and allure of this scene from *Robinson Crusoe*. The work of concern is a novella — almost just a short-story — written in Luganda though, during 2023, and only first officially published in 2024 via his literature archives on Telegram under the title *Embaga Ku Rina Island* — see [8].



Figure 16: One of the original story illustrations for the reviewer's 2023 novella titled *Embaga Ku Rina Island*, [8], a story which, more than any of his existing works, resonates most strongly with Defoe's 18th century tale of adventures on an island.

From author of "Shrines of The Free Men"

Embaga Ku Rina Island



Mini-novel by

JOSEPH W. LUTALO

Figure 17: Original cover of *Embaga Ku Rina Island*, [8], a JWL story that resonates well with *Robinson Crusoe* in several regards.

67 Apr 24, 2026 03:52:20 - Crusoe Obtains a Ship!

We finally learn of the beginnings of Crusoe's deliverance from the island of his captivity, when, after much strife, persuasion and patience, Crusoe finally had a ship given him by none other than an embattled captain he'd earlier-on helped save after his ship had been taken over by deserters!

The deliverance manifested as such...

As soon as the Ship was thus secur'd, the Captain order'd seven Guns to be fir'd, which was the Signal agreed upon with me, to give me Notice of his Success, which you may be sure I was very glad to hear, having sat watching upon the Shore for it till near two of the Clock in the Morning.

Having thus heard the Signal plainly, I laid me down; and it having been a Day of great Fatigue to me, I slept very sound, 'till I was something surpriz'd with the Noise of a Gun; and presently starting up, I heard a Man call me by the Name of Governour, Governour, and presently I knew the Captain's Voice, when climbing up to the Top of the Hill, there he stood, and pointing to the Ship, he embrac'd me in his Arms, My dear Friend and Deliverer, says he, there's your Ship, for she is all yours, and so are we and all that belong to her. I cast my Eyes to the Ship, and there she rode within little more than half a Mile of the Shore; for they had weighed her Anchor as soon as they were Masters of her; and the Weather being fair, had brought her to an Anchor just against the Mouth of the little Creek; and the Tide being up, the Captain had brought the Pinnace in near the Place where I at first landed my Rafts, and so landed just at my Door.

And so, starts to look like he'd finally earned his majestic return to his homeland after so many years of unconditional captivity on the island in the middle of nowhere!

68 Apr 24, 2026 04:00:09 - Experiencing Deliverance Can Shake One to The Bone!

I was at first ready to sink down with the Surprise. For I saw my Deliverance indeed visibly put into my Hands, all things easy, and a large Ship just ready to carry me away whither I pleased to go. At first, for some time, I was not able to answer him one Word; but as he had taken me in his Arms, I held fast by him, or I should have fallen to the Ground.

He perceived the Surprise, and immediately pulls a Bottle out of his Pocket, and gave me a Dram of Cordial, which he had brought on Purpose for me; after I had drank it, I sat down upon the Ground; and though it brought me to my self, yet it was a good while before I could speak a Word to him.

All this while the poor Man was in as great an Extasy as I, only not under any Surprise, as I was; and he said a thousand kind tender things to me, to compose me and bring me to my self; but such was the Flood of Joy in my Breast, that it put all my Spirits into Confusion, at last it broke out into Tears, and in a little while after, I recovered my Speech.

Having read this far the tale of Crusoe, and having co-endured through all thick and thin with him as narrated by Defoe, it surely was touching to experience Crusoe elated at the realization he finally had his **deliverance**! A years-long prayer finally answered!

69 Apr 24, 2026 04:30:11 - Crusoe, Blessed with Fine Accolades Upon his Deliverance, With Cascading Timeless Effects Felt by His Reviewer as Well!

First he had brought me a Case of Bottles full of excellent Cordial Waters, six large Bottles of Madera Wine; the Bottles held two Quarts a-piece; two Pound of excellent good Tobacco, twelve good Pieces of the Ship's Beef, and six Pieces of Pork, with a Bag of Pease, and about a hundred Weight of Bisket...

This part of the story.. when Crusoe was brought presents from the ship he'd conquered, also somewhat read as **"a gift" to me the reviewer** of Defoe's book; first, the relief that Crusoe finally was going home in glory! As the reader of the novel over a period longer than a year, twas such a jubilant

moment¹⁰⁹. And then, at the mention of “**Madera**”, two things occurred in my mind, in fact, three;

1. Years ago (hahaha... actually circa 2023), I wrote a novella titled *Club 69*¹¹⁰ whose story is mostly centered around a girl's boutique shop¹¹¹ in my favourite neighborhood town of Abaita Ababiri — on the way to Entebbe Airport, and that the name of that shop is actually “Madra”, but also sometimes referred to by “Maa-dre”! It was such a big surprise, seeing such a subtlety occur in a story I wrote years before I'd [ever] picked up Robinson Crusoe [for a thorough reading]!
2. And then I realized how close this liquor name is to my own dream band, “MAZERA”¹¹² — our own pioneering metal on keys band from Uganda! Perhaps the only one of its kind in Africa too! Further, and worth noting too, “Mazera” the band did get a mention in the above mentioned novella *Club 69* even though at the time, I didn't consciously notice any such link between “Madra” and “Mazera”¹¹³.
3. Finally.. and very touching — if not a bit of a stretch — “Madera” and “Nyandera” somewhat... No, without doubt do actually rhyme! Moreover, the later is **my mother's surname!**

Such an interesting string of synchronicities, so that, I, too — just like Robinson Crusoe elated at the reception of all those accolades — felt somewhat lost of words! It felt as though I'd been somewhat living in Defoe's story over the years without knowing! What a strange deliverance it was to reach this moment.. such a wonderful milestone almost impossible to express in words!

¹⁰⁹For regular readers of novels especially — since those are the kind of stories that drag the reader deep into the plot so that one even starts to relate to or associate with characters in the narrative — it should not come as a surprise when one starts to get emotionally attached to people and places in the story. Similar things might likewise happen when one watches a nice movie or perhaps a lengthy soap or series, but for written works, especially fiction, the novel typically is the kind that evokes such effects, and yes, Defoe somewhat had it in him to make things happen in our lives several centuries since his story was penned!

¹¹⁰Written around the same time as [8], *Club 69* is likewise a self-published short-story, a thicker plot and novella than actually [8], and which is likewise hosted online at the reviewer's literature archives: <https://t.me/wwwwrite/26>

¹¹¹Theme of a shop, apart from being related to **Daniel Defoe's profession as a merchant** — see **Section 3.1** — but is also, in fact, more correctly related to the reviewer's own “Menuza Bytes” shop brought up in the discussion about Laura the mannequin in **Section 52**, and which, for those interested in going down that rabbit hole, maintains an online presence at: <https://menuzabytes.nuchwezi.com>

¹¹²Refer to <https://t.me/mazeraworks>

¹¹³In retrospect, it's also indeed interesting how they both relate to Defoe's “Madera”

70 Apr 27, 2026 23:28:12 - Concerning Defoe's Unusual Writing Style

After some time, I came thither dress'd in my new Habit, and now I was call'd Governour again; being all met, and the Captain with me, I caused the Men to be brought before me, and I told them, I had had a full Account of their villanous Behaviour to the Captain, and how they had run away with the Ship, and were preparing to commit farther Robberies, but that Providence had ensnar'd them in their own Ways, and that they were fallen into the Pit which they had digged for others.

I had had a.. Then I knew I'd surely obtained authority in English literature having read that kind of line in a classic like Daniel Defoe!

That said, it's quite interesting reading classics.. the vocabulary sometimes comes off as awkward.. for example the use of "Habit" here to describe some sort of special dressing (what in modern speak we might refer to as a kind of "cosplay"?) Interesting because, most of my life, I heard the term "Habit" only used to refer to clothing when talking of those formal wear donned by the religious; nuns especially. Until this encounter, in my mind, twas that *only nuns have habits!*

The other observations I have made concerning the writing style in Defoe's *Robinson Crusoe* is that oftentimes, one comes across bits of the text that might seem illegitimate by modern grammar standards; narrative expressing verbatim conversation between characters but which generally omits use of "quotes"; also, one finds that such lines sometimes suddenly kickoff with capitalization right in the middle of a sentence, with a coma to delimit the context from the verbatim utterance; the Capitalization of words that are not nouns or rather, peculiar use of Title Case Right in the Middle of sentences, etc.

That this is *ancient* text is appreciable. It is *Olde Englysh* for gods sake! One must be glad that the Oxford World's Classics series preserved the Daniel Defoe manuscript in its original form so we can encounter and appreciate what his original style was! Other than several other works — mostly poetry — that I have encountered curated in books such as my only copy of **The Oxford Anthology of Great English Poetry**, [7], such English and styles as of Defoe might be near impossible to come by in modern literature. Thus, students and fellow writers... **Why n't Pick thine Leayf, from Daniel??**

71 Apr 27, 2026 23:46:20 - Concerning The Spirit of Expanding and Perpetuating Territory and Influence present in Robinson Crusoe

I left them my Fire Arms, viz. Five Muskets, three Fowling Pieces, and three Swords. I had above a Barrel and half of Powder left; for after the first Year or two, I used but little, and wasted none. I gave them a Description of the Way I manag'd the Goats, and Directions to milk and fatten them, and to make both Butter and Cheese.

In a Word, I gave them every Part of my own Story; and I told them, I would prevail with the Captain to leave them two Barrels of Gun-Powder more, and some Garden-Seeds, which I told them I would have been very glad of; also I gave them the Bag of Pease which the Captain had brought me to eat, and bad them be sure to sow and encrease them.

The two hostages — originally part of the crew of deserters that had attempted to seize their Captain's ship — thus survived the threat of being delivered to English authorities to be tried and hanged for their crimes, and instead got rewarded by becoming the inheritors of Crusoe's Island!

Despite being very calculative, one must appreciate that Crusoe has an interestingly fair way of dealing with villains; he not only groomed them himself — to become **his chosen inheritors** of the wild island he'd both mastered and tamed for more than a quarter of a century, but that he likewise ensured they are provided with sufficient security so as to keep their inheritance. Crusoe was such a gentleman, a merciful one too!

71.1 Later Note

Of course, thinking back to how he'd once ventured into the Brazils and how he'd established a vast and productive sugarcane plantation there [4], but which he later decided to leave behind so as to venture even further, one must then appreciate that Defoe was the kind of person who wasn't easily trapped nor attached/bound to immediate possessions or endowments. Thus, and perhaps, as we have noted, concerning the spirit of both the Spanish and later the British in **Section 35.1** — that ambitiously sought to establish themselves and their territory/empire across the vast spectrum of the planet Earth — we likewise see this kind of spirit expressed in the character of Robinson Crusoe; continuously venturing, exploring, but also establishing new territory for his future selves almost everywhere he goes¹¹⁴.

¹¹⁴I am glad that in my brief life thus far, especially across academia (but also in domains such as art, music and esoterica), I have continuously entertained and adhered to the related motto attributed to ancient philosopher, **Socrates**, and who is said to have uttered it at his trial (399 BCE), when he chose death over exile [3], and which has since been passed on by his student **Plato of Athens** in his *Apology* (section 38a); for me, it generally goes; "**A life**

72 Apr 28, 2026 00:11:43 - 28 Years in Captivity of 35 Years Being Away from England, Crusoe Finally Arrives Home!

When I took leave of this Island, I carry'd on board for Reliques, the great Goat's-Skin-Cap I had made, my Umbrella, and my Parrot; also I forgot not to take the Money I formerly mention'd, which had lain by me so long useless, that it was grown rusty, or tarnish'd, and could hardly pass for Silver, till it had been a little rubb'd, and handled; as also the Money I found in the Wreck of the Spanish Ship.

And thus I left the Island, the Nineteenth of December, as I found by the Ship's Account, in the Year 1686, after I had been upon it eight and twenty Years, two Months, and 19 Days; being deliver'd from this second Captivity, the same Day of the Month, that I first made my Escape in the Barco-Longo, from among the Moors of Sallee.

In this Vessel, after a long Voyage, I arriv'd in England, the Eleventh of June, in the Year 1687, having been thirty and five Years absent.

Finally, we learn of Robinson Crusoe's return to England, his homeland and motherland, after longer than a quarter of a century!

Interesting that he returned with these particularly mentioned relics.. the goat skins he'd used for clothing while in captivity on the Island.. somewhat reminiscent of [the still respectable even if acutely rare nowadays] traditional formal clothings in our present-day Africa. However, only that his Island only had goats for big game to speak of, but in respectable modern-day animal-hide attire, especially for royals and high-repute shamans and witch-doctors [but also for travelers/tourists¹¹⁵], are **the hides and furs of so-called power animals**; leopards (most typical in stately function wear for kings), lions (quite very rare, perhaps the stuff of truly lifted GOATS such as **S.A. LaVey**), python¹¹⁶, and despite being readily available and more legal to possess, cow and goat hides¹¹⁷. Before leaving this topic though, it should likewise be worth noting

unexplored is not worth living."

¹¹⁵So-called "*abatabazi*" — who "wander" or adventure especially for esoteric or spiritual purposes. Also, whose practice might be likened to 20th century writer **Carlos Castaneda's Don Juan's** idea of having to "shift the assemblage point" — an energy/etheric concept — that might likewise be related to the classical masonic concept of "Loci" and special physical locations as "Memory Palaces", that underlie the idea that by changing the locus of awareness (whether energetic or spatial), one alters [their] perception and consciousness. Ideas that both seafarers and adventure-seekers such as Crusoe might share with our sometimes nomadic-on-purpose African people.

¹¹⁶Especially seen worn as either shoes, bags or belts or even as "magical belts" — a fair treatment of which we have in the reviewer's [6].

¹¹⁷It might not be immediately clear why most elite frown upon wearing cow or goat skins nowadays, instead mostly finding that these are perhaps better utilized for the crafting of bags and drums. Very likely, the mentioned idea; aka. "power animals"; is most likely to blame

that, if for any other reason, it is more popular nowadays — in my Africa, or rather, here in Uganda — that when people revert to or wish to express themselves in traditional garments not directly made of synthetic material, most readily found shall be the use of **bark cloth** which is crafted from the barks of particular esoterically honorable trees¹¹⁸, instead of folks donning cloths made of animal hides. Essentially, there's a whole line of [interesting] inquiry here, for scholars and authorities interested in pursuing Defoe's fascination with the subject.

And then the coins... Hahaha! I too recall that upon completion of my longest foreign journey away from my home country (twas in Ethiopia¹¹⁹), I made sure to return with a fair collection of foreign coins as memorabilia even though most got vandalized from me a while thereafter! It's like returning home from a war.. one surely must always take home some spoils or relics¹²⁰!

73 Apr 28, 2026 00:21:09 - Concerning Tracing One's Family [Roots] or Lineage in the Face of Prolonged Absence

I went down afterwards into Yorkshire; but my Father was dead, and my Mother, and all the Family extinct, except that I found two Sisters, and two of the Children of one of my Brothers; and as I had been long ago given over for dead, there had been no Provision made for me; so that in a Word, I found nothing to relieve, or assist me; and that little Money I had, would not do much for me, as to settling in the World.

Thus we learn of how Crusoe returned home after such a longtime, he'd essentially been regarded long dead, his own family was almost all gone already, and he somewhat only had his experiences and a marginal extended family left, with whom he'd then have to kick-start the rest of his life!

A good lesson here is for modern families to ensure to always preserve lineage and family tree records for future references and traceability; could be

— **who would view a cow or goat as a symbol of power or authority?** And yet, in one way or another, several local/African cultures — e.g the Cwezi, but also several global cultures — e.g goths, pagans and occultists, respectively still hold both the cow and goat as respectable power animals and symbols. These later associations might likewise be explained by the ancient Egyptian/African honoring of the goddess **Hathor** typically depicted as either just a cow or a woman with cow horns and a solar disk, while the goat symbolism might be likened to/associated with the ancient Greek godform **Pan**, typically expressed as a man with goat's horns, hind legs, tail and sometimes even a goat's face [3].

¹¹⁸Such as, and most especially the "*Omutuba*" species.

¹¹⁹Thanks to a friend and elder, **Mr. Ivan Lumala**, former CTO of Microsoft Africa, that invited me to go work alongside his team and fellows from the University of Tulane (USA), for the Ethiopian Ministry of Health concerning Data Engineering and Analytics for Tele-Medicine and e-Health, between 2016 and 2019.

¹²⁰Helps to keep alive memories of one's adventures, victories and encounters! Also creates so-called "magical links" between the traveler and the places, people or entities one encountered on their travels and adventures.

well-kept wall-mounted family-tree organograms; could be hard-cover or sealable photograph albums or collections; could be annotated portrait collections mounted in sitting rooms, studies or hallways; could be annotated busts or compound/walkway mounted sculptures, etc. In fact, even having well-maintained family websites or online family galleries or perhaps well kept records in global lineage directories such as **Ancestry.com** or, and yes, for lucky public figures such as Daniel Defoe, even well curated, well articulated pages in public encyclopedias such as **Wikipedia.org** could serve this purpose well. This, so that, in case a family's members get somewhat scattered — such as during wars, natural catastrophes, foreign studies or work, etc. and that they later must trace each other, they have a coherent, reliable way to establish who was who, where, when, etc.

74 Apr 28, 2026 01:02:28 - Concerning Fevers of Joy and Their Potential Remedies

Having successfully returned back to his homeland in England, and finding that much of what he could have survived upon was long gone, Crusoe then embarked on a journey to Portugal, particularly Lisbon, and while there did reach out to his past accomplices in a foreign land he'd once visited and where he'd made extensive investments; the "Brasils" as he often liked to call them; from where, because of his earlier investments in both estate and farming, he could make a claim of what was still surviving of that treasure. Thus we learn of what happened once he established that indeed, he had more wealth available to him [from those earlier undertakings] than he might have use for...

I might well say, now indeed, That the latter End of Job was better than the Beginning. It is impossible to express here the Flutterings of my very Heart, when I look'd over these Letters, and especially when I found all my Wealth about me; for as the Brasil Ships come all in Fleets, the same Ships which brought my Letters, brought my Goods; and the Effects were safe in the River before the Letters came to my Hand. In a Word, I turned pale, and grew sick; and had not the old Man run and fetch'd me a Cordial, I believe the sudden Surprise of Joy had overset Nature, and I had dy'd upon the Spot.

Nay after that, I continu'd very ill, and was so some Hours, 'till a Physician being sent for, and something of the real Cause of my Illness being known, he order'd me to be let Blood; after which, I had Relief, and grew well: But I verily believe, if it had not been eas'd by a Vent given in that Manner, to the Spirits, I should have dy'd.

Interesting read! First, **the reference to the book and story of Job...** Such an ominous tale in the ballads of God's faithfuls. A somewhat undeniably bitter-sweet lesson too, albeit encouraging, that God's faithfuls might oftentimes

meet with extreme adversity and loss, and yet, eventually they get restored to, or even obtain rewards beyond their original expectations. A lesson in moral and Christian philosophy expected of Defoe given the afflictions he himself often met with in his life.

74.1 Later Note

And then **fevers of joy!** I mean.. seems like Defoe had a thing for experiencing extreme “tears of joy” — refer to an earlier episode covered in **Section 68**. That a man somewhat impoverished and devoid of honors can drop dead from sudden exuberance and/or opulence should likewise sound as a warning to fools that suddenly win the Lottery or sloths that mysteriously obtain a large inheritance! Defoe's Crusoe of course wasn't such a person — first, he'd ever been in possession of vast wealth and honor, and equitably so. But also, he was a hardworking man and such that, he should not have been shocked nor surprised when the fruits of his extensive portfolio were suddenly presented to him. And yet, Defoe warns that even for a person as entitled as Crusoe, such a sudden revelation nearly killed him!¹²¹

So much fine things to learn or glean from Defoe's wonderful story telling and moral lessons..

And then **the bloodletting...** I've previously read about and reviewed a modern treatise on the mathematics of blood — so-called “Hemomath” by **Professor Antonio Fasano**, Lisboa, Portugal — when I was writing my own take on the matter from an entirely different angle — “blood as a sequence” and not as Fasano's “blood as a fluid system”¹²². Professor Fasano did mention the “ancient” or perhaps pre-modern practice of healing by “letting blood”. Essentially, via lesions on a patient's skin made using a blade and by the doctor, the blood of a person is allowed to voluntarily ooze as a therapeutic practice! In fact, it was via reading his work that I also came to learn of the related, totally strange, practice of likewise combining blood-letting with use of literal leeches to aid in riding the sick person of “bad blood”(sic).

It is against that background and my encountering of the peculiar practice being mentioned in Defoe's book, hahaha, that I suddenly started to relate Crusoe's treatment in Enlightenment-era Europe with modern-day practices of not only blood-sample collections (used as part of clinical diagnosis), but also blood transfusion (used to solicit for blood in significant volumes that is to later be stored in blood banks for the sake of giving it back to afflicted patients later). This perhaps was among few medical-theme encounters in *Robinson Crusoe* that one might liken to an extensive treatment of medical lore in the reviewer's *Rock 'N' Draw*.

¹²¹An alternative way to interpret the message is that; overwhelming news, whether good or bad, might indeed overwhelm the recipient, and sometimes, fatally so!

¹²²Refer to *TRANSFORMATICS in Psychology* (2025); <https://doi.org/10.20944/preprints202510.0456.v1>

75 Apr 28, 2026 01:28:49 - A Criticism of Papistry

I had once a Mind to have gone to the Brasils, and have settled my self there; for I was, as it were, naturaliz'd to the Place; but I had some little Scruple in my Mind about Religion, which insensibly drew me back, of which I shall say more presently.

and then...

when I began to think of living and dying among them, I began to regret my having profess'd my self a Papist, and thought it might not be the best Religion to die with.

First, it's honestly my first time to come across this term... “**Papist**”, which (thanks to my research assistant, [3]), I just established was originally not only used to refer to “Roman Catholics” or rather “followers of The Pope” — especially **after the Reformation and splitting of England from the jurisdiction of Rome**, but also that it was especially **used in a derogatory way given how much antagonism there was between Protestants and Catholics in Defoe's time**.

75.1 Later Note

This extra context now helps explain much of the sentiment in that excerpt but also bits of what one finds in earlier parts of the book; **Despite Daniel Defoe being a Presbyterian — somewhat, a kind of Protestant, and yet, seems like his character, Robinson Crusoe, was a kind of Catholic?**

Overall, seems like, despite Crusoe having lived and prospered amongst the people of the then-predominantly Portuguese-colonized Brazil — which, like most of South America¹²³ that was under predominantly Spanish dominion — was indeed Catholic [3], and yet, he felt uneasy returning to such an atmosphere after years in solitary exile and away from conventional religions and society. It is not very clear then, if perhaps he preferred to live and die among [English] Protestants then? But, most likely, it should be that, given Defoe's own religious affiliations, this bit of the story is thus tainted or visibly biased against Catholicism — for obvious reasons.

¹²³[3] tells me that Protestantism was instead more prevalent in the British colonies such as North America and the Caribbean. So that, the rest of the Americas were mostly Catholic territory.

76 Apr 28, 2026 01:41:00 - On The Long-Lost Humane Practice of Exchanging Letters and Gifts with Remote Friends

Lastly, I wrote to my Partner, acknowledging his Industry in the Improving the Plantation, and his Integrity in encreasing the Stock of the Works, giving him Instructions for his future Government of my Part, according to the Powers I had left with my old Patron, to whom I desir'd him to send whatever became due to me, 'till he should hear from me more particularly; assuring him that it was my Intention, not only to come to him, but to settle my self there for the Remainder of my Life: To this I added a very handsom Present of some Italian Silks for his Wife, and two Daughters, for such the Captain's Son inform'd me he had; with two Pieces of fine English broad Cloath, the best I could get in Lisbon, five Pieces of black Bays, and some Flanders Lace of a good Value.

It is worth noting that many of the finer bits of cultured or civilized life that people in Defoe's days enjoyed are only but a distant memory in modern times, even among the wealthy and cultured by today's standards; for example, **people hardly treasure letter writing anymore** — the kind of formal correspondence using especially ink and paper, and that I at least had the chance to experience and enjoy as a kid during my primary school days; corresponding with remote penpals and benefactors that our Catholic school (Kisubi Boys P/S) helped put us in touch with.

Twas in the 90s; Internet had already come, but was generally still a niche thing for us ordinary folk and most of the general public, and so that, snail mail with handwritten letters as well as envelopes with postage stamps¹²⁴ were still a thing! To be called-out at the school parade when one's letters had been responded to, and when one then had an incoming letter from a foreign friend was such a wonderful childhood experience hard to forget! We really should miss those times oh my God!

And then, later on, once I'd grown into a big man and had founded my first business and company; the **Nuchwezi Research**¹²⁵ laboratory, I made sure to get us a snail mail post address. For nearly a decade since founding, we owned the box 3 at Kisubi post office, and I recall that, apart from the occasional — actually annual — calls from a one **Mr. Robert Ssemambo** that operated the Posta Uganda office at Mt. St. Theresa hill (right outside the gate to Savio Junior School), and who, when he called me — not because there was a letter or

¹²⁴I recall postage stamps being a special kind of sticker that somewhat looked like today's paper money/legal tender but much smaller — often squarish in shape, and that they often had pictures on them depicting iconic artefacts or people of contemporary society; e.g the then **Queen Elizabeth of England**, the Eiffel Tower in Paris, Uganda's Robusta Coffee on twigs, etc.

¹²⁵We nowadays prefer to call it, or emphasize "Nuchwezi Research", however, it still is just the good ol' "Nuchwezi", located in Bugabo, Garuga, and online at nuchwezi.com

parcel for **P.O. Box 3, Kisubi**, but that my annual invoice for the post-office tax was due — my heart would momentarily leap, in anticipation of whether or not there might likewise be a letter waiting for me. However, and as time went by, I discovered that indeed, letter writing — in the traditional way that is, but also the formal exchange of parcels — had surely become dead craft¹²⁶. And so, around early 2023 perhaps, I chose to retire the snail mail service avenue, so that we only retained our official email and phone contacts as the formal communications channels for our office. But still, reading about the exchange of letters in *Robinson Crusoe* does reawaken some interest in the matter, and I wonder... who out there, might still have the time and interest to engage in a long-term exchange of traditional letters with me?¹²⁷

And then **concerning the exchange of gifts and presents...** That people in Defoe's time often expressed gratitude by offering each other presents in kind (other than literal money which is more common between friends and relatives nowadays), especially exchanging clothes, wines and precious metals, is so unlike the people of today's world! Where did such friendliness and humanness vanish to? What really has corrupted us so much so that one can no longer spot a nice dress or shirt at a street-side shop while they walk through the city, and think of picking it up as a gift for an old-time friend, a son or daughter, or even just a nice neighbor!¹²⁸

¹²⁶For parcels though, especially where they originate from foreign (often Internet-based) vendors, and such that the recipient [already] ordered and paid for the packaged physical item (such as when I once bought a ceremonial magician's hooded gown akin to the kind one might spot the German Gregorian band members donning), we nowadays can either pick those up from an agent office in town (and not the post office as used to be the case), or that they are deliverable to one's physical address (often with additional correspondences over social media or via direct phone calls).

¹²⁷For students of literature, it should be worth indicating that **Letter Writing** is in fact its own respected genre of literature, and that despite the modern means of communication having become overly digitized, there still should be room for creative letter writing as well as the exchange of ideas between either individuals or between individuals and the public, via the format and tone of a formal letter. In fact, I do recall a time during my teenage years in school (but also slightly during primary; after our originally boys-only school became a mixed school), when it was the case that, the only sure way to win or get into a girl's heart was via sitting oneself down on some humble evening or Sunday afternoon, and writing down one's thoughts and feelings in a letter [likewise manually decorated or perhaps written on decorated letter-paper], which, whether stashed under the said girl's book the next day, or perhaps delivered to her via a friend, would without doubt sooner than later, send screams into the air, and yes, your boy would meet with both smiles and some sweet kisses for the rest of the school term!

¹²⁸Just not to leave this memory lost to everyone but myself; I recall, and should share here, even if briefly, that while I was a younger person.. around my late teens and throughout my twenties, I enjoyed the thrills of being a member in a local community credit and savings fraternity — it was called **Abagalana Community Bank**, ACB, founded by my mother, **Amooti Nyandera Christine**, and her longtime friend, **Mrs. Muyigwa Gertrude Abwoli**, both wonderful, thoughtful and industrious mother figures hard to forget in my life. That, among the routine, mandatory practices and traditions/culture they cultivated among the members of ACB was the mandatory exchange of gifts and presents at least once, at the end of each savings/loan cycle (typically every 4 months in a year), so that, without knowing who shall get what or give what to who, every present member at the cycle's end function was sure to return home with a surprise gift well packaged in boxes, wrapping papers, and heavy enough to carry with both hands or upon one's head! That it was **a randomized exchange of presents** made it even the more thrilling; every member had to ensure to buy something worth no less than UGX 10,000 from somewhere, and package and wrap it up well, but not assign it a particular person's name. At the venue of the cycle's end party, members would show up dressed elegantly and each carrying their gift, which they would present at some designated table. An administrator would take note of everyone that brought a gift (as only

Such are the nice little things one finds Defoe talking about, but which, for most readers perhaps, are but a distant memory or mere fiction!

77 May 18, 2026 04:25:46 - Crusoe's Battle Against Packs of Ravenous Wolves in the Pyrenees

Crusoe is back in Europe, but is not settled. A while after arriving in England, he later sailed to Lisbon in Portugal, and while there, acquired significant merchandise shipped to him from the Brasils. However, instead of traveling with it back to England via sea, he opted to have it transformed into Bills of Exchange¹²⁹, and with that, he then embarked on a Land-Adventure back to England.

The terrestrial voyage, taken in the company of several English and Portuguese merchants as well as some servants, all sourced from Lisbon, took them from the coastal capital city of Portugal, Lisbon, across land to Spain, and from there into French territory via inland capital city, Paris, on their way to the English coastal city of Dover¹³⁰, via the coastal city of Calais in France. However, a little before entering French territory on their way from Madrid, the caravan encountered not only a fierce winter, but also a troublesome route — deep valleys, alpine meadows, dense forests, and as Defoe tells us, wolves! — in the Spanish-French border region of the Pyrenees — a great mountain range close to the northern Spain city of Pamplona (which Defoe prefers to refer to as “Pampeluna”).

Among the fierce encounters their caravan had to put up with while in the Pyrenees is the following...

those would qualify to likewise receive), and that these presents were **assigned sequential numbers** that would then be written on tokens of papers that would then be rolled into balls and placed in a basket. The basket contents would later be **shuffled**, and each qualified member would then have to **pick a random token ball** that would then reveal the gift number for the present they would later have to be assigned. Twas like a kind of lottery where any number chosen must result in a win! Such was the wonderful tradition that nowadays — time has gone by, and I have not been an active member of ACB having relocated faraway — I sometimes think back to, and wonder if such might not be traditions worth teaching to other audiences and communities as well! They were so great at bonding strangers, but also great at building trust and commitment between business partners! In Defoe's story of Crusoe sending gifts to his business partners in the Brasils, we indeed see similar traits and the signs that these must be classical traditions worth exploring, worth keeping alive!

¹²⁹The glossary in [4] says that these are essentially “promissory notes” or just cheques.

¹³⁰Geographically, the English coastal city of Dover is the closest separation between England and mainland Europe, with the English channel as all that's betwixt them; such that Calais is the coastal city in northern France, directly across the English channel from Dover.

We did not think fit to disturb them at their Feast, neither did they take much Notice of us: Friday would have let fly at them, but I would not suffer him by any Means; for I found we were like to have more Business upon our Hands than we were aware of. We were not gone half over the Plain, but we began to hear the Wolves howl in the Wood on our Left, in a frightful Manner, and presently after we saw about a hundred coming on directly towards us, all in a Body, and most of them in a Line, as regularly as an Army drawn up by experienc'd Officers. I scarce knew in what Manner to receive them; but found to draw our selves in a close Line was the only Way: so we form'd in a Moment: But that we might not have too much Interval, I order'd, that only every other Man should fire, and that the others who had not fir'd should stand ready to give them a second Volley immediately, if they continued to advance upon us, and that then those who had fir'd at first, should not pretend to load their Fusees again, but stand ready with every one a Pistol; for we were all arm'd with a Fusee, and a Pair of Pistols each Man; so we were by this Method able to fire six Volleys, half of us at a Time; however, at present we had no Necessity; for upon firing the first Volley, the Enemy made a full Stop, being terrify'd as well with the Noise, as with the Fire; four of them being shot into the Head, dropp'd, several others were wounded, and went bleeding off, as we could see by the Snow: I found they stopp'd, but did not immediately retreat; whereupon remembring that I had been told, that the fiercest Creatures were terrify'd at the Voice of a Man, I caus'd all our Company to hollow as loud as we could; and I found the Notion not altogether mistaken; for upon our Shout, they began to retire, and turn about; then I order'd a second Volley to be fir'd, in their Rear, which put them to the Gallop, and away they went to the Woods.

This gave us leisure to charge our Pieces again, and that we might loose no Time, we kept going; but we had but little more than loaded our Fusees, and put our selves into a Readiness, when we heard a terrible Noise in the same Wood, on our Left, only that it was farther onward the same Way we were to go.

and then..

The Night was coming on, and the Light began to be dusky, which made it worse on our Side; but the Noise encreasing, we could easily perceive that it was the Howling and Yelling of those hellish Creatures; and on a sudden, we perceiv'd 2 or 3 Troops of Wolves, one on our Left, one behind us, and one to the Front; so that we seem'd to be surrounded with 'em; however, as they did not fall upon us, we kept our Way forward, as fast as we could make our Horses go, which the Way being very rough, was only a good large Trot; and in this Manner we came in View of the Entrance of a Wood, through which we were to pass, at the farther Side of the Plain; but we were greatly surpriz'd, when coming nearer the Lane, or Pass, we saw a confus'd Number of Wolves standing just at the Entrance.

On a sudden, at another opening of the Wood, we heard the Noise of a Gun; and looking that Way, out rush'd a Horse, with a Saddle, and a Bridle on him, flying like the Wind, and sixteen or seventeen Wolves after him, full Speed; indeed, the Horse had the Heels of them; but as we suppos'd that he could not hold it at that rate, we doubted not but they would get up with him at last, and no question but they did.

But here we had a most horrible Sight; for riding up to the Entrance where the Horse came out, we found the Carcass of another Horse, and of two Men, devour'd by the ravenous Creatures, and one of the Men was no doubt the same who we heard fir'd the Gun; for there lay a Gun just by him, fir'd off; but as to the Man, his Head, and the upper Part of his Body was eaten up.

This fill'd us with Horror...

Thus, not only is it a fierce winter with harshly cold weather and barely passable roads, but the team encountered packs — no, hordes — of ferocious, terrifying, howling and voracious canines in the form of ravenous wolves! As we see, the beasts are determined to attack not just the human travellers, but also their horses, and both of which they maul and shred upon encounter.

Twas interesting reading of Defoe's militaristic strategies dealing with foes that are [this time] not human, but utterly inhuman! The violence, the fright and the action, got me reading and re-reading those pages several times, to properly picture and soak bits of Defoe's style of narrating battle scenes¹³¹. Twas entertaining and a significant retreat from the kind of scenery and tensions that Crusoe encountered or described in all earlier parts of his story¹³².

¹³¹Of course, twas of interest to me, seeing as I have had to utilize similar skill in several parts of *Rock 'N' Draw*, [2]. However, and as one might compare this scene to Defoe's earlier battle-like scenes such as we encountered in **Section 65** and related **Section 66**, the language, the speed and the vividness of the narrations are worth noting and celebrating.

¹³²Also, note that, the cover artworks utilized for this review manuscript; particularly for the frontal cover — depicting a scene with the horsemen fending off hordes of wolves — but

78 May 23, 2026 03:21:31 - Nearly Celibate, Crusoe Finally Marries and Raises a Family!

Crusoe is finally back to England (the second time), and decides to settle in for a while, starting a family as well as nurturing the children of his kin..

My true Friend, the Widow, earnestly dissuaded me from it, and so far prevail'd with me, that for almost seven Years she prevented my running Abroad; during which time, I took my two Nephews, the Children of one of my Brothers into my Care: The eldest having something of his own, I bred up as a Gentleman, and gave him a Settlement of some Addition to his Estate, after my Decease; the other I put out to a Captain of a Ship; and after five Years, finding him a sensible bold enterprising young Fellow, I put him into a good Ship, and sent him to Sea: And this young Fellow afterwards drew me in, as old as I was, to farther Adventures my self.

In the mean time, I in Part settled my self here; for first of all I marry'd, and that not either to my Disadvantage or Dissatisfaction, and had three Children, two Sons and one Daughter: But my Wife dying, and my Nephew coming Home with good Success from a Voyage to Spain, my Inclination to go Abroad, and his Importunity prevailed and engag'd me to go in his Ship, as a private Trader to the East Indies; This was in the Year 1694.

Thus Crusoe finally becomes a family man, raising and grooming kids, and even though momentarily, likewise enjoys the experiences of being a married man! Hahaha.. after such a long tenure entertaining nomadism and solitariness, I wonder how it felt like for poor Crusoe finally having to sit at home and live like mere mortals! Plus, he'd almost become celibate!

78.1 Later Note

As with numerous things I have come to appreciate about Crusoe, loving to travel and explore the world is one — a habit I surely admire, but which isn't as [readily] accessible to me as it possibly was for him — but also the decision to hold off family and marriage commitments for as long as possible¹³³.

Talking of getting married or starting a family, note that, as the reviewer of Robinson Crusoe's story, and given bits of my own embattled family background

also one of the inner-cover art works at the end of this manuscript, were actually inspired by, based upon this particular scene in *Robinson Crusoe*.

¹³³Well, for Crusoe's case, ignoring the time he spent in involuntary isolation while on the island a shipwreck had exiled him to, we must acknowledge that it is very possible, just like for today's professional long-range drivers of trucks, but also pilots of commercial airlines perhaps, that the nature of a sailor's lifestyle most likely makes it harder for one to readily settle at a single place and start or run a family. So, perhaps, that could be one justification for why it took him so long to get married.

as shared in **Section 52**, I think that, a little while after finishing writing this review, I should in fact abandon much else to do with enterprising and explorations, and likewise attempt to find a girl, marry, and yes, run a [normal] family!

79 May 23, 2026 03:51:25 - Daniel Defoe Reviewing Himself

Finally coming to the end of a wonderful, even though sometimes intimidating, literary adventure re-reading, while reviewing Robinson Crusoe's Adventures as an adult, I truly must admit that it is **only now that I truly appreciate the strenuous efforts Daniel Defoe must have undergone to bring such a formidable work to life!**

All these things, with some very surprizing Incidents
in some new Adventures of my own, for ten Years more, I
may perhaps give a farther Account of hereafter.

I feel lucky that I picked up an annotated edition, [4] — with sufficient preamble/frontal material, but also significant appendices included, so that, it definitely feels much better than picking up a mere digital rendition of the original. **Thanks Oxford!**

As a writer, it pleased me to learn that Defoe didn't just leave this great work hanging in the air, but actually went ahead to pen some sequels, and reviews of his own — in the form of commentaries and reflections upon not just his own unique character "Robinson Crusoe"¹³⁴, but also his own life¹³⁵.

Concerning what we can glean from reading Daniel Defoe's own review/auto-biographical notes, it makes for a good hypothesis that apart from being a seasoned student of the scriptures, it likewise is **possible that he was significantly influenced by the character of Jesus**. Why? The information one gleans from his notes, but also from later reviewers of his works and life, indicate that it is very likely that Defoe did not meet with sufficient appreciation from his own immediate community nor fellow countrymen¹³⁶.

As for the influence from the person of Jesus, we learn that, Defoe occasionally found himself having to many times speak in parables or use allegories in his communications¹³⁷ — "**distant characters or language**" so he says —

¹³⁴Later, somewhat likened to earlier literary characters such as "Don Quixote" from the first European modern novel by Spanish writer, **Miguel de Cervantes Saavedra** — whose work predated that of Defoe by about a century [3].

¹³⁵About which, in *Serious Reflections*, a sequel, but also a review of his earlier works, we learn that indeed, Daniel Defoe based much of the fiction in his written works on his own factual personal experiences in life, as well as the many readings and studies of other people's works including an undeniable impeccable appreciation of reading the Christian sacred scriptures; the Bible.

¹³⁶For example, we learn that he was occasionally on the run in England, but also that, he sometimes faced acute financial difficulties despite being a prolific writer and contributor to his society's literature and culture, and in fact, wound up his life with significant debts as several historians inform us concerning his legacy! Refer to **Section 3.1**, but also consult [3].

¹³⁷Of course, it is on record — see [3] — that Defoe was a renown [British] government agent and spy. Might further explain/justify the necessity to make some or several of his ideas and communications intentionally "hidden".

but also that, he many times needed to travel abroad to seek authority as well as to appeal to foreign audiences...

the Teacher, like a greater, having no Honour in his own Country. Facts that are form'd to touch the Mind, must be done a great Way off , and by somebody never heard of: Even the Miracles of the Blessed Saviour of the World suffered Scorn and Contempt, when it was reflected, that they were done by the Carpenter's Son; one whose Family and Original they had a mean Opinion of, and whose Brothers and Sisters were ordinary People like themselves.

—Daniel Defoe, *The Life and Adventures of Robinson Crusoe*, 2000[4]

Which, as we learn in the annotation and critical reviewer's notes included in the volume, [4], is possibly based on the scripture:

For Jesus himself testified, that a prophet hath no honour in his own country.

—John 4:44

80 May 23, 2026 04:20:34 - The Moral

This last excerpt is from Defoe's own notes relating to his earlier written works such as *Robinson Crusoe*, but is here quoted verbatim, as an **illuminating remark** he made in his *Serious Reflections*, concerning his own writing discipline and methods.

As the Design of every Thing is said to be first in the Intention, and last in the Execution; so I come now to acknowledge to my Reader, That the present Work is not merely the Product of the two first Volumes, but the two first Volumes may rather be called the Product of this: The Fable is always made for the Moral, not the Moral for the Fable.

80.1 Later Note

That intents hold the gist of things shall be appreciated not only by Chaos Magicians¹³⁸ but also anyone with the care to study [and perhaps execute] the wisdom passed on by the reviewer in *Grimoire Lumtauto*, [6].

Thus we end our treatment of *The Life and Strange Surprising Adventures of Robinson Crusoe, of York, Mariner* as presented in [4] by the **OXFORD WORLD'S CLASSICS** series.

¹³⁸Thanks to late British Occultist and Computer Scientist, **Peter James Carroll**, but also his predecessor and father of **Sigil Magick**, **Austin Osman Spare**, intents as the foundations of most magical designs and executions are no more a thing of the past!

81 ABOUT REVIEWER



Fut. Prof. Joseph W. Lutalo at Nuchwezi Research

[Future Professor] **Joseph Willrich Lutalo Cwa Mukama Rwemera Weira** is an independent empirical researcher but also a seasoned theorist in software language engineering, esoteric science and mathematics. He's an avid writer on all things relating to modern scientific illuminism such as practical chaos magick, technomancing, occult art and crafts. As of this moment, he is based at his private, personal laboratory known as "Nuchwezi Research" in Garuga, UGANDA — also home to the (mostly online) school: Nuchwezi Esoteric School (NES; <https://iona.nuchwezi.com>). He is the founder of an underground esoteric community of researchers and practitioners known as IoNA (Illuminates of Nuchwezi Angellic). Otherwise, he was recently (2025) a finalist graduate researcher at Makerere University's Col-

lege of Computing and Information Sciences (CoCIS), from where he completed his MSc. Software Engineering and Data Communications. His Master's thesis, "VOSA: A Reusable and Reconfigurable Voice Operated Support Assistant Chatbot Platform" was successfully presented at SE2024 in Copenhagen, Denmark, and it introduced a hands-free human support tool driven by user-configurable knowledge models based on QAKBs.

Since founding **Nuchwezi** (<https://nuchwezi.com>), a research-oriented technology service provider based in UGANDA, circa 2014, he has made extensive contributions in the form of mobile and web applications, software libraries, a new general-purpose programming language (TEA – <https://tea.nuchwezi.com>) and several other contributions in both the arts and sciences. He has a total of 60+ academic works (ORCID), 20+ scholarly articles (Google Scholar) and has contributed a total of 150+ mini-lectures on several topics in computer science, maths and software engineering as well as two special lists focused on Occult Science (54 videos) and Chaos Magick (145 videos) (YouTube). Joseph has written 2 full-length novels as of this moment, and 3 novellas. Apart from being the brains and hands behind several unconventional musical acts based in Uganda and especially over ICs (**I**nternet **C**ommunities) such as pioneer melodic metal-on-keys band MAZERA, underground Hip Hop acts Nemesis Fixx, Arch L, Mensa ICE, BATEMBUZYI and more, he also is the founder and Editor-in-Chief of **I*POW**, the Telegram-based *International Internet Portfolio of Writers*. Fut. Prof. JWL continues to push the edge for what's possible in both fiction and non-fiction, written, spoken and performed modern [world] literature as and when the need arises. At 40 years of age as of May 2026, Joseph is likewise exploring the prospect of obtaining their PhD from potentially the University of Oxford.

81.1 Notable Earlier Reviews

Joseph is a passionate reviewer of both academic and non-academic works over the years. However, in the interests of only calling out the academic reviews in particular, the following shall be worth mentioning:

1. **A Philosophical Review:** Lutalo, J. (2025). **Concerning a transformative power in certain symbols, letters and words.** <https://doi.org/10.20944/preprints202502.1849.v1> — *this work helps develop a theoretical foundation for the still fringe idea and field of “Computational Mysticism”. It builds the theory via a careful review of 4 major works spanning philosophy, sociology and linguistics:*
 - (a) Berger, P., & Luckmann, T. (2016). The social construction of reality. In *Social theory re-wired* (pp. 110-122). Routledge. — *A 1966 treatise by two professors of sociology, Peter L. Berger and Thomas Luckmann, on how social reality is constructed through language and symbols.*
 - (b) Bourdieu, P. (1991). Language and symbolic power. Harvard university press. — *A 1991 book by renowned French sociologist, anthropologist, and philosopher, Professor Pierre Bourdieu (Collège de France) that explores how language and symbols are used to maintain and challenge power structures in society.*
 - (c) Wydra, H. (2012). The power of symbols—Communism and beyond. *International Journal of Politics, Culture, and Society*, 25(1), 49-69. — *A 2012 paper by Harald Wydra, Professor of Politics and Holden Fellow in Politics at St Catharine's College, University of Cambridge, and which work treats of how symbolic structures played a crucial role in the formation and maintenance of Soviet communism as a political force, but also the dramatic and imaginative sources of the Bolshevik Revolution and how symbolic meanings contributed to the creation of Soviet society.*
 - (d) Chandler, D. (1994). The Sapir-Whorf Hypothesis. — *A 1994 paper by Dr. Daniel Chandler of Aberystwyth University in Wales that laid the foundations for linguistic relativity as a theory, and which suggests that the structure of a language affects its speakers' cognition and worldview.*
2. **A Mathematical Review:** Lutalo, J. W. (2025). **A Mini-Review of RNG Theory.** Zenodo. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20705477> — *This mini-review presents literature excerpts from one important and influential 1992 academic statistical text book by Clarke et al., as well as original commentary, discussion and new formulations concerning the matter of Random Number Generators (RNGs) and their evaluation. It preceded later work by the reviewer on developing the Lu-Number System (LNS) as well as its potential use in automated generation of random numbers based on reading entropy in nature. The related works are:*
 - (a) Geoffrey Mallin Clarke and Dennis Cooke. *A Basic Course in Statistics—3rd Ed.* Edward Arnold, 1992. — *A fine introductory text on college-level mathematical statistics.*

- (b) Lutalo, J. W. (2025). **A Meta-Review of The Philosophical and Mathematical Foundations of The Number Generating Theory (NGT) and The Lu-Number System, LNS.** — *A review of both earlier work on LNS as well as further commentary courtesy of Professor Terry Lyons (Oxford), concerning potential use of the proposed Lu-Numbers in not only RNGs but also modeling general kinds of artificial intelligence and machine learning tasks among others.*
3. **Computational and Mathematical Review:** Lutalo, J. W. (2025). **A Comparative Review and Critique of the 1991 Tree Algebra Thesis: Revisiting Gibbons (1991) in Light of Contemporary Modern Transformatics.** <https://www.academia.edu/144711639/> — *A review of [Oxford CS] Professor Jeremy Gibbon's 1991 PhD thesis in light of newly developed mathematical theory by the reviewer spanning sequences and their algebras, of which, it was found that Gibbon's trees and graphs are but a mere subset. Related works:*
- (a) Gibbons, J. (1991). *Algebras for tree algorithms* (Doctoral dissertation, University of Oxford). — *A foundational work that helped develop an algebra (a mathematical system; a language; concepts, structures, relations and operators) with which one can formally treat of various kinds of tree graphs as well as their algebraic transformation.*
- (b) Lutalo, J. W. (2025). **TRANSFORMATICS 101-explained** (Doctoral dissertation, Thesis). — *A mini-thesis, itself significantly a review of earlier works by the reviewer, laying down the conceptual, mathematical and especially theoretical foundations of the newly proposed subfield of mathematics known as "Transformatics"; a mathematics that one might essentially appreciate as a general theory of the algebra of sequences and their transforms.*
4. **Computational Review:** Lutalo, J. W. (2024). **Software Language Engineering-Text Processing Language Design, Implementation, Evaluation Methods.** <https://doi.org/10.20944/preprints202410.0636.v2> — *A thorough [meta-]review of a substantial amount of vital theory concerning the design and development of new programming languages, especially "Domain Specific Languages". It also developed new general theory on all programming and computing via Turing Machines (virtually most modern computers) as being under the umbrella of text-processing, by proposing the UPLT; Unifying Programming Language Theory. That review work predated the reviewer's [re-]design and implementation of their own new general-purpose programming language known as TEA; Transforming Executable Alphabet. Related works include:*
- (a) Oliveira, N., Pereira, M. J., Henriques, P., & Cruz, D. (2009). *Domain specific languages: A theoretical survey.* — *A highly resourceful paper concerning the then state-of-the-art in the design and implementation of especially DSLs.*
- (b) Lutalo, J. W. **TEA: Transforming Executable Alphabet-A Minimal Language Leveraging Sequence Transformer Chaining.**

<https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20094948> — *The first formal presentation of the design, implementation and evaluation approaches underlying the TEA language that is a GPL based on the reviewer's mathematics of Transformatics as well as the idea of programming using just the 26 letters of the English alphabet!*

For Details on New and Old Scholarly Works (Papers, Books, Letters):

Refer to **ACADEMIA**:

<https://mak.academia.edu/JosephWillrichLutalo>

For Details on New and Old Creative Works (Music, Video-Books, Lectures):

Refer to **YOUTUBE**:

<https://YouTube.com/@1JWL>

For Highlights of New and Old Review Works (Literature, Film):

Refer to **REDDIT**:

<https://Reddit.com/r/jwlreviews>

For Highlights of Reviews that Might not fit Anywhere-Else (Music, Artistes, People, etc.):

Refer to **TELEGRAM**:

<https://t.me/ugandanow>

82 Acknowledgments

Thanks to **Microsoft Bing Image Creator** for providing all the original artworks utilized in this review via original prompts engineered by the reviewer himself. **Figure 8** was sourced from **Telegram** channel @aetatesolis, while photographs and photo collages are IP of the reviewer himself. Otherwise, all graphics work associated with this manuscript was made possible thanks to **Adobe Express**, while the manuscript typesetting was made possible by **Texmaker** a free LaTeX editor. Despite the work underlying this review having **had no particular sponsor nor a funding body**, and yet, the often timely support from the reviewer's academic friends at **St. Kizito Learning Center**¹³⁹ — a leading Ugandan Catholic primary school located in Mityana, that helped a lot — especially during the thin months when the reviewer found themselves having to operate with almost no alternative sources of income.

83 Dedication

This booklet is especially dedicated to my late elder sister and the person that truly got my book-reading, book-loving and Book Club membership aspirations off the ground (see **Section 3**), **Hope Irene Resty**, whose pet-name "Atwoki" was also shared by the only grandmother (RIP Atwoki Mukaikuru of Kisubi-Kawuku!) I had the chance to stay close to as I grew up. Together, these

¹³⁹Refer to <https://kizitolearningcentre.net>

people greatly influenced the themes and material of my first novel, *Shrines of The Free Men*, which later drove me to write *Rock 'N' Draw*, and subsequently, the re-reading of Daniel Defoe's *The Life and Strange Surprising Adventures of Robinson Crusoe, of York, Mariner*, and thus this review.

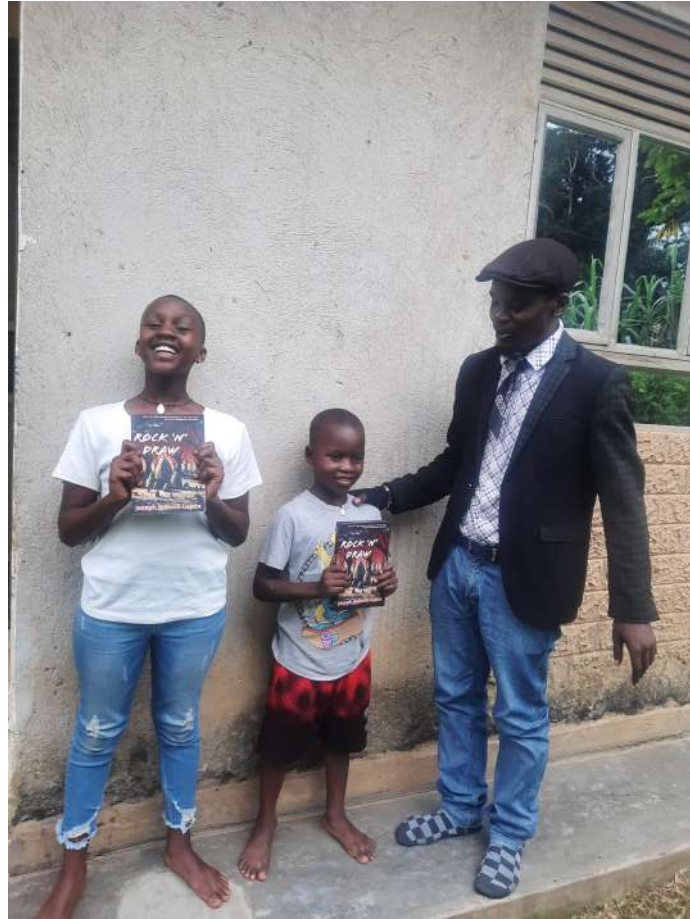


Figure 18: An **April 19, 2025** photo of the reviewer with their eldest daughter, Shona Karungi, and son, **Theo Rujuna Willrich**, at their mother's home. It was a moment of great joy when they got their copies of his second [self-published] full-length novel, **Rock 'N' Draw**.

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- [1] Stephen King. *On Writing: A Memoir of the Craft*. Scribner, New York, 2000. <https://archive.org/details/onwritingmemoiro0000king>.
- [2] Joseph Willrich Lutalo. **Rock ‘N’ Draw**. I*POW, 2025. *ISBN 978-9913-624-71-8 (First Edition)*. A physical copy might be accessed via the National Library of Uganda (NLU), but also, an education-purposes-only edition is accessible freely via Academia at <https://t.me/ipowriters/237>.
- [3] Microsoft Copilot. Research assistance and various clarifications. AI-generated insights via Copilot discussion, 2026. *Personal communication, since February 2025*.
- [4] Daniel Defoe. *Robinson Crusoe*. Oxford World’s Classics. Oxford University Press, Oxford; New York, 2007. *With introduction by Thomas Keymer and notes by Thomas Keymer and James Kelly. PDF readable version available at Internet Archive: https://archive.org/details/robinsoncrusoe0000defo_r7e4*.
- [5] Joseph Willrich Lutalo. **Shrines of the Free Men**. I*POW, 2023. *No ISBN, even for the original 2018 edition released to the public as an e-book! — The official, free-access electronic edition of the 2023 release is accessible via: <https://t.me/ipowriters/26>*.
- [6] Joseph Willrich Lutalo. **NOVUS MODERNUS GRIMOIRE LUM-TAUTO MAGIA**. I*POW, November 2025. *A Modern Grimoire of 5 Eternal Magical Languages*. <https://www.academia.edu/145086513>.
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- [8] Joseph Willrich Lutalo. **Embaga Ku Rina Island**. Telegram, Kampala, Uganda, 2023. *Though written entirely in Luganda, this is a story about a bunch of young people that sailed to a less known island on Lake Victoria, for a leisurely tour that quickly met with troubles in the form of mysterious shape-shifters as well as body snatchers. Available online at JWL’s Literature Archives: <https://t.me/wwwrite/20>*.





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CHRONOLOGICAL LITERARY REVIEW

DANIEL DEFOE'S ROBINSON CRUSOE (1719)

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